VELVET COCONUT / PENNED PICTURES / GINGA STORIES · STORYBOARD

OFFSET

After years caring for her dying mother, a grieving woman tags along with a fling and his wealthy friends to a five-day retreat, hoping to finally put herself out there and live. The retreat is built around a device that grants shared access to each guest's deepest fantasy, until she turns it, one twist at a time, into an instrument of reckoning.

58 scenes   302 shots   Written and directed by Thomas David Beatty   Ungers House II, Villa Glashuette

ACT I Arrival   **ACT IIA** Immersion and Erosion   **ACT IIB** The Hunt and the Outhouse   **ACT III** The Reckoning

The film in frames

Every shot in order, start to finish. The coloured edge on each panel marks its world.

🟦 Eve nightmare ■ Reality 🟨 Fantasy ■ Memory: grey ⬜ Memory: good times 🟨 Memory: walk to the cinema 🟦 Night 🟥 Party 🟦 The hunt 🟧 Device / infinity ⬜ Walking out

Visual rules

From the Director's Statement, Deck V5 and the Miro board.

REALITY
Black-and-white Ungers architecture. Centred, symmetrical, locked-off wides. The house dominates the frame.

NEON GREEN
The only saturated colour in the real world: device rings, cameras, bottled water, the outhouse door. Under for longer, the rings drift to yellow, then red.

FANTASY
Warm, syrupy yellow light, slowed time, a floating camera. Each guest's desire gets its own world.

MEMORY
Mother's flat, handheld and close. Greyish for the hard years, growing harsher as the fantasies grow vivid. White and bright when she reflects on the good times. Warm yellow for the walk to the cinema.

BOARD GRADE
House scenes carry a slight green cast. Fantasies glow warm yellow. Red for the dancing, the sex scenes and the final fantasies turning to nightmares (not Eleanora's). Flashbacks are washed white.

PROGRESSION
Controlled and objective in Act One, subjective and immersive by Act Three. Rooms feel smaller. The feast rots.

SOUND
TWIST then CLICK marks every passage under, louder each time. Rooms go quiet; breath gets heavier.

Cast

Character portraits from Deck V5.

Eleanora

Spanish. Cared for her mother through a long illness; now grieving, and putting herself out there to experience life.

Desire: Pain-free time with her mother, well again.

Ezra

Eleanora's fling. An actor, charming in public, corrosive in private.

Desire: Continuous admiration.

Cali

Lifelong eating disorder, masked by a free-spirit act.

Desire: Unlimited chocolate cake and a mirror that never changes.

Cai

Countercultural, escapist, quick to close ranks.

Desire: Undefined. Escape.

Jacqueline

Multilingual, razor-sharp, performing 'dumb' for Jasper.

Desire: A family, including pregnancy.

Jasper

Generational wealth, charm over manipulation.

Desire: Psychological and sexual dominance.

Charlie

The showman who built the house and the device.

Desire: Redemption through creation.

Flo

Danish socialite ruled by order and correction.

Desire: An endless cycle of restoring order.

Frans

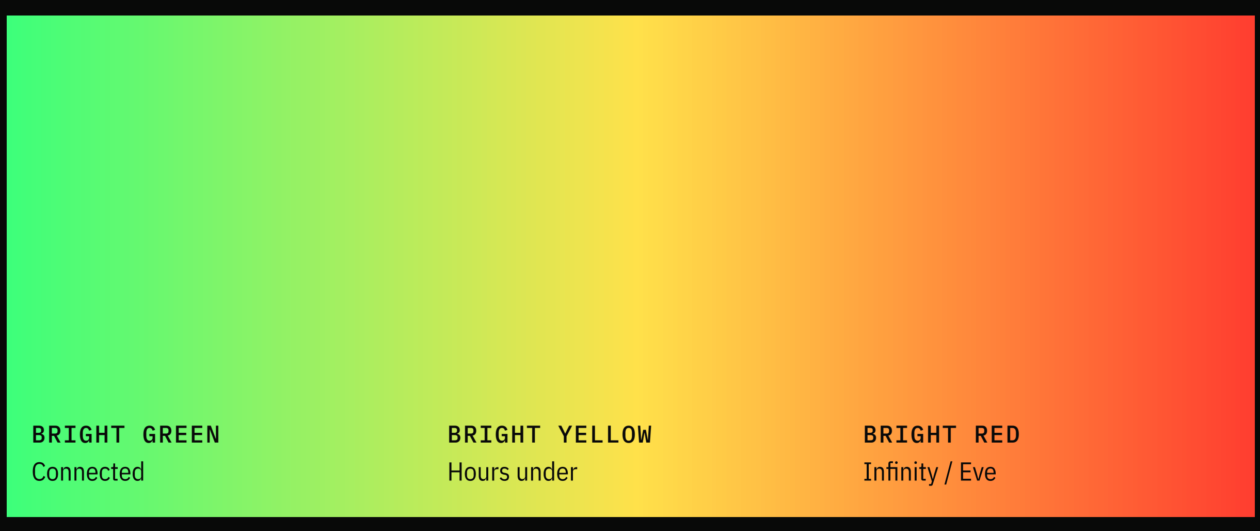
Danish entrepreneur. Hunter. Knew about Eve.

Desire: Human hunting with full agency.

The device

A neural implant on trial. Anchored at the base of the skull where the spine meets the brainstem, a slender surgical spike reaches the cortex. It does not just read signals; it rewrites them. To the user the fantasy is indistinguishable from reality.

SIZE	About 1 inch across, raised about 0.4 from the skin
FORM	Circular, white, smooth; slightly convex, like a magnifying glass
OPERATE	Twist the dial once per hour, then push the middle
OUTER RING	Green when the device is on
INNER RING	Green when connected to a subject
TIME UNDER	The longer in the fantasy, the further it glows toward red



ACT I

Arrival

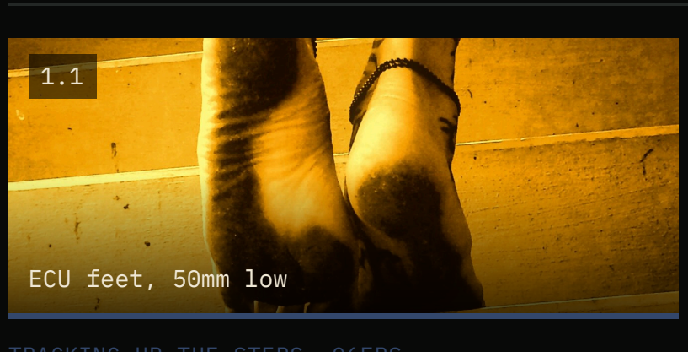
Scenes 1 to 11

01

BLACK / INT. EVE'S FANTASY - STAIRWELL - NIGHT

BLACK. A woman sprints up a stairwell in slow motion while Mother and Eleanora's voices tell her this is not real. At the top, the open balcony beckons with warm yellow light. She jumps at it with all her might.

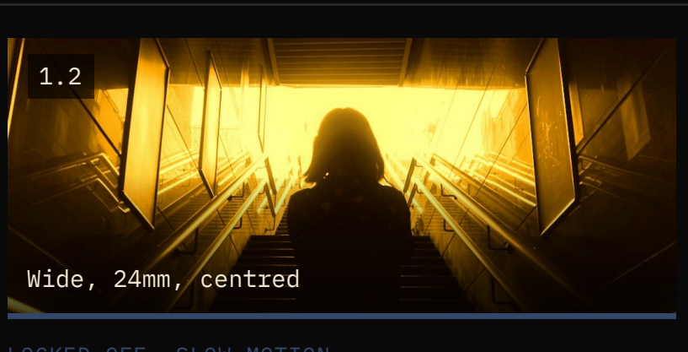
SOURCE	Script p1-2
WORLD	■ Eve nightmare
LOOK	Blue-black concrete, one warm yellow opening. Overcranked 96fps. Dead-centre symmetry that breaks only when she looks back.



TRACKING UP THE STEPS, 96FPS

BLACK. Then her muddied feet pound the steps, leaving dark smears behind. Her breath echoes loudly.

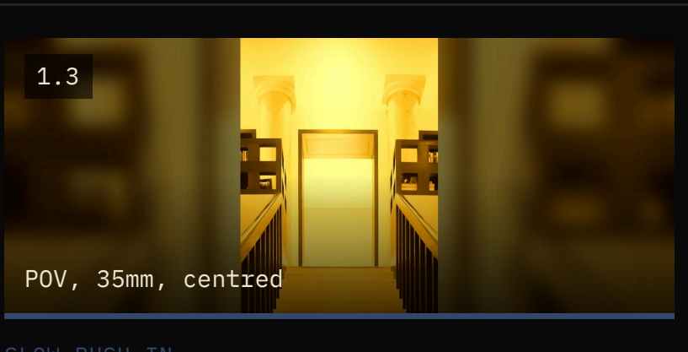
MOTHER (V.O.) Wake up, Eleanora. Wach auf, Eleanora.



LOCKED-OFF, SLOW MOTION

A WOMAN sprints up the stairwell in slow motion.

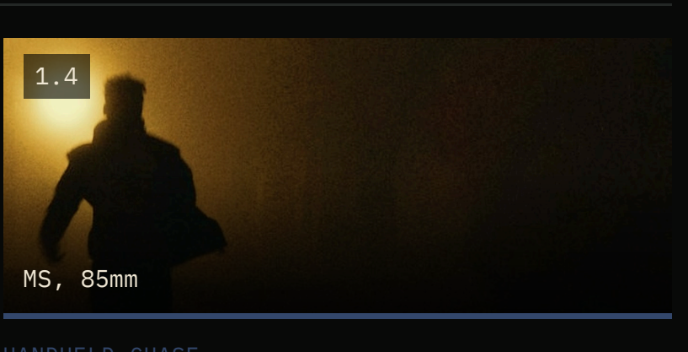
ELEANORA (V.O.) Despierta, Eleanora. Esto no es real. MOTHER (V.O.) This is not real.



SLOW PUSH IN

She halts at the top of the stairs, frozen in place. Her eyes dart back to where she came from. Her footprints are already gone. The wind howls through the open, dark doorway below.

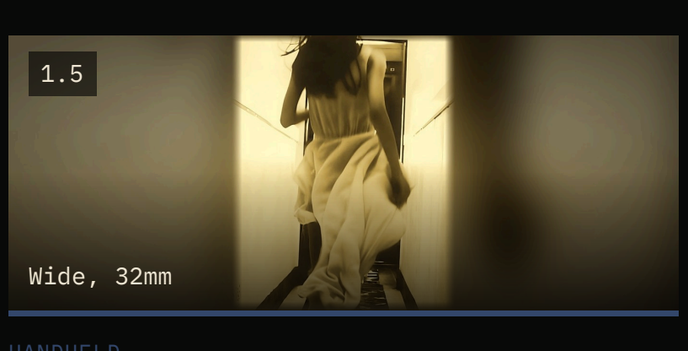
ELEANORA (V.O.) ¿Lo ves? Por eso tengo que matarte. Sí, a ti. A la persona que más amo… Pero porque no hablas mi idioma.



HANDHELD CHASE

She sprints again.

ELEANORA (V.O.) Por mucho que intentes aprenderlo, nunca lo conseguirás.



HANDHELD

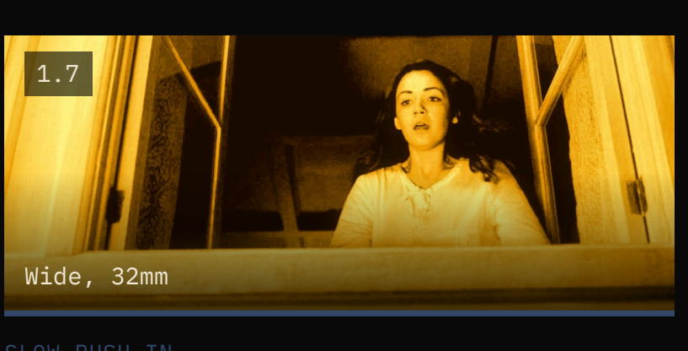
Turning the corner, she sees the open balcony.

ELEANORA (V.O.) Tu boca puede imitar los sonidos, pero jamás podrá captar lo que significa hablar en mi lengua.

STATIC

She exhales shakily. Fear grips her.

ELEANORA (V.O.) So you need to stay silent.



SLOW PUSH IN

The opening, lit with warm yellow light, beckoning her in.

ELEANORA (V.O.) Para siempre. Forever.

1.8
Insert, 85mm

SLOW MOTION, 120FPS

She jumps at it with all her might.

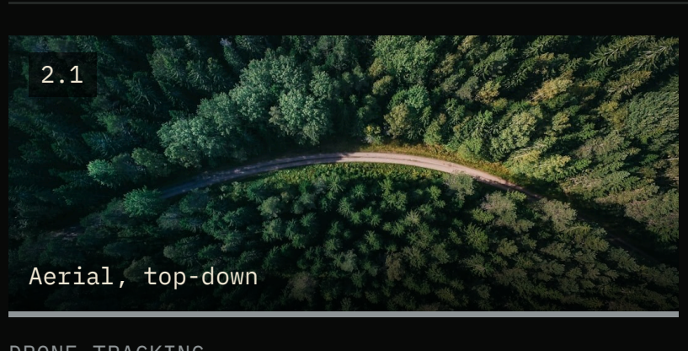
JUMP CUT TO:

02

INT. TAXI - MORNING (MOVING)

Eleanora jolts awake against the taxi window. Flo brushes off her questions; the driver says they have been crossing the estate for an hour. She draws a circle on the window, then its centre.

SOURCE	Script p2-4
WORLD	■ Reality
LOOK	First reality: cool forest greens through wet glass. Long lenses inside the car; compressed, claustrophobic.



DRONE TRACKING

Two large black taxis move down country lanes.

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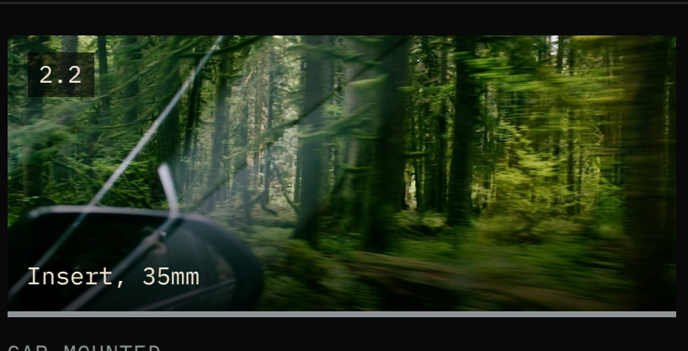

CAR-MOUNTED

Fast moving countryside whizzes by.

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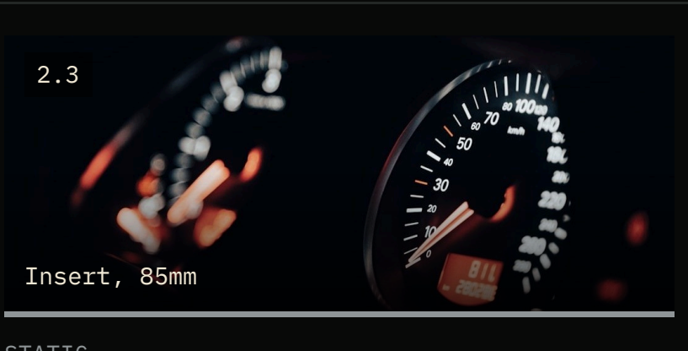


STATIC

The time is 13:00 on the car clock.

-

2.4
CU, 85mm through glass

STATIC

Eleanora jolts her eyes wide, her face pressed up against the window. Her breath fogs up the glass, disturbing the view of nature.

-

2.5
Wide, high angle

SLOW CRANE, FOLLOWING

The other large cab, filled with two other couples: Cai, Cali, Jasper and Jacqueline.

-

2.6
Insert, 50mm

STATIC

Eleanora sits up with her 'German for Beginners' book. It has been dog-eared in every which way and Post-it notes stick out from the side.

ELEANORA Where is this house? FLO (scoffs) Not a house. ELEANORA What is it then? Entschuldigung? FLO Sie sind entschuldigt. (To Frans) Ligesom at tage på rekreation, ikke? (Like a retreat, right?)

2.7
POV back seat, 32mm

STATIC

Goli, the local taxi driver with a thick moustache, overhears, noticing the awkwardness. Flo and Frans share the taxi; tiny scars are visible on the backs of their necks.

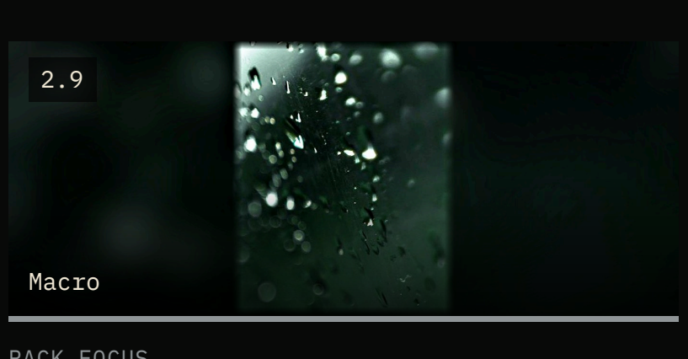
ELEANORA OK so, when do we arrive at the retreat? DRIVER Nun ja, wir fahren seit einer Stunde über das Anwesen. ELEANORA (whispers) Unanswered questions… Unbeantwortete Fragen.

2.8
ECU hand, 100mm macro

STATIC

Eleanora draws a large circle on the window, then a middle point to the circle.

ELEANORA Not your fault. So much space. Ungenutzt. So groß. DRIVER We're going right to the Zentrum… the centre of it.



RACK FOCUS

Water droplets trail down the window from her drawing.

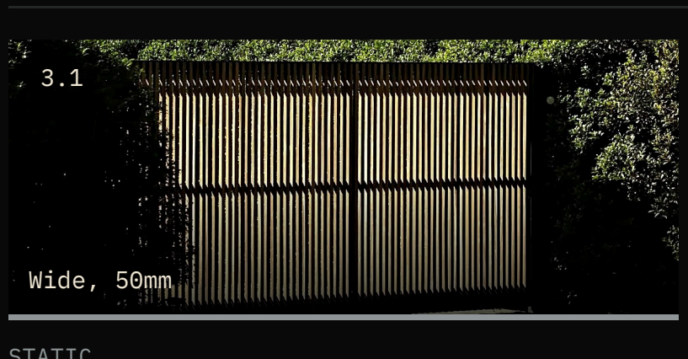
CUT TO:

03

EXT. RETREAT - MORNING

The gate opens. The guests form a semicircle before the house. Charlie and Coco's necks carry worn devices with a green glow. The group flows inside; Eleanora holds back before the symmetrical façade.

SOURCE	Script p4-5
WORLD	■ Reality
LOOK	Architecture dominates: centred, locked-off, wide. White cube against black forest.



STATIC

The front gate opens slowly.

The hum of the gate motor.

3.2
Extreme wide, 24mm, centred

LOCKED-OFF

Both cars breeze through and pull to a stop.

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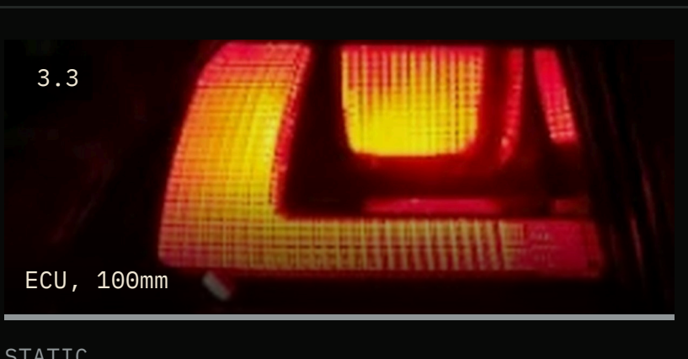

STATIC

Brake light as the car pulls to a stop.

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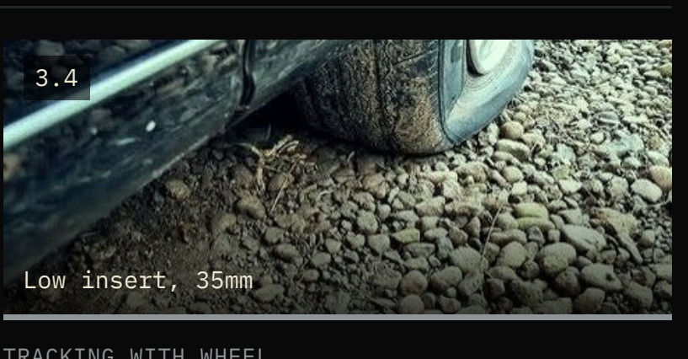

TRACKING WITH WHEEL

The driver helps with bags.

-

3.5
Low insert

STATIC

Rocks scrape and collect beneath the dragging bags.

Rocks scraping.

STATIC

From above, the guests form a rough semicircle, Eleanora lingering at the back. They are all poised. One of the taxis drives off; the other remains.

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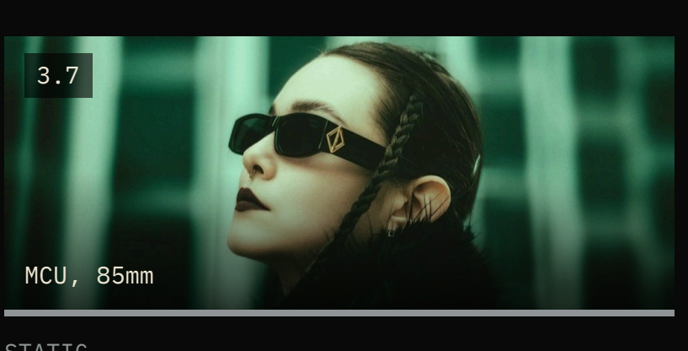

STATIC

Coco stands beside Charlie, writing notes; she whispers. A half smirk, half grimace forms on Charlie's face. Cai and Cali exchange a little smile with Eleanora. Jacqueline exchanges a look with Flo at Eleanora's expense.

-

3.8
Extreme wide, through the leaves

LOCKED-OFF

Charlie leads the group forward towards the house, followed by Coco with her tablet.

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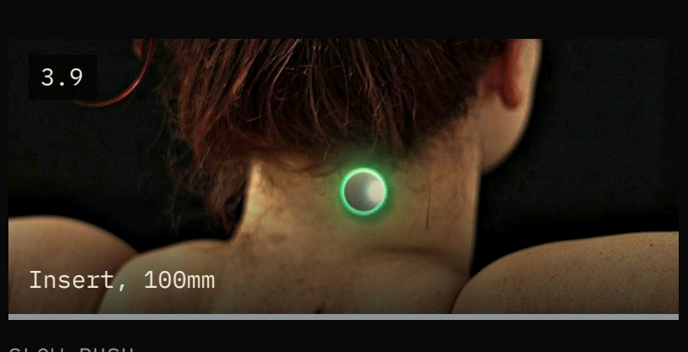


SLOW PUSH

Eleanora notices the backs of their necks: strange devices, slightly worn, a faded white with a green glow emitting.

-

3.10
Wide, 35mm

STATIC

From overhead, the semicircle of guests flows slowly into the building, with Charlie at the front.

-

3.11
Top shot, very high

STATIC

Eleanora pauses behind, holding back for a moment. She stands before the building, its perfectly symmetrical façade rising evenly on either side of her. As she follows inside, Coco directs each person to their room; Charlie stands at the top of the stairs.

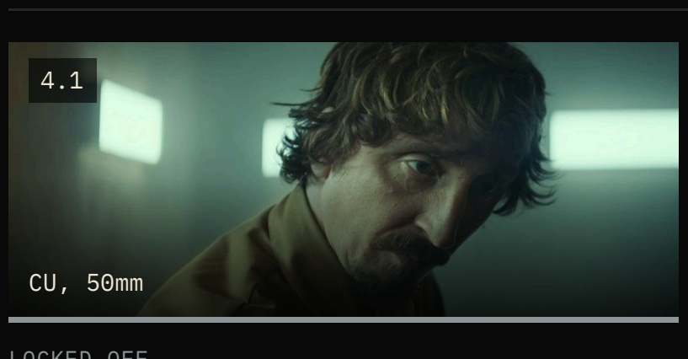
-

04

INT. DINING ROOM - DAY (INTERCUT BEDROOM)

Close on Charlie addressing the group. He quotes Ungers over insert shots of the building's architecture. Little black cameras in every room, a bright green light emitting from them. No locks. Nor keys.

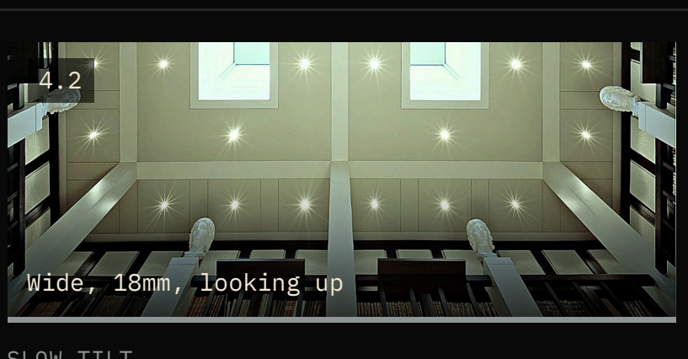
SOURCE	Script p5-7
WORLD	■ Reality
LOOK	Insert shots of the building architecture under Charlie's voice. The cameras' bright green light.



LOCKED-OFF

Close on Charlie, speaking, addressing the group.

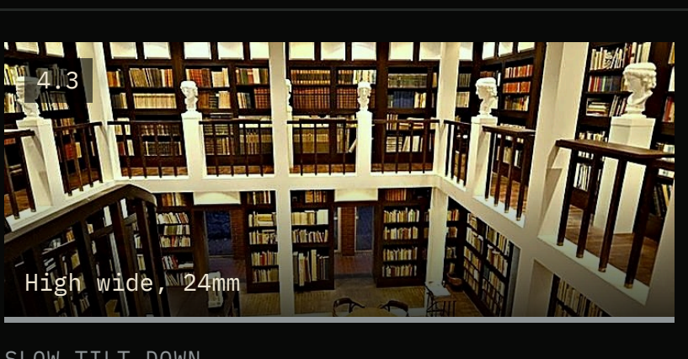
CHARLIE 'Das ist ein Lebensraum. Ein Laborversuch. Eine Verkörperung der Idee von der Welt.' ('This is a living space, a laboratory test. A representation of the idea of the world.')



SLOW TILT

Insert shot: building architecture.

CHARLIE (CONT'D) I can't take credit for it, nor shall I. So I use the words of the man who designed this place. Oswald. Mathias. Ungers.



SLOW TILT DOWN

Insert shot: building architecture. The library, seen from the gallery above.

CHARLIE (CONT'D) 'An idea of the world.' Who speaks like that nowadays? Such grandiose plans.

4.4
Wide, 24mm

STATIC

Insert shot: building architecture.

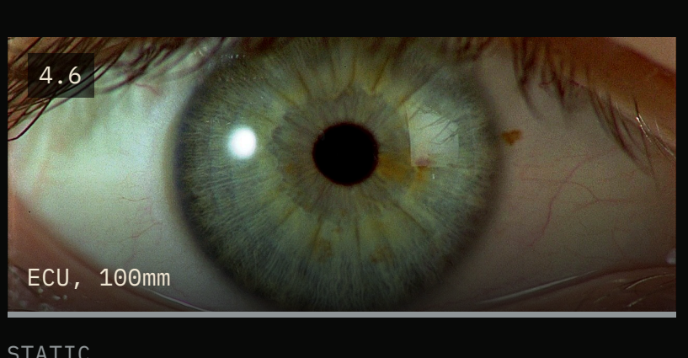
CHARLIE (CONT'D) His aim was 'To see how far architecture can be abstract. A house without qualities. No ornaments, no details, no bottom nor top. Everything subtracted to the absolute core of abstraction.' End quote. Abstraction. That is what we are going to do here. Find the core of each of you.

4.5
ECU, 100mm, centred

LOCKED-OFF

INT. BEDROOM - DAY. Little black cameras in every room, a bright green light emitting from them.

CHARLIE (V.O.) No locks. Nor keys.



STATIC

Watched. The group unpack and manoeuvre below.

CHARLIE (CONT'D) Privacy is not prerequisite. Make peace with being watched.

05

INT. BEDROOMS - DAY

Bare rooms, five sets of colour-coded scrubs. Charlie (V.O.): they will be watched, from afar. Everyone changes; jewellery piles up. Cali and Cai undress each other, aware Eleanora is watching. Her hands grip the edge of the bed.

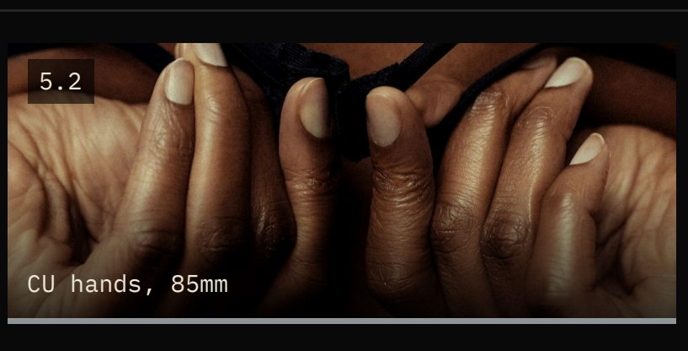
SOURCE	Script p6-7
WORLD	■ Reality
LOOK	Quiet, voyeuristic. Through doorways and down the hall.

5.1
Wide, 32mm

STATIC

Each room is bare except for five sets of colour-coded scrubs hanging neatly, with folded towels laid on the beds. Coco stands at the doorway in front of Eleanora, giving her an odd reassuring look.

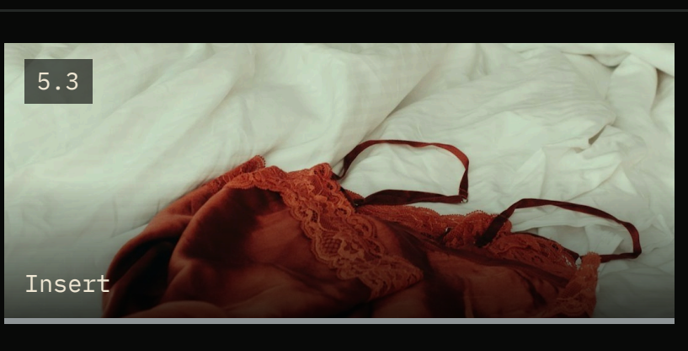
FRANS (V.O.) And who watches? CHARLIE (V.O.) Us. COCO (V.O.) But from afar. FRANS (V.O.) Big Bruder, no? CHARLIE (V.O.) Not quite. JASPER (V.O.) Something Orwellian anyhow. COCO (V.O.) All for your safety. CHARLIE (V.O.) Of course.



STATIC

Jewellery piles up in each bedside table. Flo is very precise with her finishing touches.

ELEANORA (V.O.) You're not staying with us? COCO (V.O.) Only for the start. CHARLIE We like the open and the close, don't we darling? The starters and desserts, as you always put it.



STATIC

Scrubs are held up by members of the group. Jacqueline looks upset and appalled by what she is having to wear. Jasper glances to Charlie; Charlie shakes his head.

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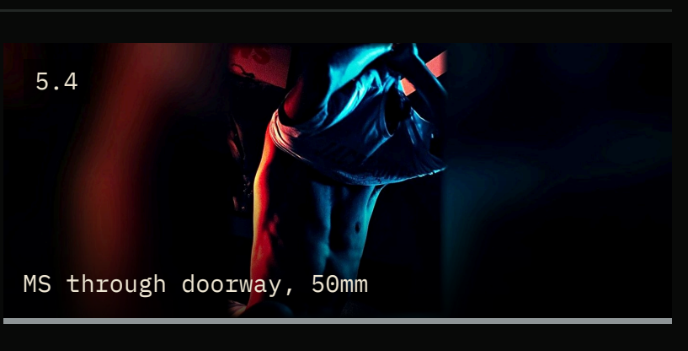

SLOW PUSH

Cali and Cai undress each other, stealing glances toward Eleanora at the end of the hallway. Aware she's watching.

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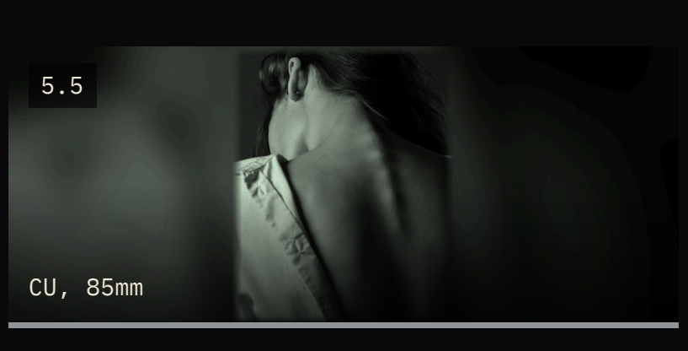
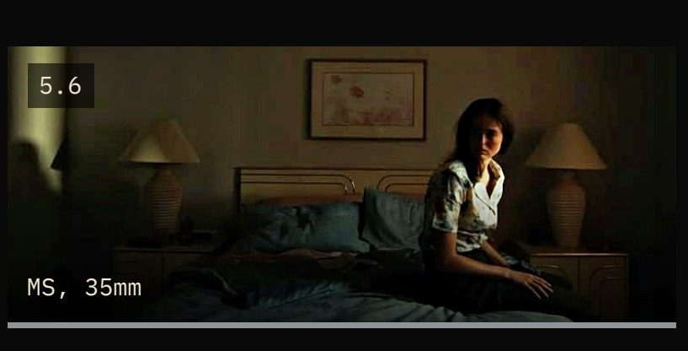


STATIC

Each person gets changed.



STATIC

Eleanora sits on the edge of her bed. Her hands grip the edge of the bed.

-

06

INT. STAIRWELL - DAY

The group ascends the staircase from shadow to pale light. Charlie and Coco stand either side of the entrance at the top, almost ceremonial. Eleanora takes a deep breath and follows.

SOURCE	Script p7-8
WORLD	■ Reality
LOOK	Low, symmetrical, the staircase as altar.

6.1
Wide, 24mm, centred

LOCKED-OFF

The group ascends the staircase, figures moving from shadow to the pale light filing from above. Charlie and Coco stand either side of the entrance at the top of the stairs, almost ceremonial.

-

6.2
POV up the stair, 35mm

STEADICAM CLIMB

Eleanora sees the doorway looming. She takes in a deep breath and ascends the stairs. Charlie and Coco follow her with subtly unsettling smiles.

CHARLIE (whispers) Get back to a blank canvas. CHARLIE (V.O.) And that's where you all can begin to paint.

07

INT. DINING ROOM - DAY (THE FEAST)

Eleanora's gaze falls on a magnificent feast with 8 black boxes as its centrepiece. Charlie reveals the device: five days, no food, only water. Eleanora names it Offset, then hears her own name muffled, as if underwater.

SOURCE	Script p8-15
WORLD	■ Reality
LOOK	Decadence in cool teal light. The table as stage, composed from the head of the room. The device is the only saturated green.

7.1
High wide, 24mm

SLOW PUSH IN

Eleanora is seated, her gaze falls upon a magnificent feast laid out in sumptuous splendour.

-

7.2
Wide, 32mm

SLOW TRACK LEFT

Gleaming platters overflow with golden joints of roast meat. A lavish smorgasbord of decadent delights and condensation-covered drinks.

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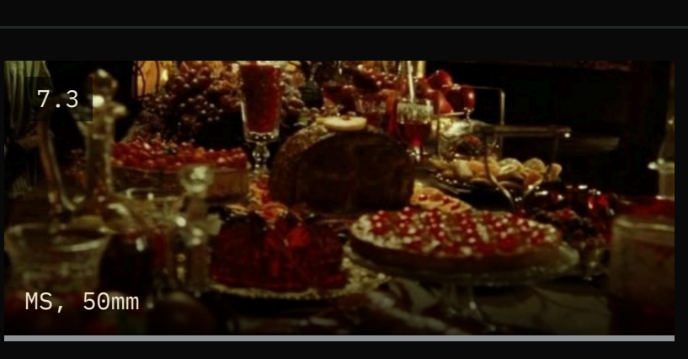

SLOW DOLLY IN

Towers of exquisite hors d'oeuvres plastered with caviar. 8 pristine black boxes are laid out in the middle of the decadent feast as a centrepiece.

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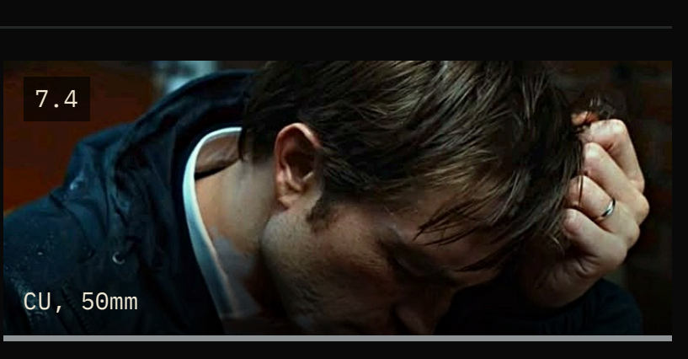


STATIC

Charlie slaps his head right in the centre; Jasper winces.

CHARLIE We came - We've come, together. That's seven. We're missing one. No one likes an odd number. Ezra is it? CALI Later.

7.5
Insert, 50mm

STATIC

Coco wants to comfort him and does a slight shimmy shuffle; Charlie holds out his hand at his side to stop her in her tracks.

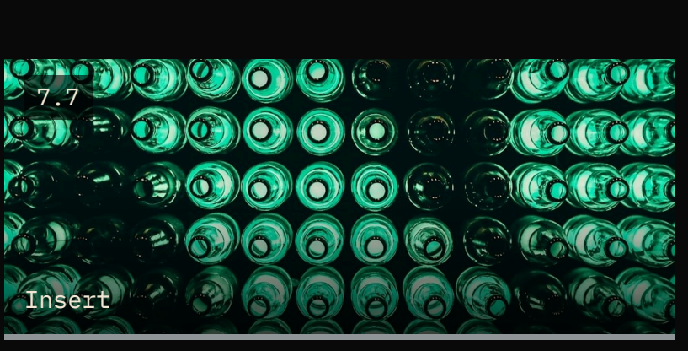
-

7.6
Insert, 100mm macro

STATIC

Coco passes Charlie one of the black boxes. He opens it carefully to reveal the device.

CHARLIE Let's get on, shall we.



STATIC

Insert: the water. Everyone apart from Eleanora pauses in their actions and looks straight towards Charlie.

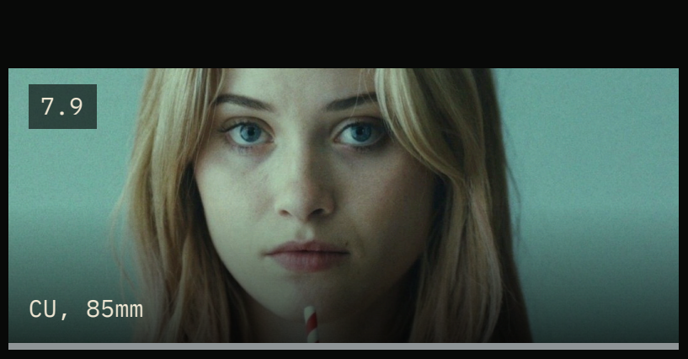
CHARLIE But you have water. The house is full of water. It's pristine, alpine, alkaline, so damn fine it will cure your bloodline. JASPER Sorry, wait. No actual food? CHARLIE Nada. Nichts. Fünf Tage, meine Schätze.

7.8
Insert, 85mm

STATIC

Rows of green glass bottles: the house is full of water.

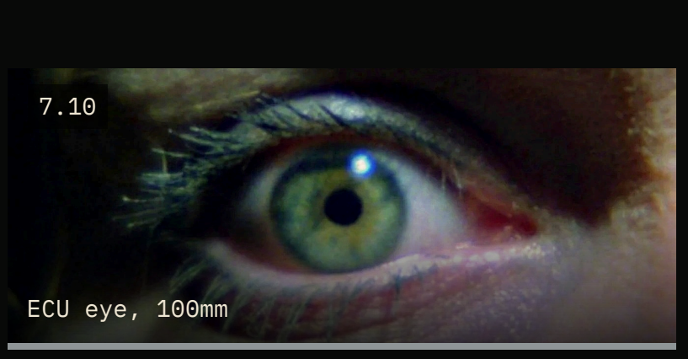
CHARLIE It's pristine, alpine, alkaline, so damn fine it will cure your bloodline.



STATIC

Eleanora watches Cali drink the milkshake halfway up the straw, then stop. Cali lets out an enthusiastic moan, as if it is delicious without tasting a drop. She looks Eleanora dead in the eyes.

ELEANORA What do you call it? CHARLIE Offline was the original name. Off-grid maybe, Offbeat, Offset. ELEANORA I like that. CHARLIE Offset?



PUSH IN

Eleanora says her own name. We hear her voice muffled, as if underwater.

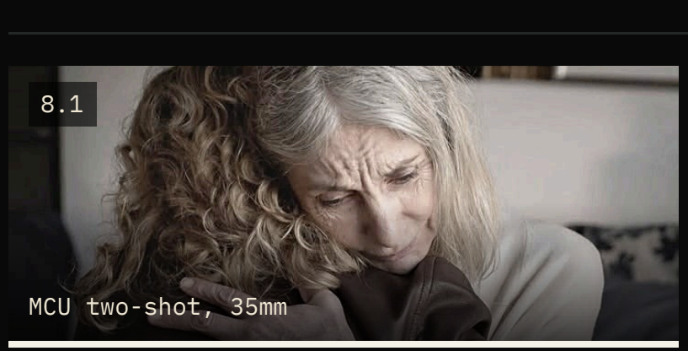
CHARLIE A gold star for the lovely… ELEANORA Eleanora. JUMP CUT TO:

08

FLASHBACK - INT. MOTHER'S FLAT - DAY

Mother holds Eleanora; recognition breaks in.

SOURCE	Script p13
WORLD	■ Memory: good times
LOOK	A good memory: soft, bright, near-white light. Handheld 35mm, close.



HANDHELD

Eleanora's MOTHER softly holds Eleanora; realisation breaks in as she recognises her daughter's face.

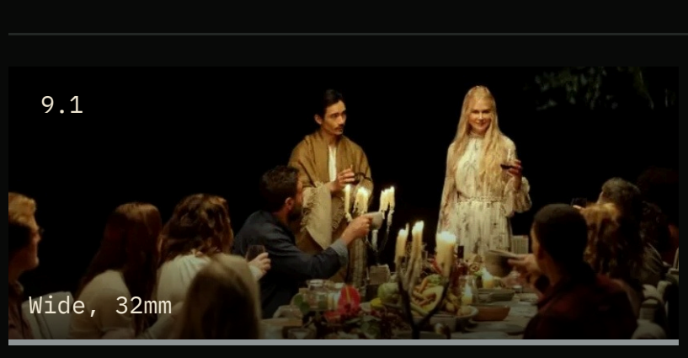
MOTHER Eleanora? JUMP BACK TO:

09

INT. DINING ROOM - DAY (THE DEVICE)

Charlie explains the rules: the first under controls the fantasy. Twist for hours, press to go. Charlie and Coco leave; Eleanora watches from the balcony.

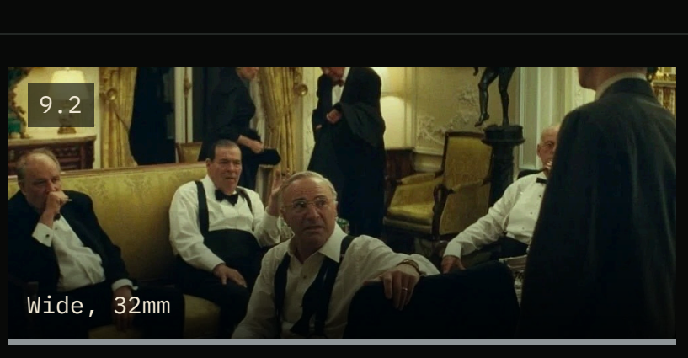
SOURCE	Script p13-16
WORLD	■ Reality
LOOK	Charlie centred and talking; the group in singles. Then high and wide from the balcony.



STATIC

Charlie and Coco stand at the head of the table. The group notice Eleanora's slip; subtle side-eyes are made to each other.

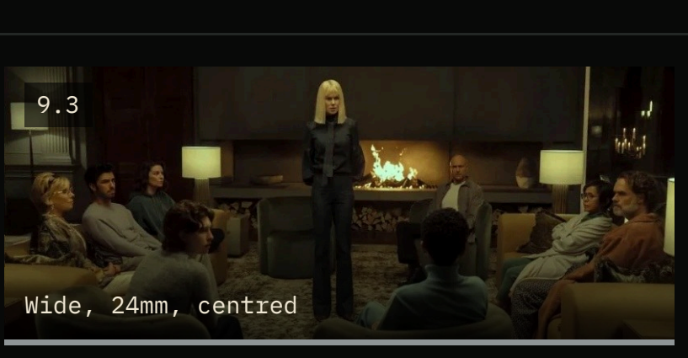
CHARLIE Eleanora. In all relationships there is the talker and there is the doer. Coco right here is the doer and I am the talker.



STATIC

Charlie stands over the seated group, talking about purpose.

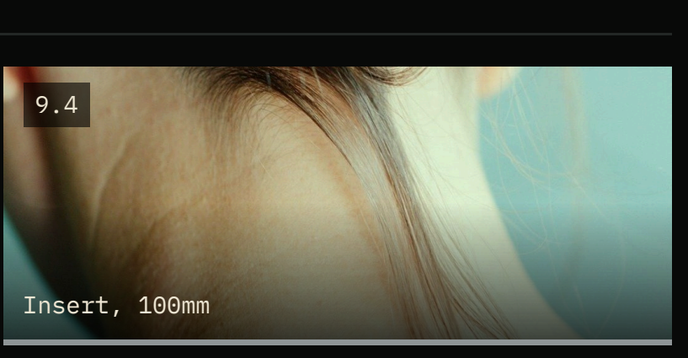
COCO This machine, if we can call it a machine, truly is something special. It has given us purpose. CHARLIE To me it is God. It shows you what you desire.



SLOW PUSH IN

Charlie centred, the group seated around him.

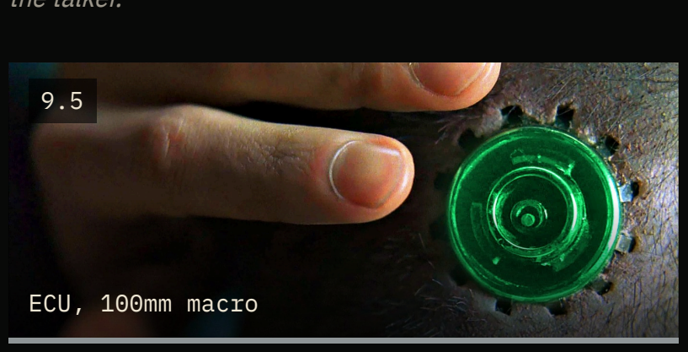
CHARLIE You each need to lay yourself out on the slab. For all to see. Then, what judgement can harm you?



STATIC

Coco walks around checking and cleaning the back of each person's neck.

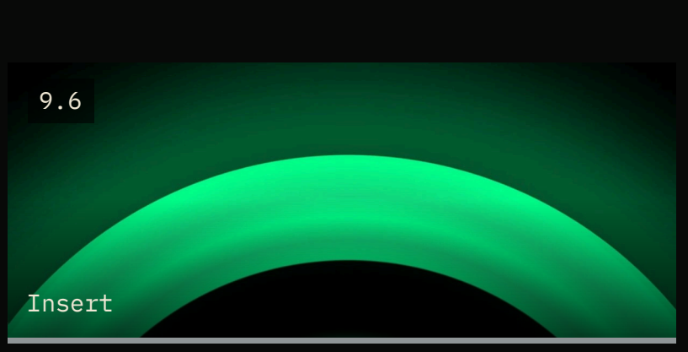
-



STATIC

Charlie twists the device.

TWIST. CHARLIE Good energy.



STATIC

He presses the middle button. A green glow emits from the inner circle.

CLICK. CHARLIE My new friends, ecstasy is just the press of a button away. Coco. COCO One twist and press is one hour… FRANS Eternity. We get it. ELEANORA (looking at one of the devices) Infinity?

9.7
MS from below, exterior, 50mm

STATIC

Eleanora looks out the balcony to see Charlie and Coco getting into the last remaining taxi. Coco holds a little longer, staring up at Eleanora's silhouette through the balcony door. Eleanora taps the glass repeatedly, gently.

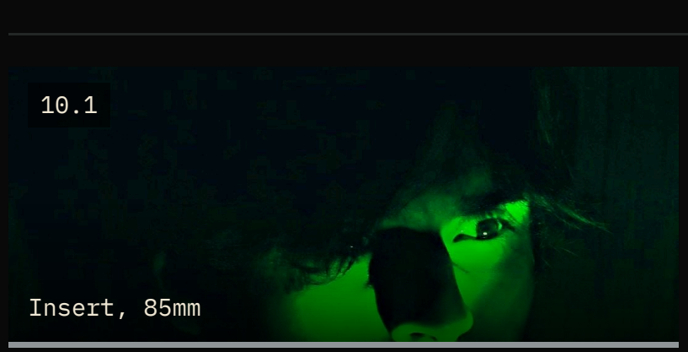
CHARLIE (V.O.) We are not the kids with a magnifying glass and you are not the ants. You are all simultaneously. The glass, the ant, and the child.

10

INT. DINING ROOM - DAY (THE FAST)

The devices are attached, outer rings glowing green, inner rings grey. The group keeps eating while agreeing food is bad for you. Eleanora's 'patent it' joke about starving kids lands badly; Frans reveals Ezra paid for her. 'Who goes first?'

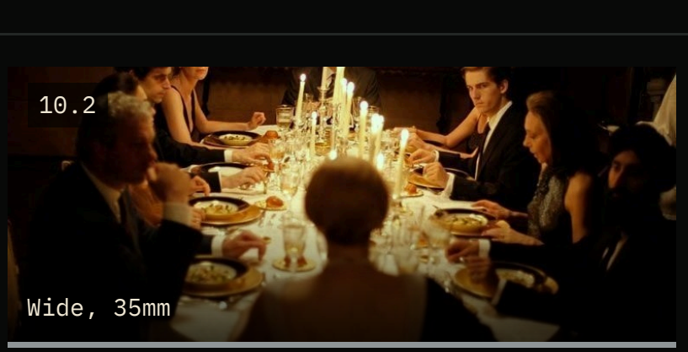
SOURCE	Script p16-27
WORLD	■ Reality
LOOK	Round-table coverage on a slow lateral dolly; intercut close-ups of chewing.



STATIC

Around the group, the devices are now attached to the back of their necks: a subtle green glow in the outer ring, a soft pulse of light; the inner ring grey, not active yet. The guests, unbothered, keep eating at the most lavish dishes.

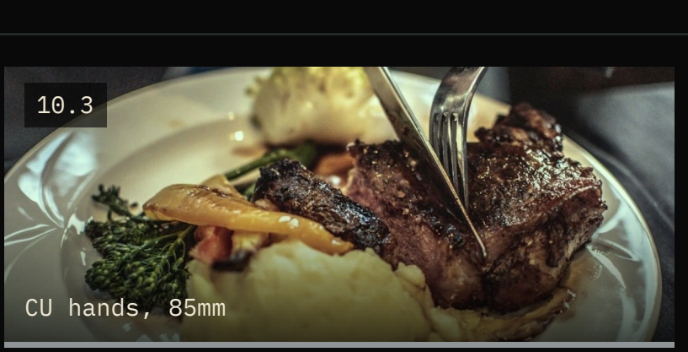
-



STATIC

Unbothered, the guests keep eating at the most lavish dishes.

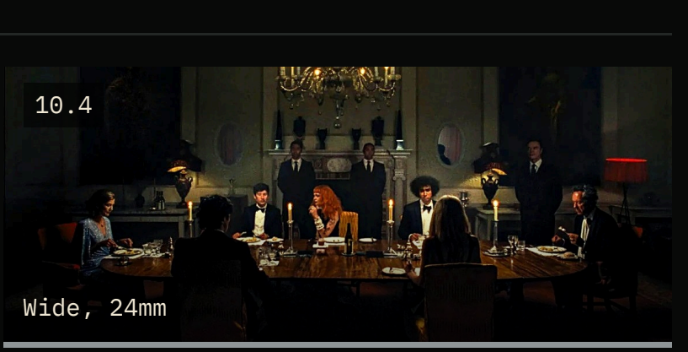
Cutlery, chewing.



STATIC

Cali picks and chops and adds food to her plate but very clearly isn't eating anything. A routine she has done many times. INTERCUT with CLOSE on chewing.

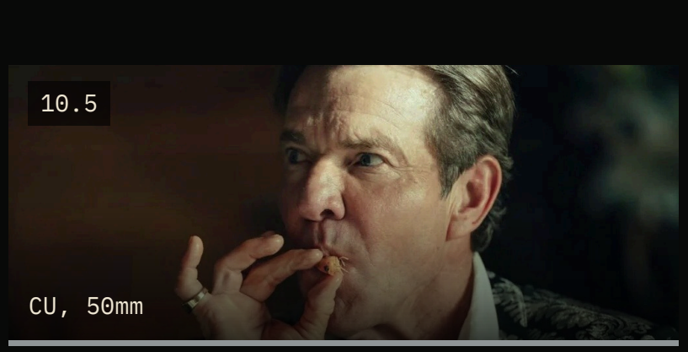
CALI 'The future is fasting' I hear. FLO Removes cancer. CALI Should go for as long as you can.



SLOW LATERAL DOLLY

The group unanimously agree food isn't good for you, but continue eating. Eleanora's joke lands; the group goes quiet. Cai breaks the silence and bursts out laughing.

ELEANORA Maybe they should patent it. JASPER Please can't we enjoy one meal without hearing of any starving kids. CAI I like her. I wasn't sure at first. Thought something was a little komisch… But dennoch, that is funny. JACQUELINE Geschmacklos.



STATIC

Frans eats with his fingers, eyes on Eleanora. Eleanora winces.

FRANS He paid for you right? You wouldn't be speaking like that if you paid for this yourself. ELEANORA You know that? FRANS I know that. ELEANORA OK. He did.

10.6
Wide, centred, 32mm

STATIC

Silence. Everyone looking towards Eleanora.

FRANS He paid for you right? You wouldn't be speaking like that if you paid for this yourself.

10.7
Wide, 50mm, down the table

STATIC

Before anyone can reply.

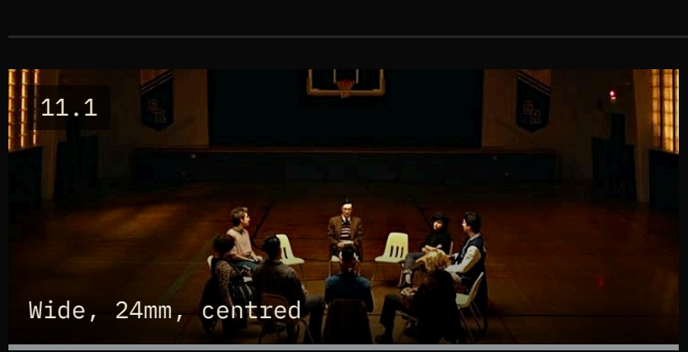
ELEANORA Even, still. Who goes first?

11

INT. LIVING ROOM - DAY (FIRST ACTIVATION)

Cali twists once, mouths 'I love you' to Cai and presses; she passes out. A row of twists, a row of clicks: one by one they follow. Eleanora mimes passing out, then twists, hand shaking, and presses. Her eyes roll back.

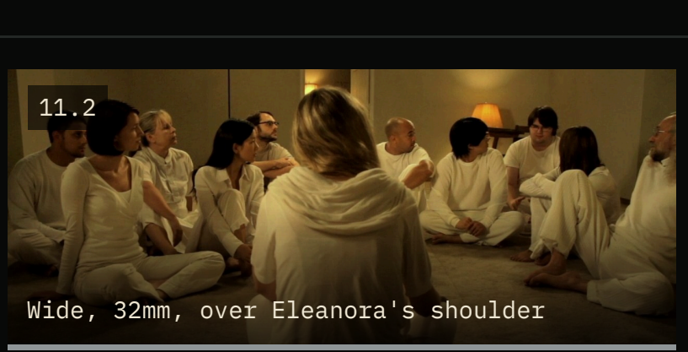
SOURCE	Script p27-28
WORLD	■ Reality
LOOK	Semicircle of seats in a long white room. Locked-off wide, then singles as each goes under.



LOCKED-OFF

A semi-circle of seats holds all but one. Eleanora is in her own chair, a little apart from the group.

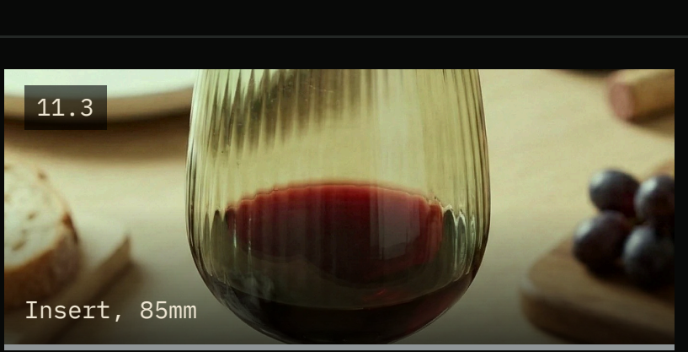
-


11.2
Wide, 32mm, over Eleanora's shoulder

STATIC

Everyone else occupies the sofa and adjacent seats, facing inward as if bracing for something unsaid. The mood shifts from jovial and tipsy to tightened.

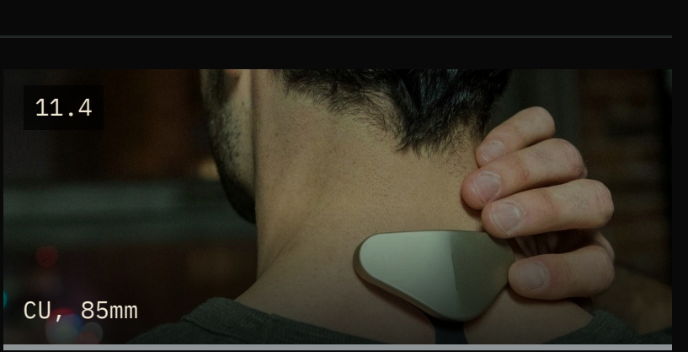
The room is still, apart from the breathing which has become heavier.



STATIC

Varyingly filled wine glasses cover the table.

-



STATIC

Cali raises her hand to the device on the back of her neck.

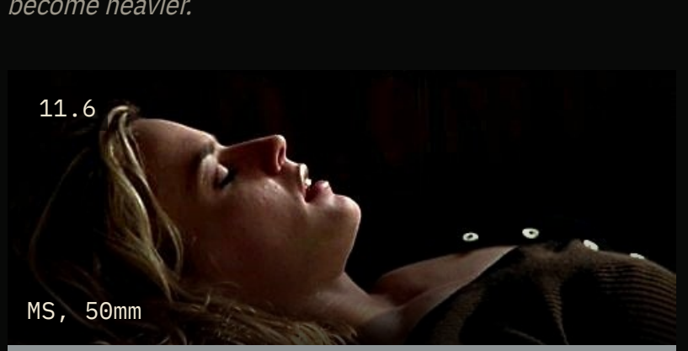
-

11.5
ECU, 100mm macro

STATIC

She twists the device clockwise until she hears the one click. Her fingers linger; Cai gives her a look of support.

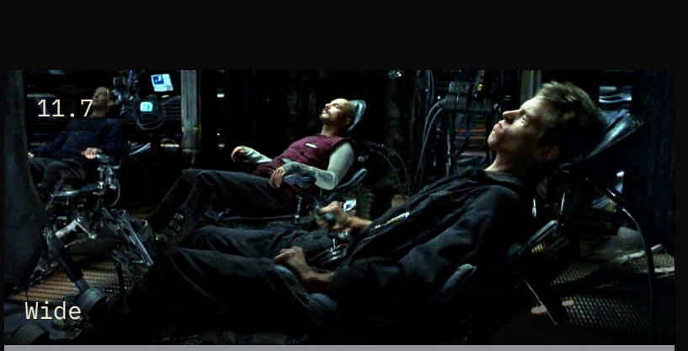
CALI One. CAI (mouths) I love you. CALI (mouths) I love you too.



STATIC

She presses the button. Instantly, her device emits a green glow in the inner circle. Immediately, Cali passes out backwards onto the sofa in an eerie way. All eyes on her.

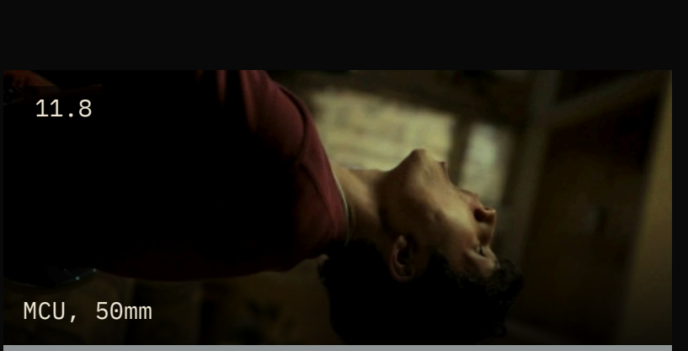
A click. Even heavier breathing from the group.



STATIC

They look to each other for support. A row of twists is heard, then a row of clicks.

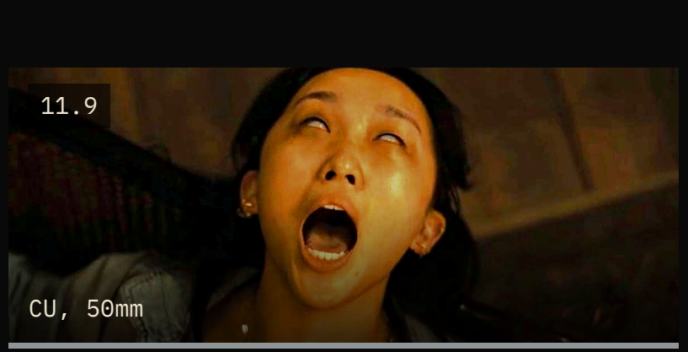
WHOLE GROUP TOGETHER One.



STATIC

One by one they all follow suit, passing out in a similar manner in different directions.

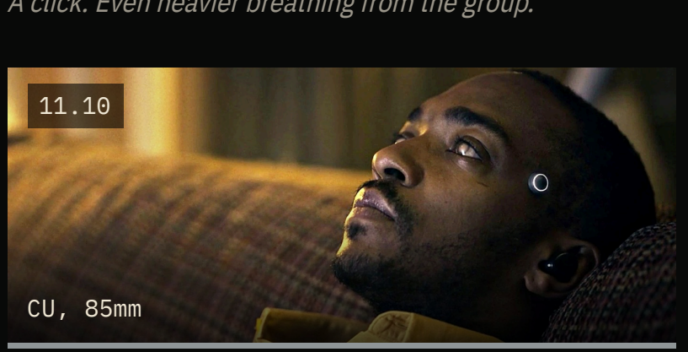
A row of clicks.



STATIC

As each goes under, eyes roll back and mouths fall open; the device takes them into OFFSET.

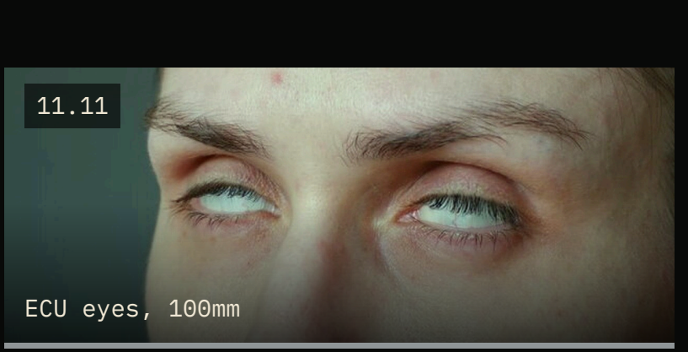
-



STATIC

Lying back on the sofa, gone under: eyes glazed, the device glowing at the temple.

-



STATIC

Eleanora surveys the room: these characters, so lively, now in complete silence. She mimes passing out, flicking her head back in a strange manner. She twists her device. Her hand shakes. Tentatively she presses. Her eyes roll back.

A loud click. CUT TO BLACK.

ACT IIA

Immersion and Erosion

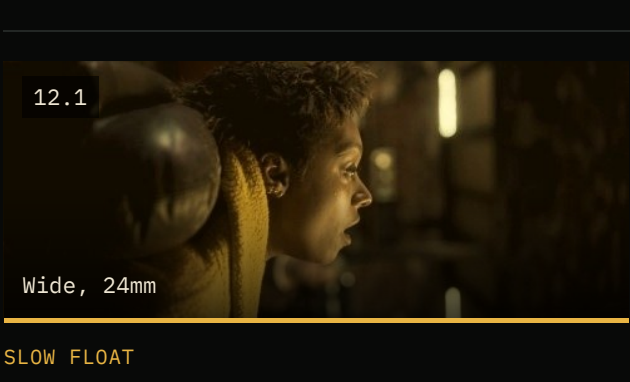
Scenes 12 to 37

12

INT. CALI'S FANTASY – LIVING ROOM / KITCHEN – NIGHT

In syrupy yellow light, Cali devours a towering chocolate cake while a mirror shows a cleaner version of her. Eleanora bites down on a nail.

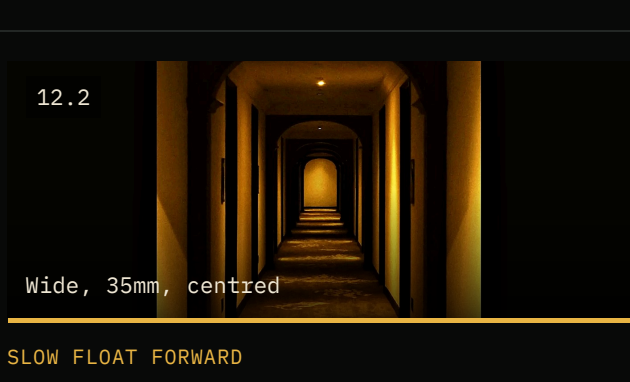
SOURCE Script p28-30
WORLD ■ Fantasy
LOOK First fantasy: warm, slow, floating camera. Food becomes grotesque.



SLOW FLOAT

Eleanora wakes in the same position. The room is dark, apart from a yellow glow emanating through the living room. She turns to the sofa, empty, and sees the group slowly moving toward something in the kitchen.

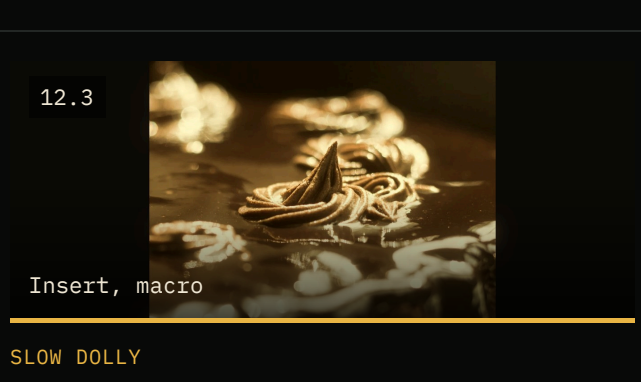
-



SLOW FLOAT FORWARD

She follows the yellow glow down the corridor toward the kitchen, breathing calmly. The house has softened. Light is syrupy.

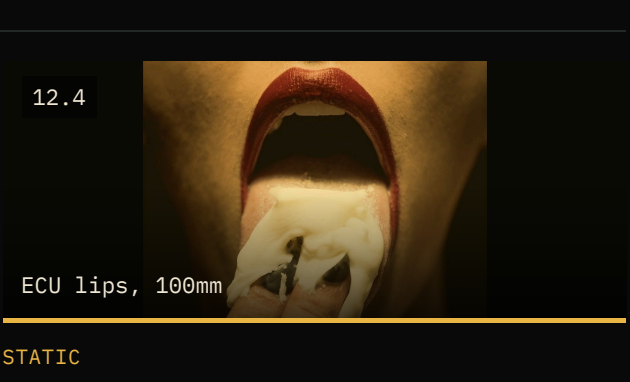
-



SLOW DOLLY

A chocolate cake sits alone on the counter. Tall, extravagant. Shimmering in the yellow light. Cali steps forward, barefoot, eyes wide.

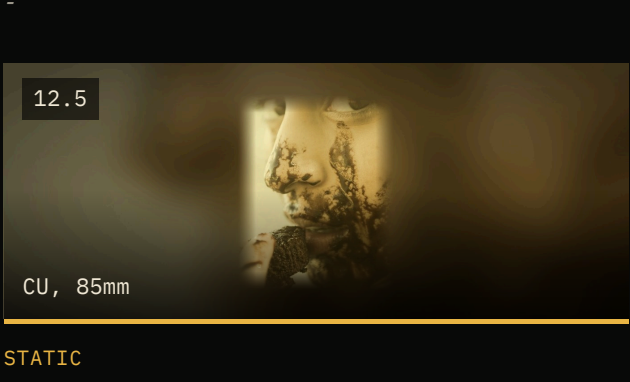
Cali giggles softly, like it's been waiting just for her.



STATIC

She glides her finger across the whole cake from bottom to top and licks it slowly, enjoying every second. Jasper takes a small taste on his pinky; Jacqueline drags her fingernail through the icing.

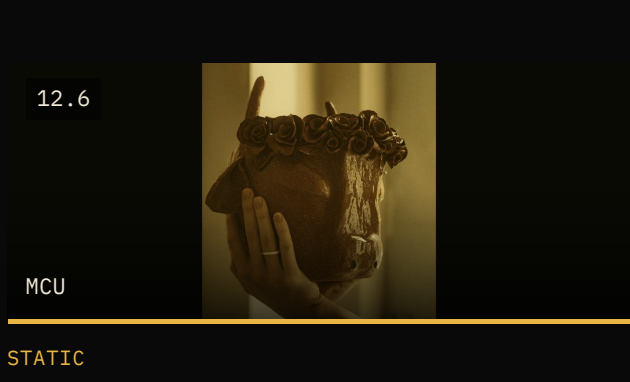
-



STATIC

Cali climbs onto the counter, sitting among the cakes. She eats with both hands now, eyes glassy, cheeks flushed. She lowers her face to the cake and shovels more and more in.

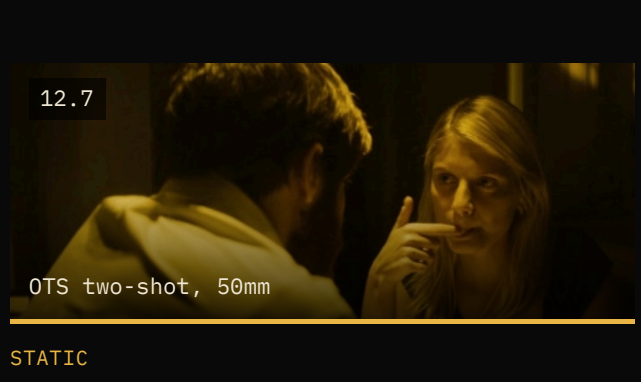
-



STATIC

A mirror appears in front of her, displaying a version of herself enjoying just one small teaspoon of a bite at a time.

-



STATIC

Eleanora takes a fresh bite from the same side, chews, crunches on something hard. She pulls a chocolate-covered nail from her mouth. Her jaw clenches in disgust.

A hard CRUNCH.

STATIC

Cai doesn't move. He watches Cali: her joy, her hunger, her unravelling. He gets a little emotional.

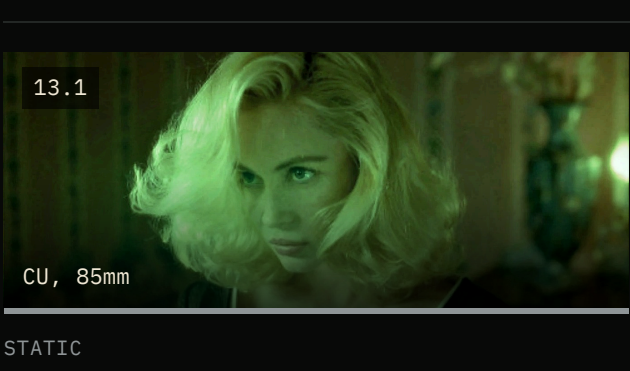
-

13

INT. LIVING ROOM – NIGHT (CALI'S CONFESSION)

Cold green replaces the yellow. Cali laughs hysterically, then talks about her mother. Jacqueline: 'Again?'

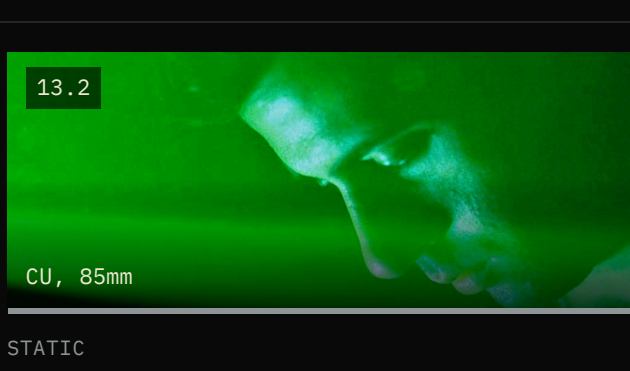
SOURCE Script p30-31
WORLD ■ Reality
LOOK Back to reality: green device light on faces in the dark.



STATIC

The yellow warming glow has been replaced with a colder green one. The rest of them appear to still be in Cali's fantasy, savouring the pure ecstasy of it all.

-



STATIC

Cali opens her eyes. All the rest come out of the system, back to the positions they were in. Cali laughs hysterically. It's so contagious everyone has a smile.

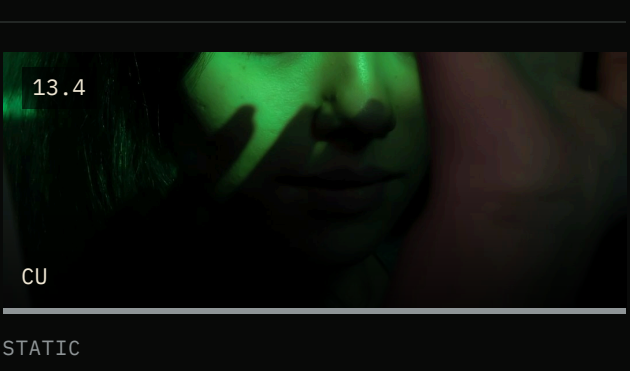
-

13.3
High wide, 24mm

STATIC

Cali has settled. The group sits around her, watching, in the cold green light. Cai sits a little closer by.

CALI My mother always said: 'Don't be greedy Cali. There is nothing in this world more unattractive than a greedy woman.' She didn't mean greedy, she meant fat. ... JACQUELINE Stunning.



STATIC

Necks fall back. TWIST. CLICK. PRESS, ACTIVATE. Eyes roll back.

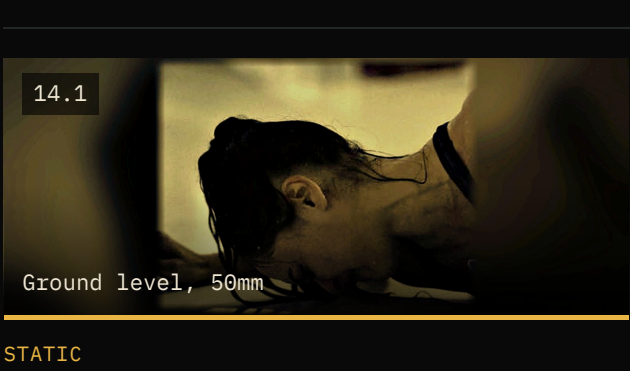
JACQUELINE Again?

14

INT. JACQUELINE'S FANTASY – BATHROOM – NIGHT

Jacqueline lies in a bath of dark, oil-like water in yellow syrup light, the group observing in silence. The pan reveals she is pregnant. Her fingers drip water; each drip slower and slower.

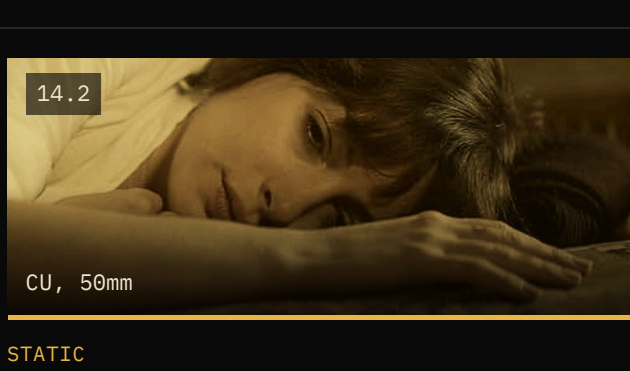
SOURCE Script p31-33
WORLD ■ Fantasy
LOOK Dark water, yellow syrup light. Stillness.



STATIC

Eleanora comes to on the floor below the bookcase, eyes opening.

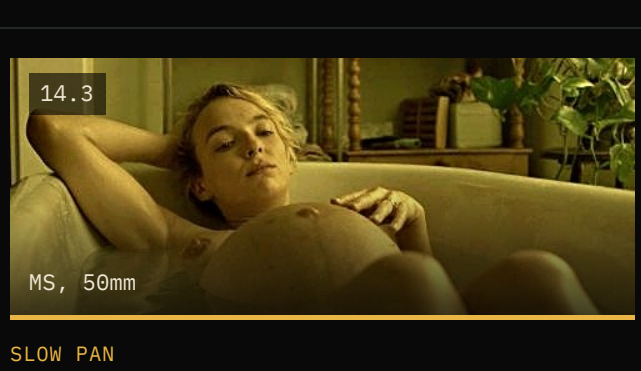
-



STATIC

She feels the back of her neck immediately: there is no device. A warm glow comes from downstairs; figures standing, watching, beckon her down.

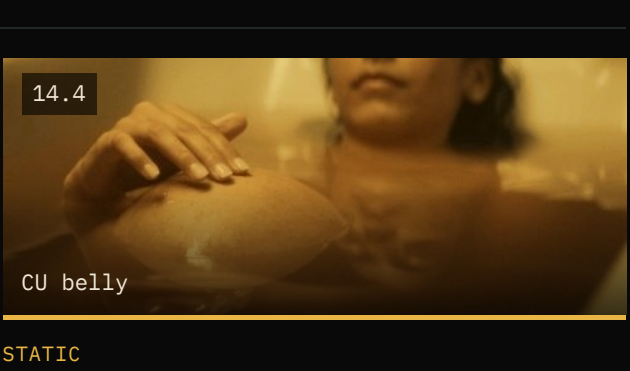
-



SLOW PAN

The bathtub is filled with dark, oil-like water, opaque and still; the yellow syrup light reflects off it. Jacqueline lies in the bath. The group stands nearby, observing in silence. As we pan we see her body is pregnant, her hand resting on the rounded belly.

-



STATIC

Her face shows a mix of uncertainty and quiet happiness. Eleanora smiles: a softer side to Jacqueline.

-

14.5
Insert macro

STATIC

Her other hand's fingers dip into the dark water and let it drip. Each drip comes slower and slower.

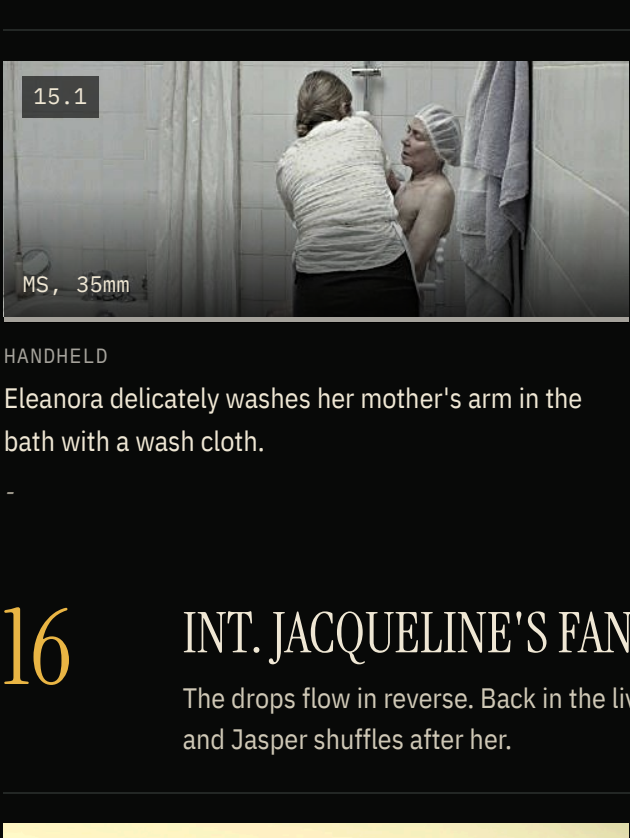
CUT TO:

15

FLASHBACK – INT. MOTHER'S FLAT – BATHROOM – DAY

Eleanora delicately washes her mother's arm in the bath, drops the cloth and grips the arm a little in frustration.

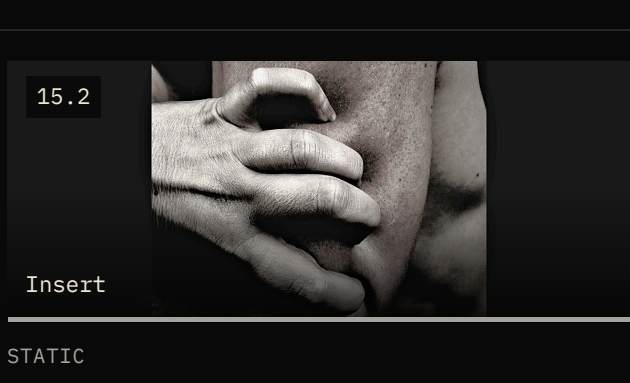
SOURCE Script p32
WORLD ■ Memory: grey
LOOK Greyish, flat, unflattering daylight. Handheld.



HANDHELD

Eleanora delicately washes her mother's arm in the bath with a wash cloth.

-



STATIC

She drops the cloth into the water and grips the arm a little in frustration.

-

16

INT. JACQUELINE'S FANTASY – BATHROOM / INT. LIVING ROOM – NIGHT

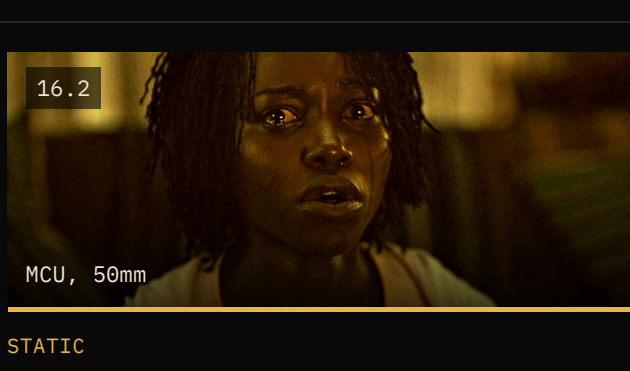
The drops flow in reverse. Back in the living room the group wakes; Jacqueline leaves the room and Jasper shuffles after her.

SOURCE Script p33
WORLD ■ Fantasy
LOOK Reverse motion, then cold green reality.

REVERSE MOTION

Eleanora watches more closely. The drops flow in reverse.

CUT TO:



STATIC

Eleanora, in a similar position, shakes her head. The group wake up all around as she pulls her hair back; she sees Jacqueline leaving the room. Jasper quickly shuffles after her.

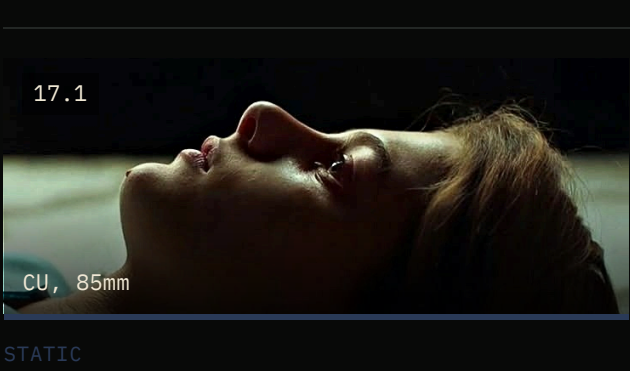
-

17

INT. RETREAT – BEDROOM – NIGHT

Eleanora lies in bed feeling the device on her neck. Another breath in the room continues after she closes her mouth. She grabs her cigarettes and heads outside.

SOURCE Script p33
WORLD ■ Night
LOOK Dark, tight, sound-led.



STATIC

Eleanora is lying in bed feeling the device on her neck. We get the feeling she's being watched. As she closes her mouth, the other breath continues. She is about to turn over, then grabs her cigarettes and heads outside.

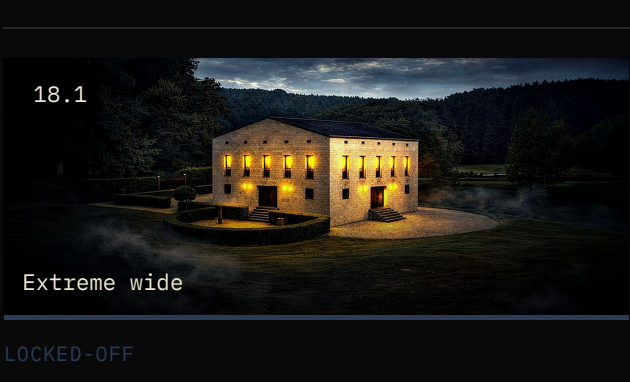
Another breath in the room.

18

EXT. RETREAT – NIGHT (EZRA ARRIVES)

Headlights burst; Ezra's silhouette looms over her on the white wall. He feels for her device, then they hug.

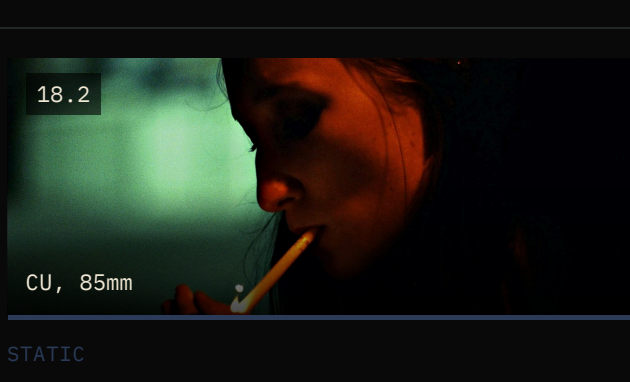
SOURCE Script p33-34
WORLD ■ Night
LOOK Hard headlight, giant shadow on the facade. Then moonlight.



LOCKED-OFF

EXT. RETREAT - NIGHT. The house in the dark, every window glowing; mist creeps across the lawn.

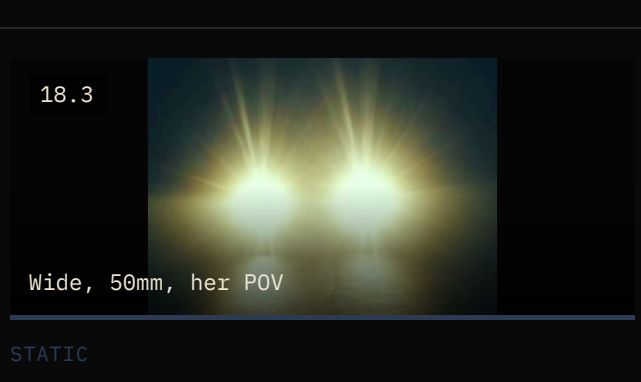
-



STATIC

Eleanora is having a cigarette in front of the house, wearing a jacket over her scrubs. She lights it.

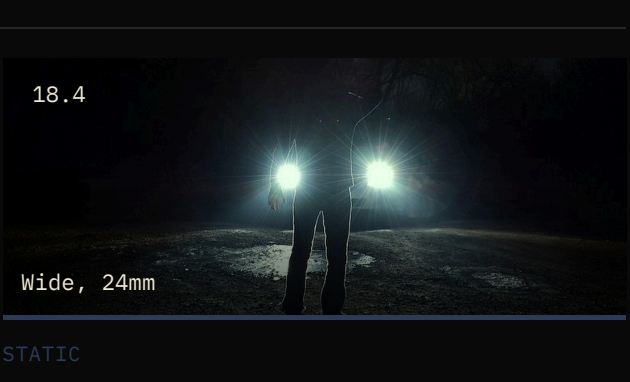
The flick of a lighter.



STATIC

Suddenly, a huge bright light bursts at her from outside.

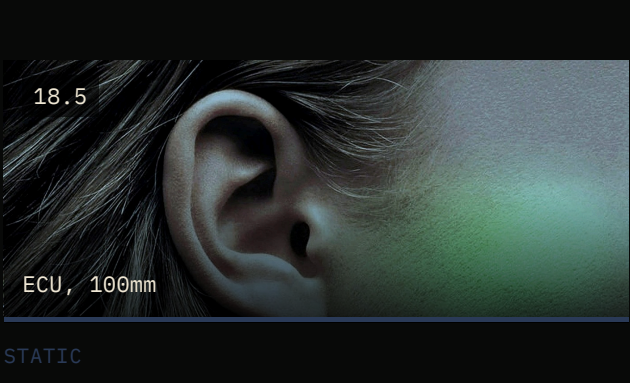
The noise of car tyres on rocks.



STATIC

The light hits the figure, creating a large silhouette against the building which looms over Eleanora, covering her in shadow. As the figure becomes clearer, we see Ezra marching forward with bag in hand.

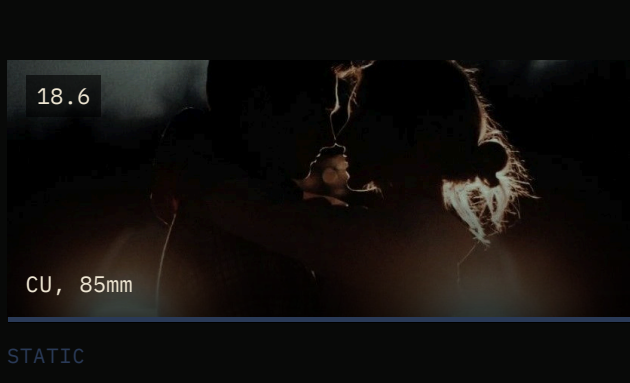
-



STATIC

Ezra makes a talking symbol with his hand, shaking his head. The car drives off. He reaches out and grabs the top of her ears and feels her neck.

A strange clicking sound from his mouth.



STATIC

They hug. Finally, some connection she knows.

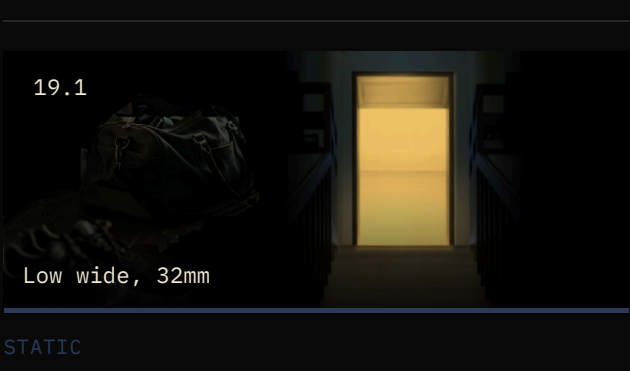
-

19

INT. ENTRANCE HALL – NIGHT

Ezra drops his bag and climbs toward the warm glow and the group's laughter.

SOURCE Script p34
WORLD ■ Night
LOOK From the shadows looking up the stair.



STATIC

Light comes from the top of the stairs. He drops his bag at the foot of the stairs. It slides to a stop near her feet.

A swift peck on the cheek. EZRA I'll be down in a minute.

19.2
Wide, 24mm

STATIC

Unfazed, Ezra heads up the stairs, drawn toward the warm glow spilling through the open doorway above. From the shadows, Eleanora watches him climb into the light.

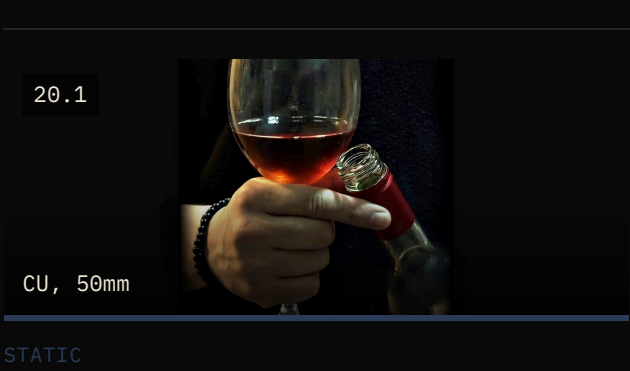
His footsteps echo loudly on the stairs.

20

INT. BEDROOM – NIGHT

Ezra stumbles in with wine. Her device lights his face green. She sees a scar on his neck and stops herself.

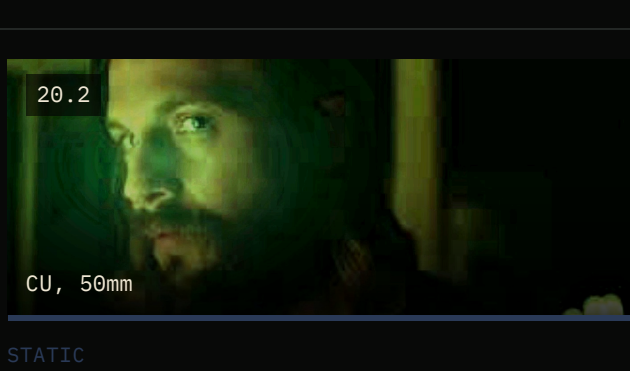
SOURCE Script p34-35
WORLD ■ Night
LOOK Green device light on skin in a dark room.



STATIC

Ezra strolls in with the end of a glass of wine. He carefully takes off his jacket and hangs it.

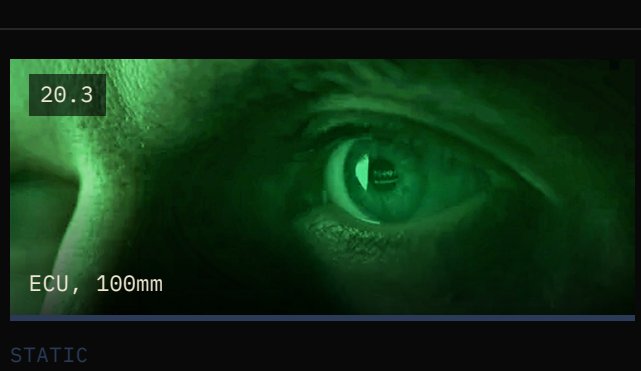
-



STATIC

He downs his wine, plants it onto the bedside table and slumps down onto the bed. He looks across at her for a moment.

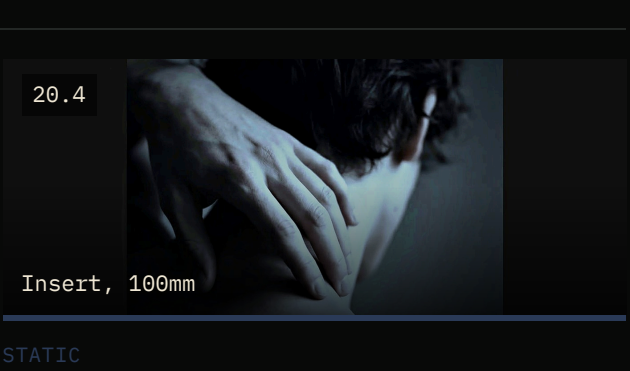
-



STATIC

His face illuminates with green light from her device. He turns away.

-



STATIC

Eleanora glances around. A very subtle scar on the back of his neck can be seen. She reaches out, only to stop herself.

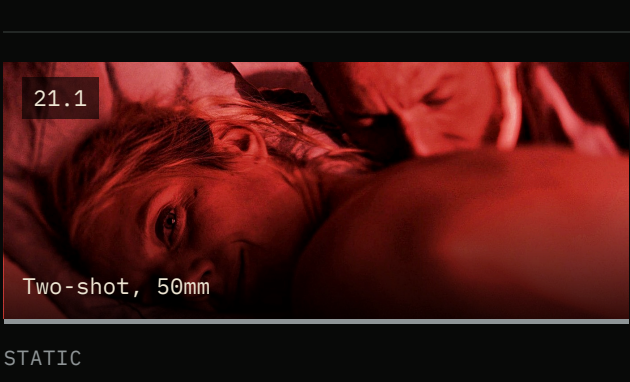
-

21

INT. BEDROOM – MORNING

Ezra wakes her for sex. Her touch is detached, procedural. Her eyes are closed.

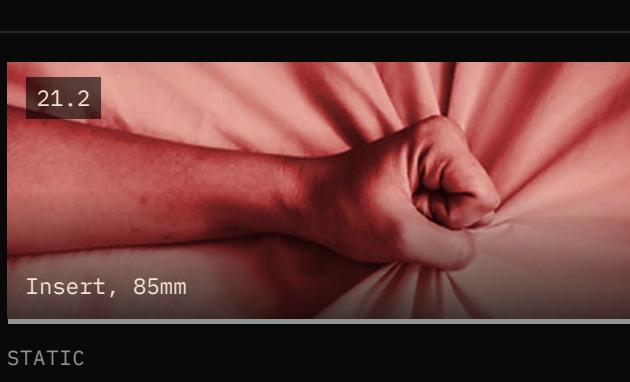
SOURCE Script p35
WORLD ■ Reality
LOOK Close and unglamorous. The kettle hum overlaps the cut.



STATIC

Ezra kisses the side of Eleanora's neck, a trace of red wine on his lips. She stiffens; she doesn't lean into him. Her gaze drifts past his shoulder.

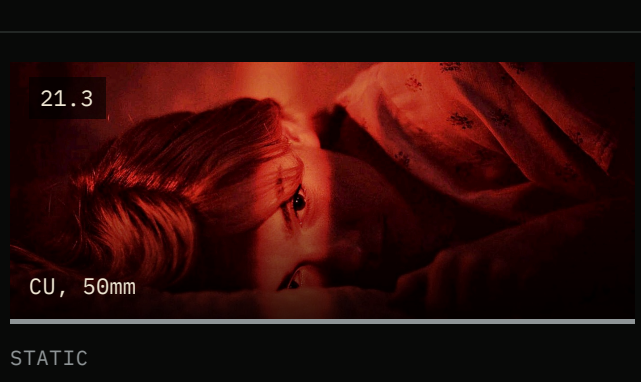
-



STATIC

Her touch is quick, detached, almost procedural. His breath catches, his body tensing; his fist clenches the sheet. Her eyes are closed.

An extra-loud climax. EZRA You're so gorgeous.



STATIC

Eleanora now remains still, eyes open, half her face in the pillow. She exhales off the side of the bed.

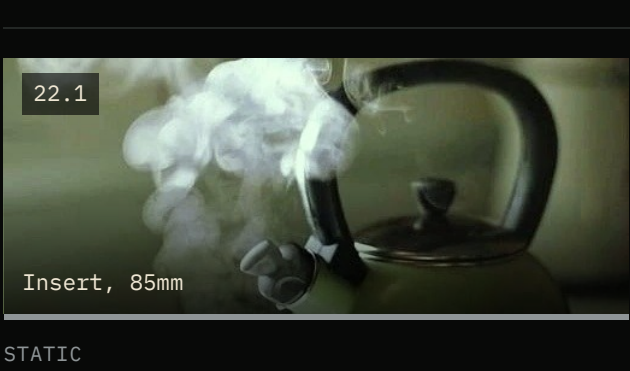
The rising hum of a kettle.

22

INT. RETREAT – LIVING ROOM – DAY

The kettle clicks off. Ezra, his device already fitted ('Flo helped'), eats grapes from the old feast. Flo pours Eleanora boiling water in a green mug. Jacqueline mouths 'Stray'. Ezra grabs Eleanora: 'Glücklich?'

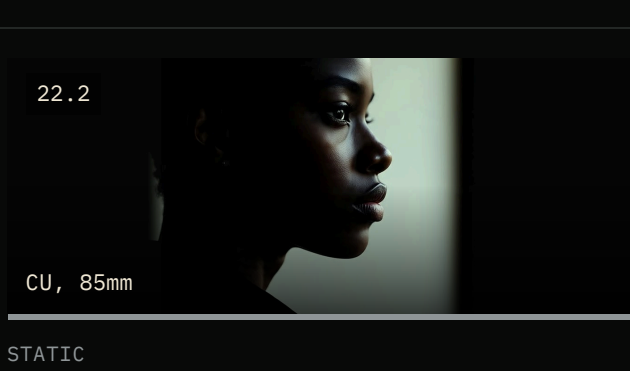
SOURCE Script p35-39
WORLD ■ Reality
LOOK Clean daylight; Ezra centred, Eleanora edge of frame.



STATIC

The kettle clicks off; steam curls from the spout. Flo pours boiling water into a green, see-through mug.

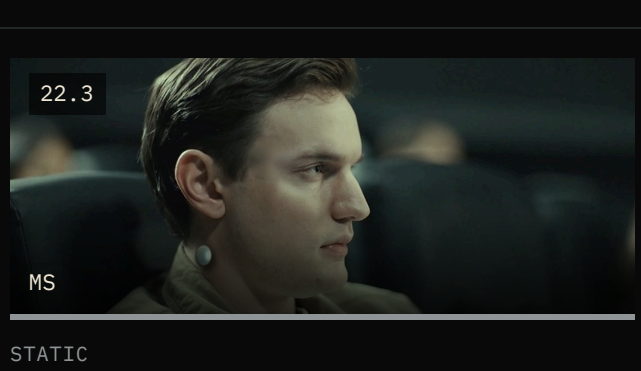
FLO You want your water hot. It makes you feel like you're having a cup of tea. ELEANORA Yeah. Hot is fine. FLO No 'thanks'? ELEANORA Thank you.



STATIC

Jacqueline walks decisively towards Ezra, then turns to Eleanora alone and mouths the word. Ezra shakes his head.

JACQUELINE And you brought a 'friend.' (mouths) Stray. EZRA And thank god.



STATIC

Ezra now has the device on his neck. He walks towards Eleanora.

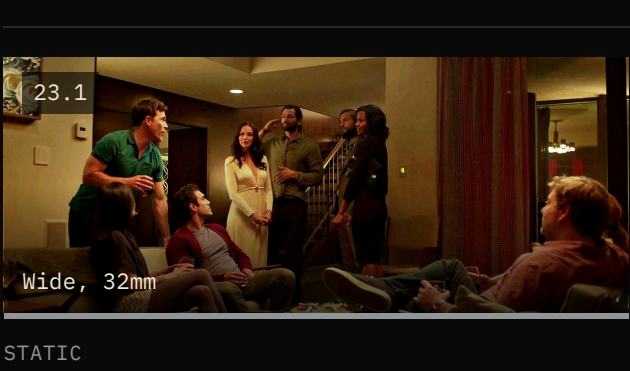
ELEANORA How did you do that? EZRA They left me instructions. And Flo helped. ... (Announcing) This is going to help you know? ELEANORA I know. I'm grateful. EZRA Glücklich? ELEANORA Glücklich. EZRA You ready?

23

INT. LIVING ROOM – BALCONY DOOR – DAY

Voices fade. A cigarette. Twist. Click. She falls forward onto a table.

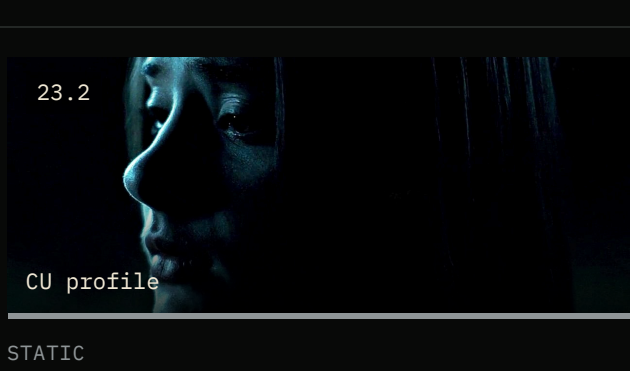
SOURCE Script p39
WORLD ■ Reality
LOOK Sound bridge: the draw of a cigarette cut against the device.



STATIC

The group chatters in the living room. Eleanora moves away toward the balcony door.

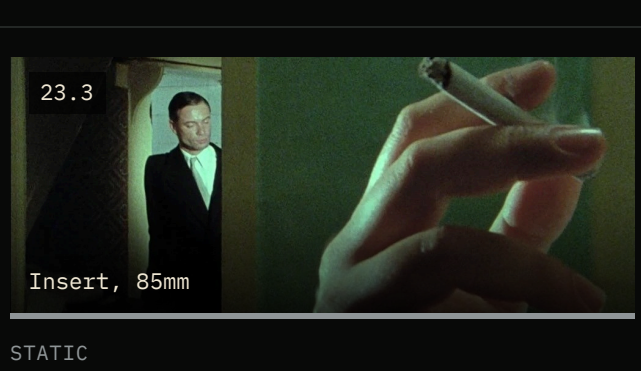
Overlapping chatter, fading until the words are lost.



STATIC

Eleanora at the balcony door, pensive, bracing for what is to come. A cigarette in her hand.

Inhale. The sound of the draw. A TWIST.



STATIC

The cigarette between her fingers, smoke curling up at the balcony door.

-

HANDHELD

Smoke from her lips; breathing heavier; she falls forward.

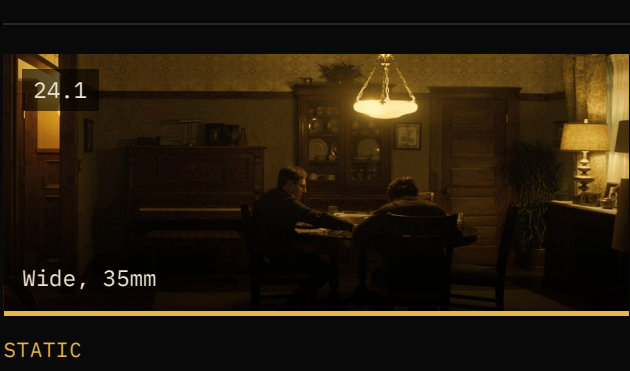
A CLICK.

24

INT. ELEANORA'S FANTASY – DINING ROOM – NIGHT

The room becomes her mother's flat. Mother is well and joyful. The table glides away from the group; their mouths are sealed.

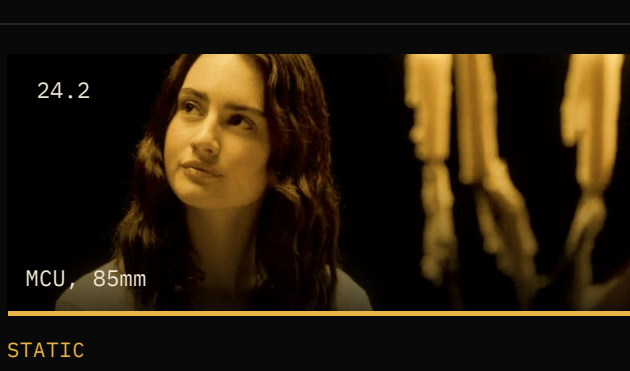
SOURCE Script p39-40
WORLD ■ Fantasy
LOOK Candlelit yellow syrup. The group watches from a doorway, as if through someone's eyes.



STATIC

A small candlelit table in the corner, dressed as Mother's flat.

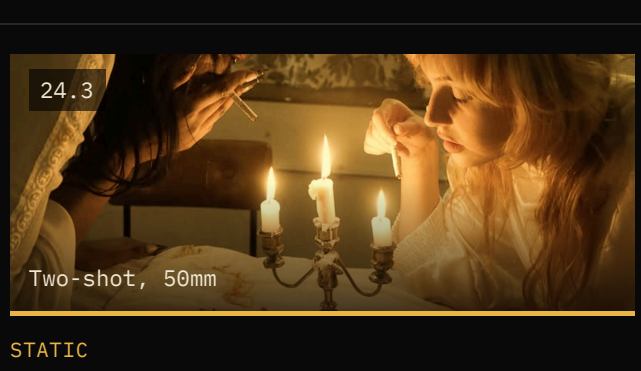
-



STATIC

Eleanora looks down at her plate, almost finished bar one last bite. She looks up to see her Mother smiling from ear to ear.

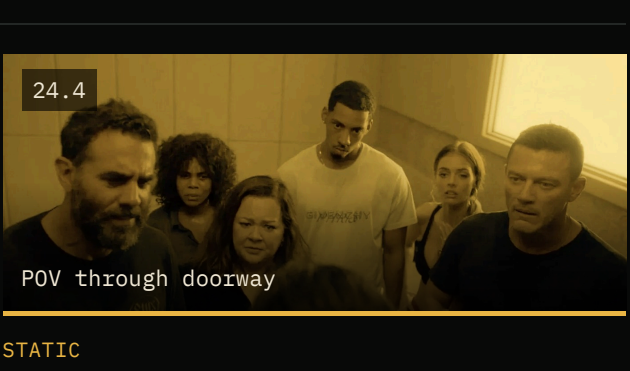
-



STATIC

Mother smiles, full of life. They laugh and hug.

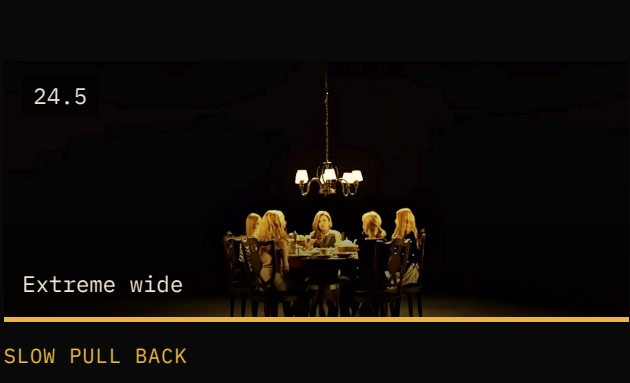
ELEANORA Aunque no seas real, igual quiero abrazarte.



STATIC

The group watches. Ezra leans in, analysing.

-



SLOW PULL BACK

Immediately the table glides away from the group, carrying Eleanora and her Mother with it, alone in the dark.

Rush of air.

STATIC

The group's mouths are sealed shut; they can only watch.

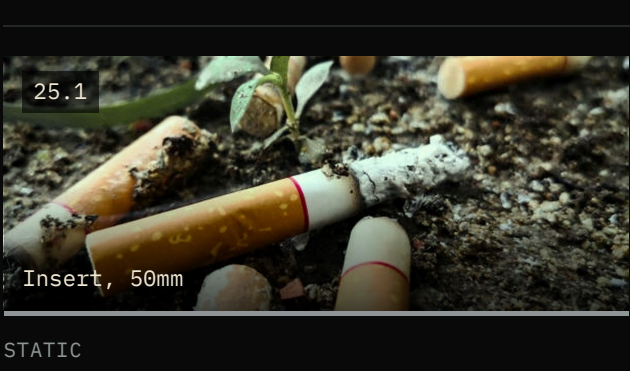
Rush of air.

25

EXT. RETREAT – DAY

Chain-smoking, Eleanora repeats 'No eres mi madre' as Ezra's questions echo. She follows the group, stops and turns away. A TWIST, a CLICK: she drops backward to the floor from the same position.

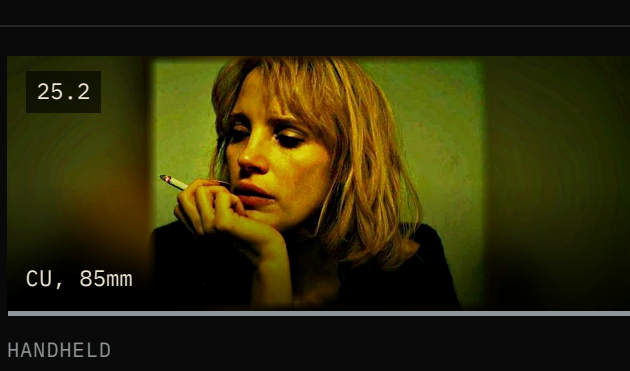
SOURCE Script p41-42
WORLD ■ Reality
LOOK Exterior steps, handheld, nervous.



STATIC

A few cigarettes are on the floor already.

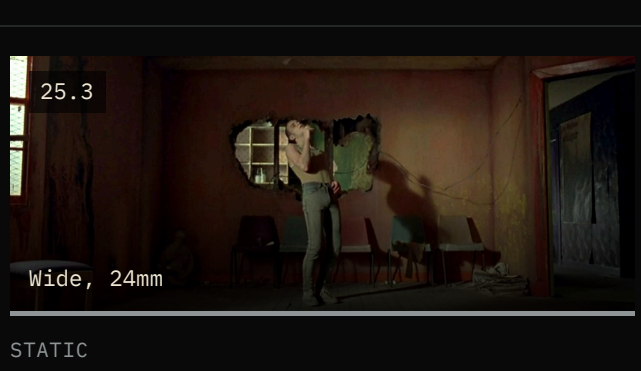
-



HANDHELD

Eleanora is fidgety. Hurrying through each cigarette, she repeats something to herself under her breath. She feels guilty, unsure how she can approach the group.

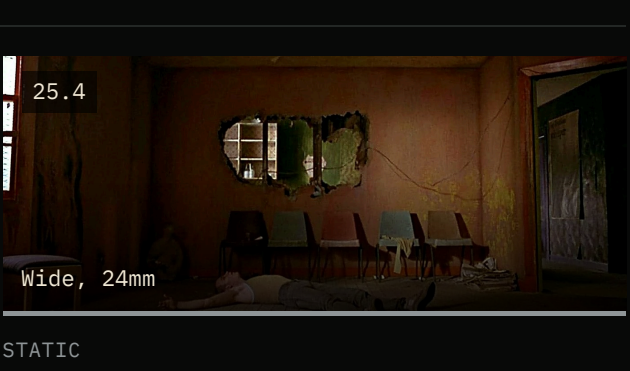
EZRA (V.O.) Do you love her? ELEANORA (V.O.) Yes. ELEANORA (rushing and unclear) No eres mi madre. EZRA (V.O.) Do you resent her? ELEANORA (V.O.) No... Yes. ELEANORA ¡No eres mi madre!



STATIC

She hears the group move down the stairs, laughing and jovial. She stubs her half cigarette on the edge of the steps and follows them slightly; they vanish out of sight. She stops and turns away. Suddenly she starts to turn.

A TWIST.



STATIC

She drops backward to the floor from the same position.

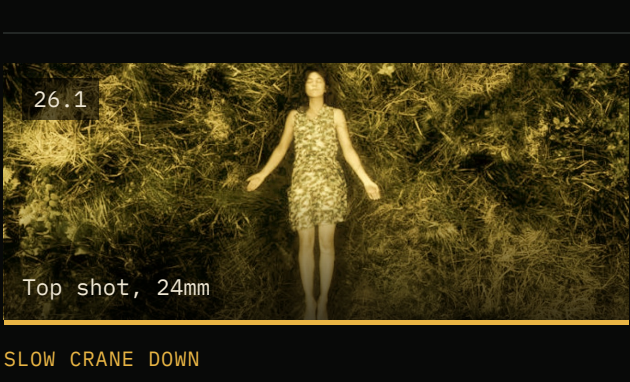
A CLICK.

26

EXT. FOREST CLEARING – CAI'S FANTASY (INTERCUT MOTHER'S FLAT)

Eleanora floats down into Cai's forest; trees rise and settle under a yellow sky. Jacqueline calls her a little chameleon while Mother's accusations from the flat intercut. Eleanora backs away as the grass envelopes the seven like a grave, and they enjoy it.

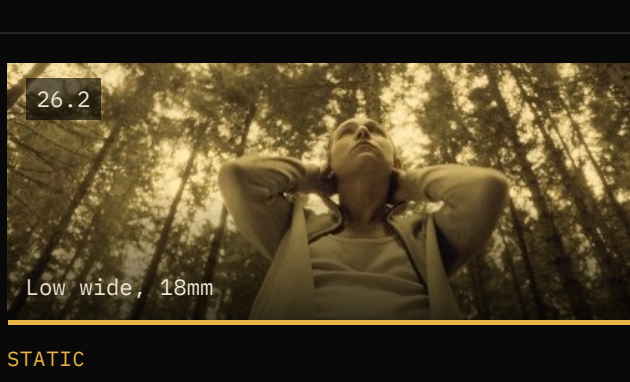
SOURCE Script p42-45
WORLD ■ Fantasy
LOOK Impossible greens and a yellow sky. Top shots of bodies in grass. Intercut grey, harsh memory of the flat.



SLOW CRANE DOWN

JUMP CUT TO: Cai's fantasy. Eleanora floats across the ground, then gently lands on the grass.

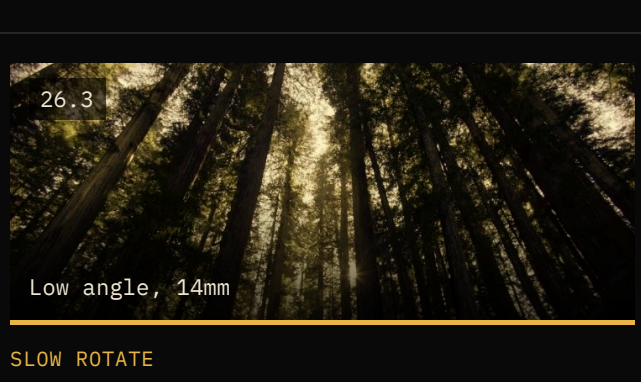
-



STATIC

The space subtly shifts: the environment morphs into tall trees that rise and settle into place. Light filters through the branches, unreal but calming. She senses something slightly wrong beneath the beauty.

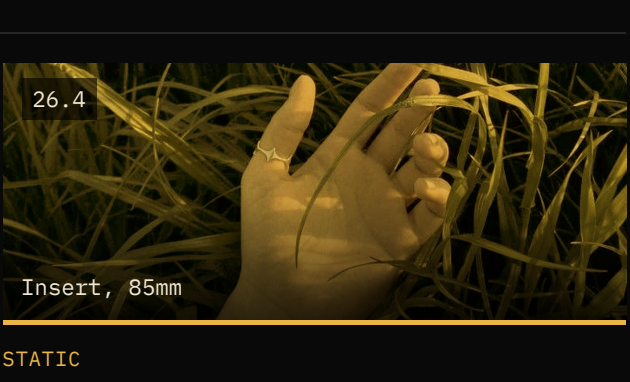
-



SLOW ROTATE

Tall trees rise and settle into place; light filters through the branches.

-



STATIC

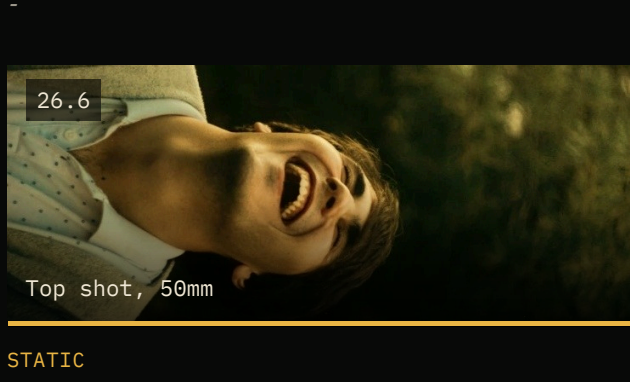
As she gently lands, her hands grip onto the grass.

-

STATIC

Cai looks up at the yellow sky. He drops to the ground, fingers pressing into the grass as if to anchor himself, nerves tingling in euphoria. Ezra sits above them on the hill. Cali sits quietly with a soft, dreamy smile.

CAI Connect. Disconnect. Reconnect.



STATIC

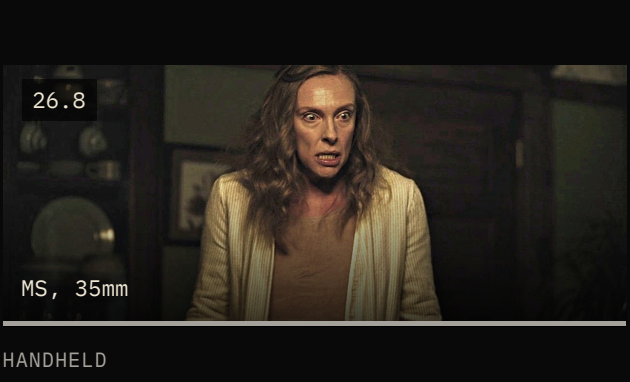
Cai lies back in the grass, laughing, nerves tingling in euphoria.

-

STATIC

Eleanora turns to Jacqueline, who lies beside her.

ELEANORA What do you think of me? JACQUELINE Honest. You're a little chameleon. Unsure which colour to change to. You've been through some things... Not sure why you're here?



HANDHELD

FLASHBACK: Mother is irate, panicked, rambling; when she makes eye contact it looks fearful rather than spiteful.

MOTHER Always disappearing like that. They don't like you. Why can't you fit in? Is there something wrong with you? They never come to see you. ELEANORA They never came to see me.

STATIC

Cali shades her face with a fern-like hand. The group is quiet; they all turn away from her. Their faces blur in and out of focus.

ELEANORA Who did you lose? CALI She was just asleep under a fern... It was me... maybe it was you. CAI You can trust us.

26.10
Top shot

SLOW CRANE UP

Eleanora moves in reverse away from the group, eyes darting. Cai lets out an ecstatic breath; they all lie back, sinking into the grass. The grass envelopes them like a grave: seven bodies being swallowed up, but they are enjoying it.

ELEANORA (under her breath) Could you just bring me back though, please?

26.11
Top shot, 50mm

SLOW CRANE UP

Jacqueline lies back, eyes closed, laughing as the grass envelopes her: swallowed up, but enjoying it.

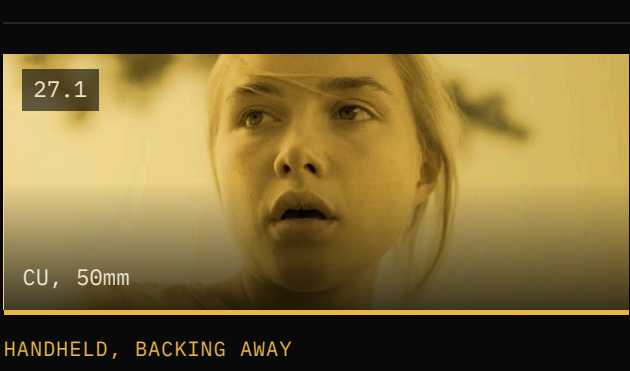
-

27

INT. CAI'S FANTASY – BATHROOM / BLACK WATER

Eleanora vomits into the toilet; a hand holds her hair, then grips. The hands are covered in tubes and force her in. Black water: she swims toward a glowing green door, then curls up and surrenders.

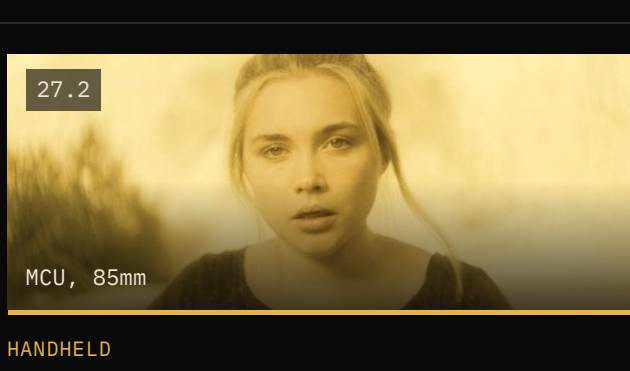
SOURCE Script p45-46
WORLD ■ Fantasy
LOOK Reverse shot from the woods into the bathroom. Underwater: black, one green door.



HANDHELD, BACKING AWAY

As Eleanora walks away from the group, in the background the seven bodies are swallowed up by the grass, enjoying it. She reaches the property and rushes inside.

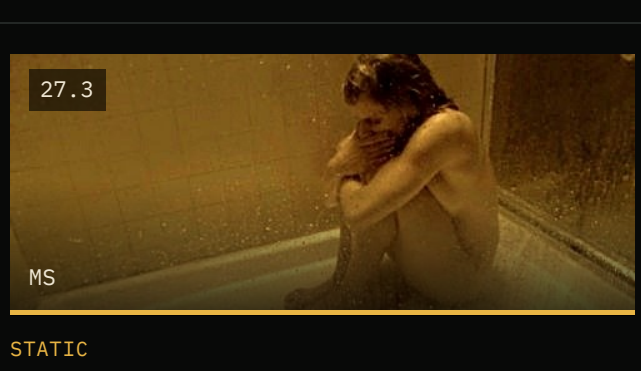
-



HANDHELD

She stares back at the group, stunned, as she backs away toward the property.

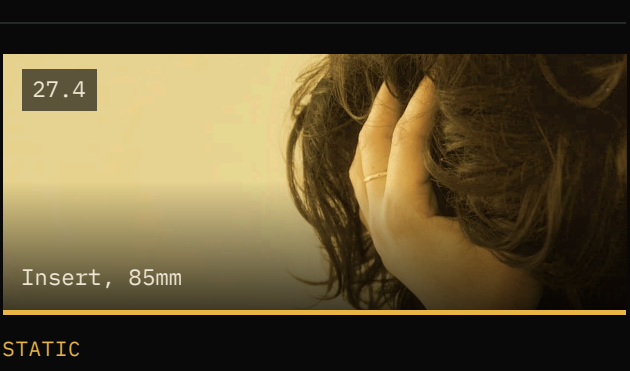
-



STATIC

Eleanora finally reaches the property and vomits into the closest toilet. A hand comes from behind her, holding her hair gently at first.

ELEANORA Thank you.



STATIC

The hand grabs onto her hair a little rougher.

-

27.5
ECU, 100mm

STATIC

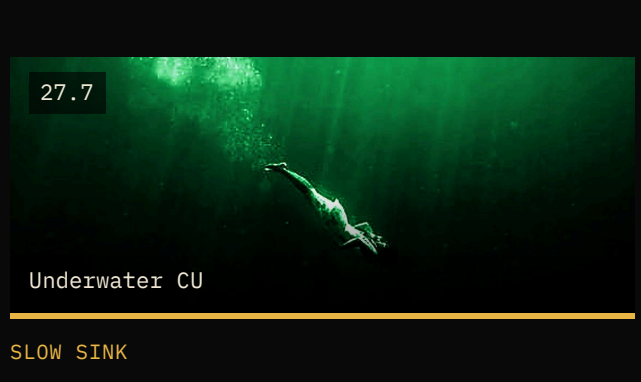
Her head is pulled back by the hair. Sweat beads across her throat. Eleanora reaches back...

-

STATIC

She reaches back: the hands are covered in tubes. They grab her hair and push her head into the toilet, further and further in.

-



SLOW SINK

Black water surrounds Eleanora. She swims toward a glowing green door below. Bubbles escape her lips; realisation comes over her face as she scrambles toward the surface. Her eyes close. Out of breath, she gives in, curls into herself and surrenders to the depths.

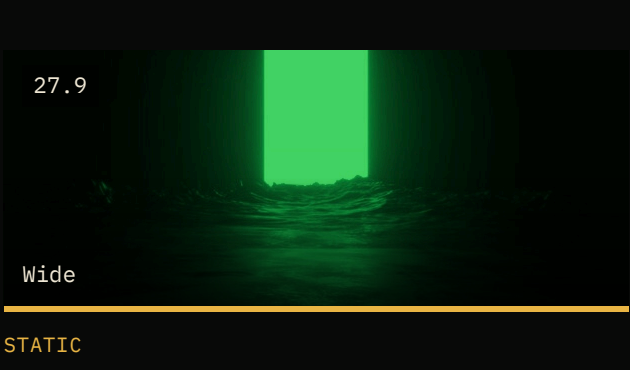
JUMP CUT TO:

27.8
Wide, overhead

SLOW SINK

Black water surrounds Eleanora. She swims down toward the glowing green door below.

-



STATIC

The glowing green door at the bottom of the black water, below.

-

27.10
Wide, 35mm, floor level

STATIC

JUMP CUT TO: INT. BATHROOM - NIGHT. Back in reality: curled up in the same position, she breathes, gasping for air.

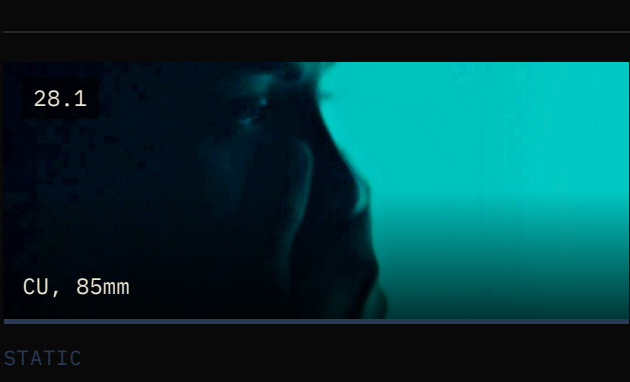
Gasping.

28

INT. BATHROOM – NIGHT

Curled against the wall, gasping, soaked, her head bleeding slightly. She feels the device: relief. Music upstairs.

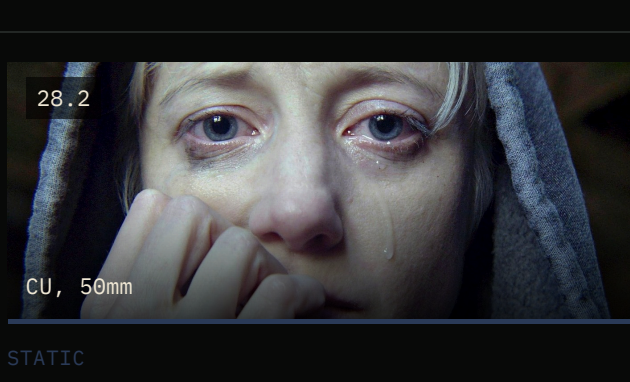
SOURCE Script p46
WORLD ■ Night
LOOK Cold, wet, real.



STATIC

INT. BATHROOM - NIGHT. In the dark, she breathes, gasping and coughing for air. The yellow dreamy hue is gone.

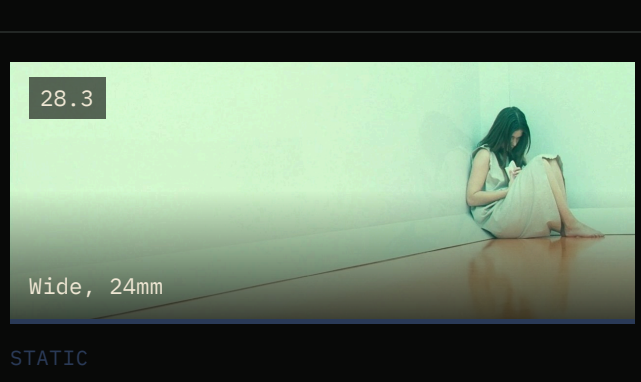
Gasping, coughing.



STATIC

Back against the wall, she gets her breath back and pushes her wet hair behind her ears. She feels the device attached: a wave of relief washes over her. Soaked in her scrubs, her head bleeding slightly from the top.

Music coming from upstairs.



STATIC

She sits alone in the corner against the wall, knees drawn up, soaked in her scrubs.

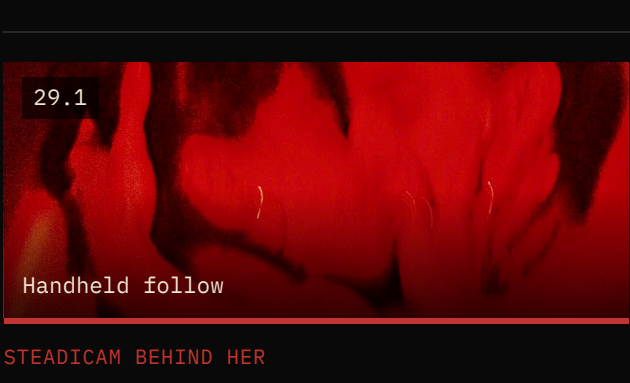
Music coming from upstairs.

29

INT. LIVING ROOM – NIGHT (PARTY) / FLASHBACK

Jacqueline mouths 'Stray'. The song switches to 'It's All Coming Back to Me Now'; Eleanora dances in the red light, crying, intercut with dancing for her frail mother. Ezra and Frans enjoy the chaos.

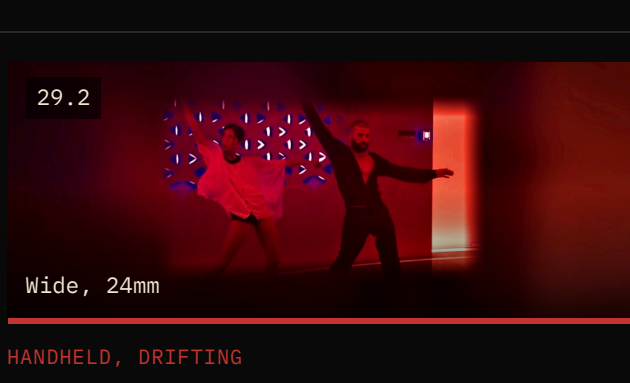
SOURCE Script p46-47
WORLD ■ Party
LOOK Red-washed, handheld, circling. The flashback of dancing for Mother is soft white.



STEADICAM BEHIND HER

We follow her through the small party in full swing. A handful of the group dance, bodies close, the room washed in red light. Jacqueline catches Eleanora's eye.

Music plays loud. JACQUELINE (mouths) STRAY.



HANDHELD, DRIFTING

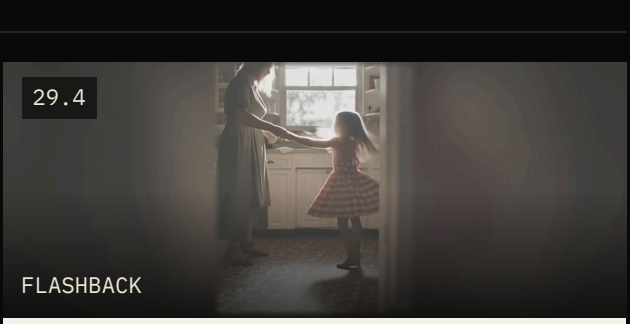
Music plays loud in the space. A handful of the group dance. Bodies close, the room washed in red light.

Music plays loud.

CIRCLING

Eleanora smiles, unfazed, then steps into the middle of the room and begins to dance.

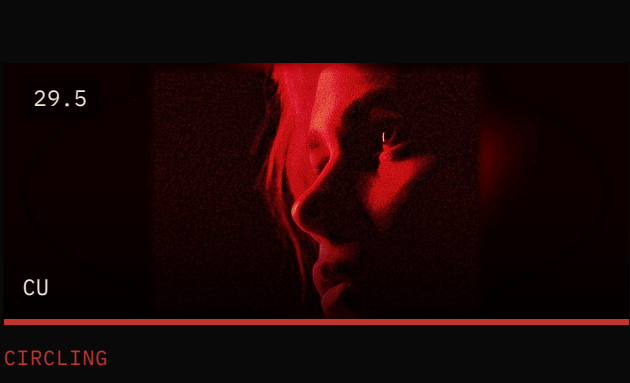
The song switches to 'It's All Coming Back to Me Now'.



HANDHELD

FLASHBACK: Eleanora dancing for her mum, silly, playful, trying to make her laugh. Mother, frailer, still mirrors her movements in a smaller fashion; when she spins, she twirls her fingers.

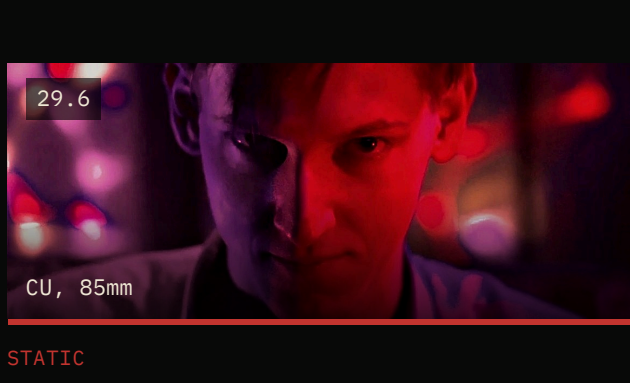
-



CIRCLING

Under the red light, Eleanora keeps dancing. Tears run down her face, but she doesn't stop. She's dancing and crying at the same time.

-



STATIC

Darting eyes across the room between the group. Ezra is enjoying the chaos of the whole scene, as is Frans.

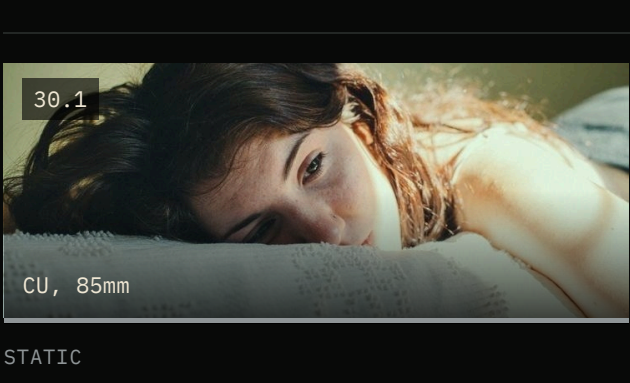
-

30

INT. BEDROOM – MORNING

An echoing scream gets quieter. Morning light breaks through. Eleanora lies with a vacant stare, hand on the device.

SOURCE Script p47
WORLD ■ Reality
LOOK Hard white daylight.



STATIC

Morning light breaks through with the sharpness of day. Eleanora lies on the bed with a vacant stare; her hand touches her neck and the device.

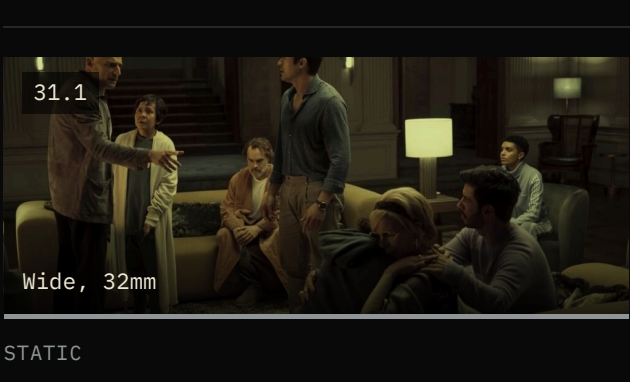
An echoing scream gradually gets quieter.

31

INT. LIVING ROOM – MORNING

The group gossips about 'the stray' in German and Danish. Eleanora confronts Cai, then finds scratches in the balcony's metal ledge and asks about the other building: 'where they store the batteries'.

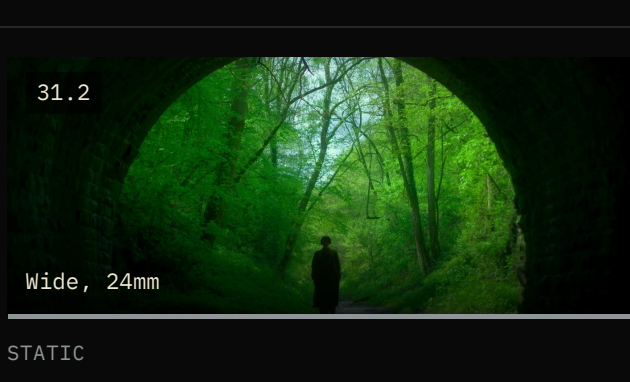
SOURCE Script p47-52
WORLD ■ Reality
LOOK Group in one frame, Eleanora in the doorway. Insert of scratches. The outhouse glimpsed.



STATIC

The group talks about her in German and Danish. Eleanora stands in the doorway.

EZRA It's been group therapy so far, no? FLO Ja, hvad var der med den strejfer? EZRA Ich habe gesagt, es wird alles gut. ELEANORA Could you not see I was uncomfortable? JASPER No one sits out. EZRA That's the point.



STATIC

Eleanora opens the door to get some fresh air, a dark silhouette against the green outside.

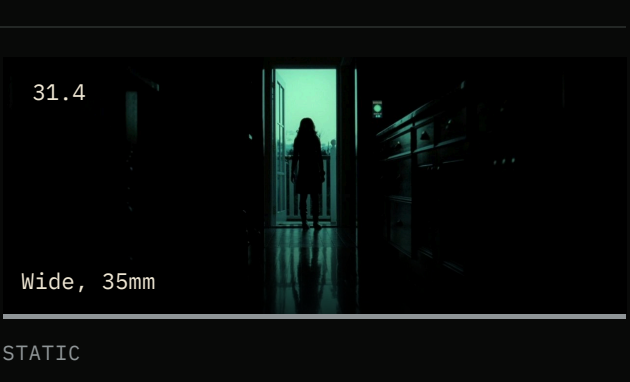
-

31.3
Insert, 100mm macro

SLOW TRACK

She holds onto the metal ledge and notices some scratches in the metal; her fingers trail across them.

CALI You should close that? CAI I don't like it open either.



STATIC

Eleanora stands at the open balcony door at the end of the dark room, looking out. She glances back out as she is closing it over: the other building.

ELEANORA What's the other building? CALI It's like an outhouse. CAI It's where they store the batteries. ... They last for ages. CALI He told us so we wouldn't go in. ELEANORA So who would? CAI Exactly. No one.

32

INT. BEDROOM – DAY

Ezra faces Eleanora on the bed; she reluctantly meets him halfway. They grab each other's devices. He presses hers first.

SOURCE Script p52-53
WORLD ■ Reality
LOOK Symmetrical two-shot.

32.1
Wide, centred

STATIC

Ezra sits facing Eleanora on the bed. He leans forward; she reluctantly meets him halfway. They both grab each other's devices. He nods. Ezra presses her device first.

TWIST. CLICK. JUMP CUT TO:

33

INT. ELEANORA'S FANTASY – BEDROOM / DINING ROOM – NIGHT

Ezra at the table, everything far too close. Mother accuses Eleanora of bringing him to embarrass her, holds her ears and screams 'GET OUT'. Then Ezra and Eleanora on opposite sides of a bed; nothing is said.

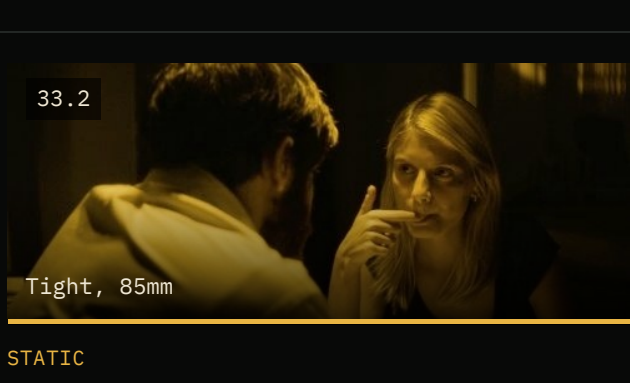
SOURCE Script p53-54
WORLD ■ Fantasy
LOOK Long-lens compression, claustrophobic.

33.1
Wide, centred

STATIC

JUMP CUT TO: Eleanora's fantasy, revisited. Ezra sits facing Eleanora, mirrored, in her world now.

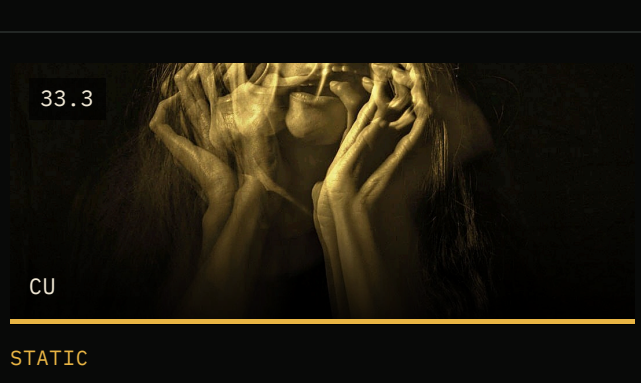
-



STATIC

Ezra is now seated at the table. Everything feels far too close. They are all almost pressed together.

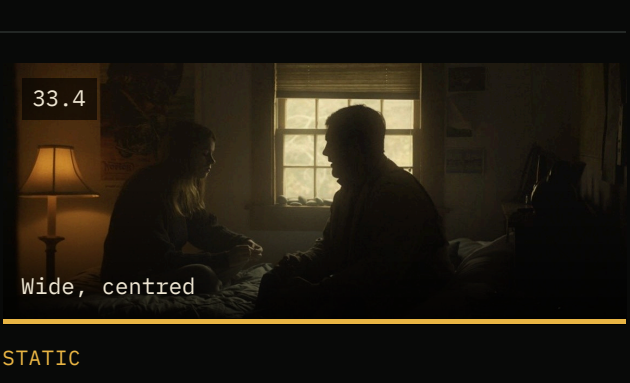
MOTHER You brought him here to embarrass me. ELEANORA No lo es. MOTHER You are making a show of your own Mother. I didn't raise you like this.



STATIC

The Mother becomes increasingly agitated; she holds her ears and screams.

MOTHER GET OUT!



STATIC

Ezra and Eleanora sit on opposite sides of the bed. Eleanora holds her emotion well. Nothing is said. Ezra faces the door.

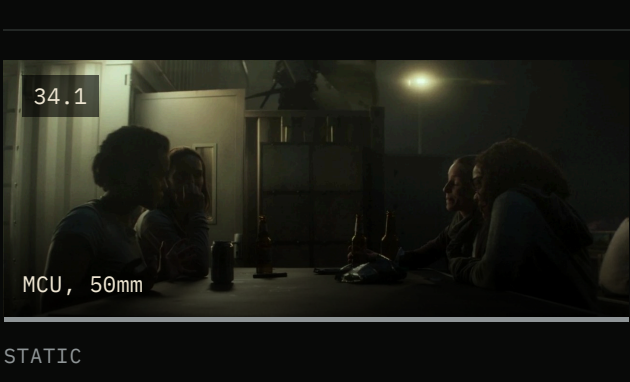
-

34

INT. LIVING ROOM – DAY (EZRA'S STORY) / JASPER'S FANTASY

Eleanora walks in on Ezra telling his 'leading man' story; her leg shakes. Jasper applauds. Flashes of Jasper's fantasy: hands erupt from the darkness, claiming him. 'Nothing major to report.'

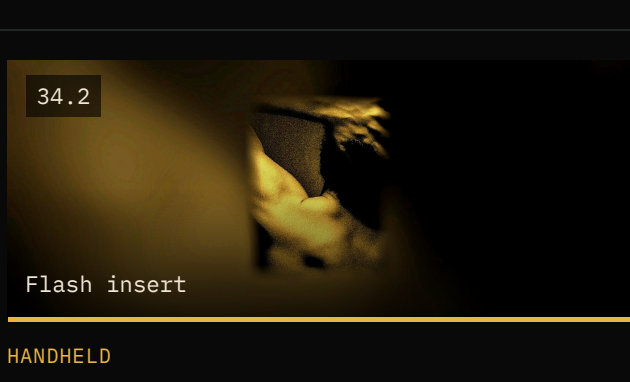
SOURCE Script p54-56
WORLD ■ Reality
LOOK Ezra centred and lit; flash cuts to darkness.



STATIC

Eleanora walks in on Ezra telling a story. She sits, her leg shaking from the experience. Ezra is completely at ease, reciting a story he takes great joy in. Small applause from Jasper.

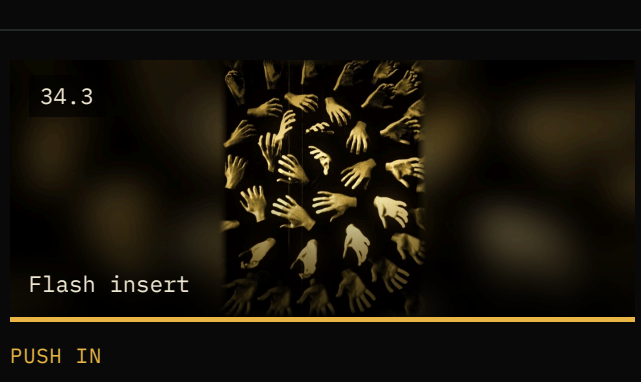
EZRA They say leading man. Like it's a burden... I didn't want to be cheered or whatever, champion of the fucking people. JASPER Man of the people. EZRA ...I wanted him to know that his card is marked.



HANDHELD

INTERCUT: FLASHES OF JASPER'S FANTASY. Hands erupt from the darkness, brushing, clutching, scratching, claiming every inch of him. Jasper's breath quickens, eyes closing, swallowed by the void.

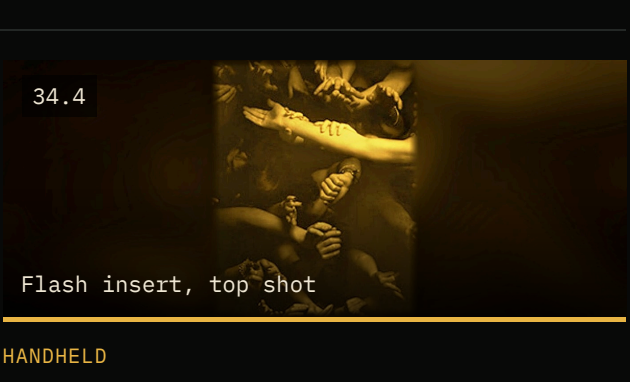
JASPER Nothing major to report. ELEANORA Then it's you.



PUSH IN

Hands erupt from the darkness, reaching for Jasper.

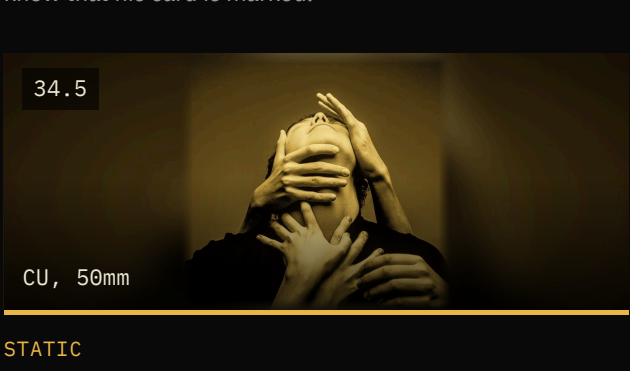
-



HANDHELD

Brushing, clutching, scratching, claiming every inch of him; he is swallowed by the void.

-



STATIC

Hands at his throat and face; Jasper's head tips back, his breath quickening, eyes closing.

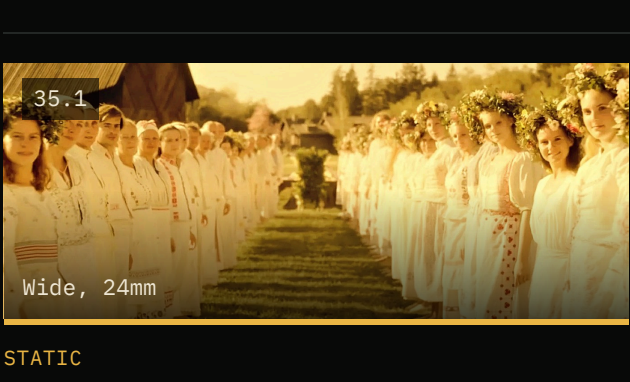
-

35

INT. / EXT. EZRA'S FANTASY – HOUSE / FOREST – DAY

Eleanora follows clapping out of the house: a crowd in white claps aggressively for Ezra in full stage make-up. She finds her Mother cheering at the front and drags her away. Mother remembers the day at the cinema as perfect; Eleanora remembers it as the worst.

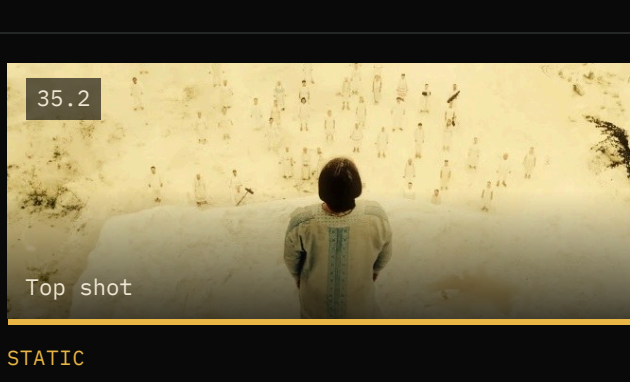
SOURCE Script p56-58
WORLD ■ Fantasy
LOOK Theatrical, rehearsed applause. Then a quiet forest. Memory inserts: warm yellow for the walk to the cinema, grey for the cubicle.



STATIC

Eleanora wakes at the bottom of the staircase and follows a clapping noise, getting louder and louder, out of the house. A group of people dressed in white stand in unison, clapping. She watches from the back, partially obscured.

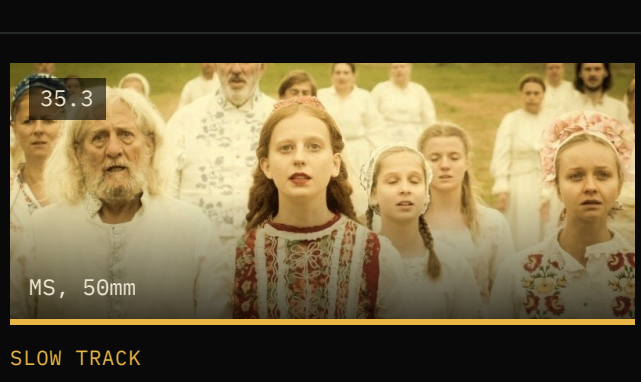
Clapping, aggressive, getting faster.



STATIC

Ezra stands elevated near the house, his face fully covered in bold stage make-up, a wide genuine smile. The applause fills the open space between the house and the forest, in rhythm as if rehearsed a million times. He bows every so often in a mechanical manner.

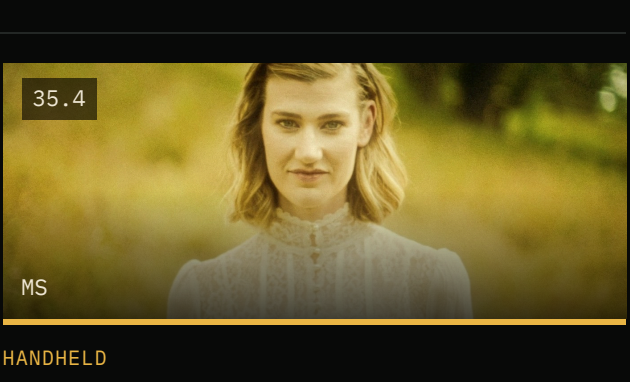
-



SLOW TRACK

The group clap increasingly aggressively, their attention fixed on him. The sound sharp, invasive and insistent.

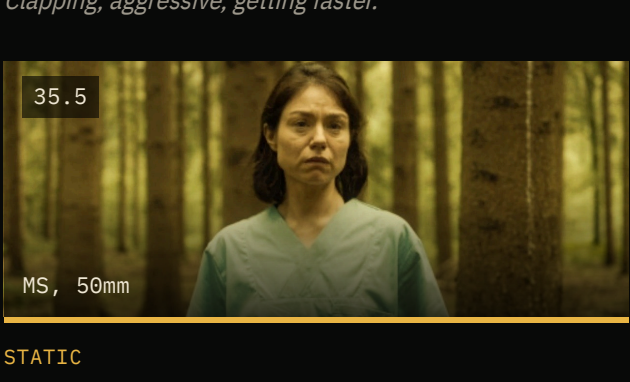
Applause.



HANDHELD

Eleanora works her way through the crowd and sees her Mother at the front, cheering. She drags her Mother away, still cheering.

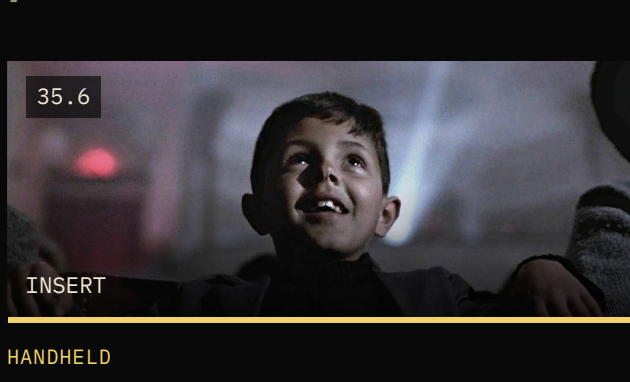
ELEANORA ¿Por quién estás animando? MOTHER Him. ELEANORA Cuéntame sobre el día en el cine. MOTHER We went to my favourite cinema. Cine Malda. Perfect day.



STATIC

Mother stands in the forest. Eleanora up ahead. Clapping echoes from behind. Mother looks around for someone.

ELEANORA ¿Por quién estás animando? (Who are you cheering for?) Who are you looking for?



HANDHELD

INSERT: the pair entering the cinema. INSERT: her Mother's eyes lighting up while seated.

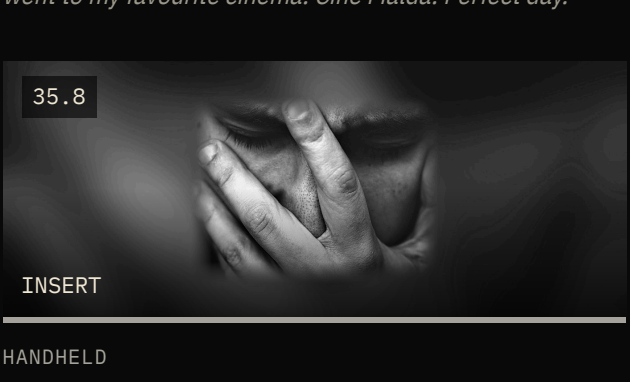
ELEANORA (V.O.) How you took the train. The popcorn. Every single thing. So I surprised you. MOTHER It really was the best day, wasn't it?

35.7
Wide, 24mm

STATIC

INSERT: the cinema toilets. Strangers gather around the cubicle where her Mother has fallen.

-



HANDHELD

INSERT: Eleanora crying on the floor underneath the bathroom cubicle, holding her Mother. Flashes of kids taking pictures and videos underneath the cubicle.

ELEANORA It was the worst day. Well, the second worst day of my life. I screamed at you... MOTHER It's okay. Must be coming to an end. ELEANORA Looks that way.

36

INT. LIVING ROOM – DAY

Ezra wakes; a long awkward pause. The talk turns to Eleanora's looks and escalates ('What else do you have to offer?') until Jacqueline twists Flo's device and presses.

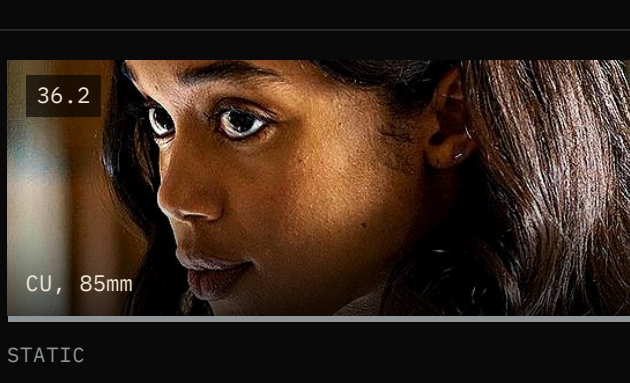
SOURCE Script p59-63
WORLD ■ Reality
LOOK Tightening singles as the scene escalates.

36.1
Two-shot

HANDHELD, TIGHTENING

Ezra wakes on the sofa, followed by Eleanora, Flo, Jasper and Jacqueline. A long awkward pause. The argument escalates.

ELEANORA So they just clap the whole time? EZRA Is there an issue with that? ... EZRA Lenny, you're pretty? What's it like? ... EZRA What else do you have to offer? ELEANORA It's not why we're here, right? Flo, are you ready yet?



STATIC

Jacqueline twists Flo's device. Everyone pauses. She presses just as they are about to escalate the argument.

TWIST. CLICK. CUT TO:

37

EXT. FLO'S FANTASY – LAKE EDGE – DAY

Flo stands behind a massive black pane of glass at the edge of the lake. She wipes one mark clean; another instantly appears. A slow, satisfied smile. The cycle continues, infinite, hypnotic.

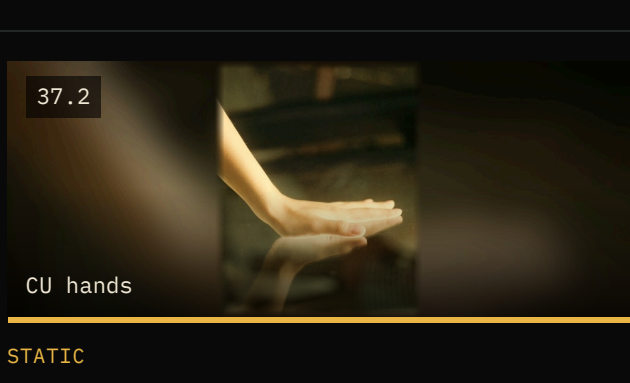
SOURCE Script p63-64
WORLD ■ Fantasy
LOOK Locked-off, centred, repetitive.

37.1
Extreme wide

LOCKED-OFF

Flo stands behind a massive black pane of glass at the edge of the lake, palms pressed flat. Marks appear across the surface: endless lines, smudges, imperfections.

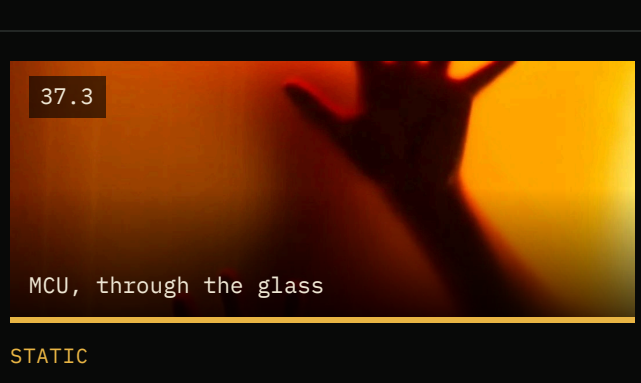
-



STATIC

She wipes one clean; another instantly appears. Another. Her fingers are red at the knuckles, tiny streaks of soap and water trailing down her hands. A flicker of irritation, then a slow, satisfied smile; she moves faster, almost dancing with the repetition.

Flo exhales, a soft, contented sigh.



STATIC

The marks multiply; her hands press against the glass from the other side, silhouetted in the warm light.

-

ACT IIB

The Hunt and the Outhouse

Scenes 38 to 54

38

EXT. FRONT ENTRANCE - NIGHT

We do not hear what is said: Ezra is very animated with his speech and apology while Eleanora stands and smokes.

SOURCE Script p64
WORLD ■ Night
LOOK Wide, no dialogue heard.

STATIC

We do not hear what is being said, but Ezra is very animated with his speech and apology towards Eleanora as she stands and smokes.

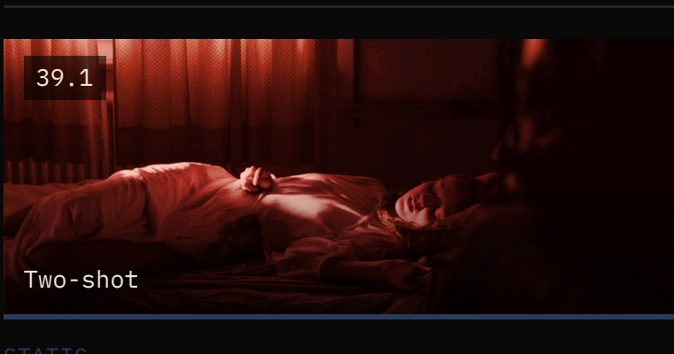
-

39

INT. BEDROOM - NIGHT

Ezra in bed with Eleanora. She finishes him off without a word, staring at the ceiling, then smears his release onto his jacket.

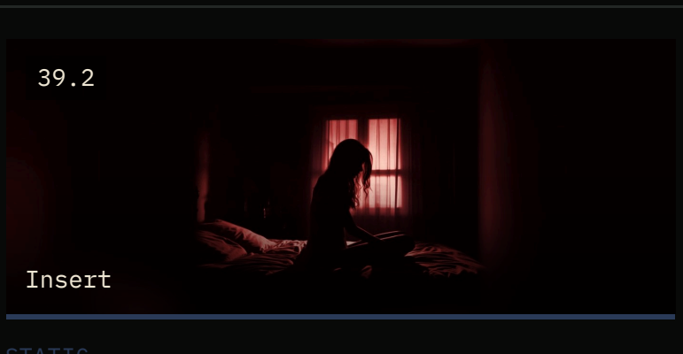
SOURCE Script p64
WORLD ■ Night
LOOK Static, unflinching.



STATIC

Ezra in bed with Eleanora. She looks increasingly upset the closer he gets to climaxing. Again she finishes him off without saying a word, still staring at the ceiling, a vacant look across her eyes.

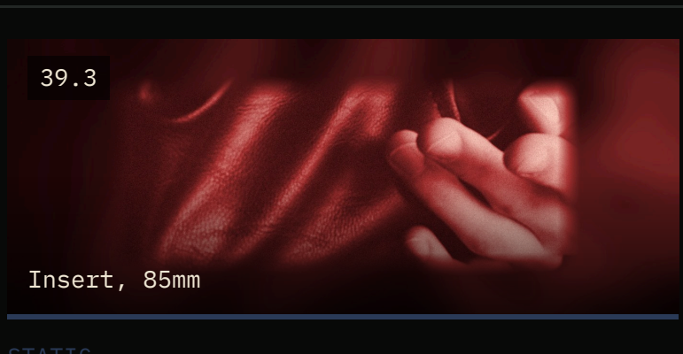
EZRA You love it. You really love it, don't you? Get me some water.



STATIC

She sits at the side of the bed; he rolls over.

-



STATIC

Her hand covered, she walks over to his jacket and smears his release onto it, using the front of her hand and the back.

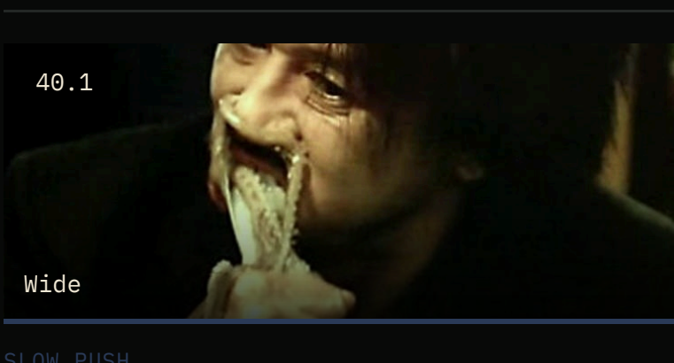
-

40

INT. DINING ROOM - NIGHT

Eleanora hears a rustle: Frans sits in the dark at the back of the dining room behind the rotting food, eating.

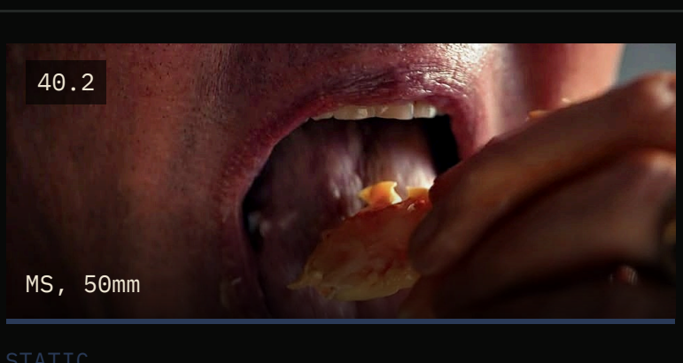
SOURCE Script p64-65
WORLD ■ Night
LOOK One sliver of light on his body.



SLOW PUSH

Eleanora hears a rustle and goes into the dining room. A figure sits at the back of the room, behind the rotting food: Frans. Just a little light hitting the side of his body makes him visible. She pauses and stares briefly at him.

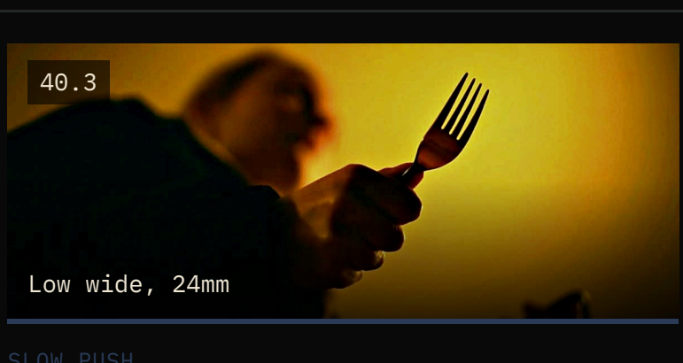
The noise of him eating increases.



STATIC

Frans sits behind the rotting food, eating in the dark.

The noise of him eating increases.



SLOW PUSH

The rotting feast between them; Frans keeps eating, unbothered.

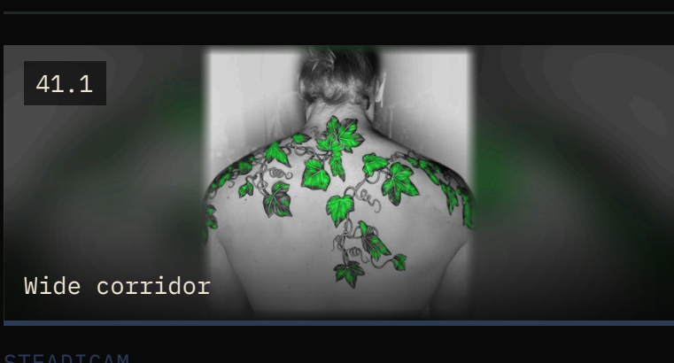
-

41

INT. HALLWAY / BEDROOM - NIGHT

Ezra is asleep. Through blurred vision a figure darts down the corridor; ivy crawls down Ezra's back. Eleanora follows the woman, mirroring every step. When they meet, they are identical; they slow dance through every empty room.

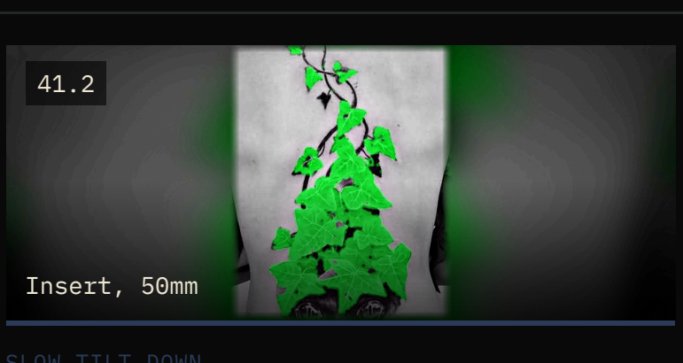
SOURCE Script p65
WORLD ■ Night
LOOK Blurred, dreamlike Steadicam through the house.



STEADICAM

Eleanora sets down two glasses of water; Ezra is already asleep. Through blurred vision, a figure darts down the corridor. Startled, she turns to Ezra: ivy crawls down his back, from the top of his neck to the base of his spine.

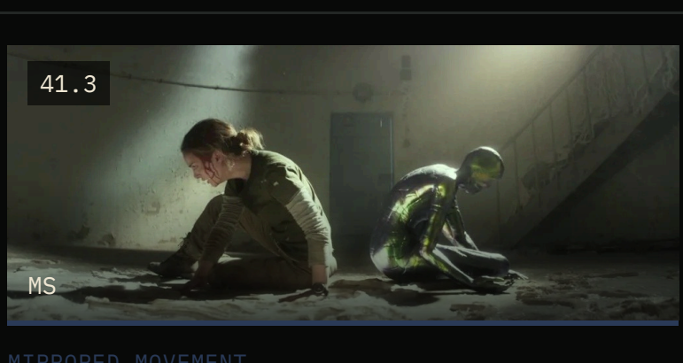
-



SLOW TILT DOWN

The ivy crawls on, from the top of his neck down to the base of his spine.

-



MIRRORED MOVEMENT

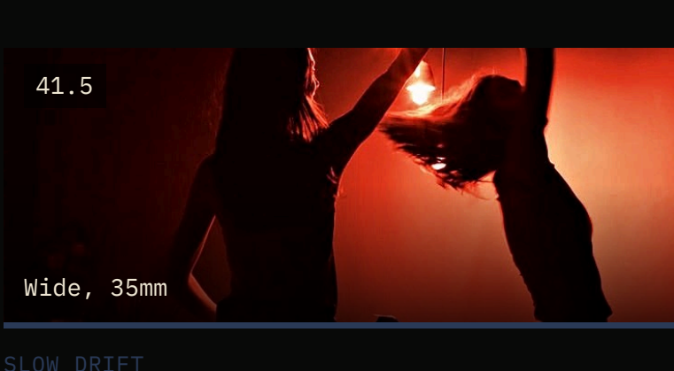
Eleanora rises and follows the unknown woman. They move in sync, mirroring every step, neither catching the other, both trying to escape the property.

-

SLOW DRIFT

When they finally meet, they are dressed identically; even their faces echo each other. They push their bodies together, relieved.

-



SLOW DRIFT

They slow dance, first slowly, then faster, drifting through the property, bringing a moment of peace to every empty room.

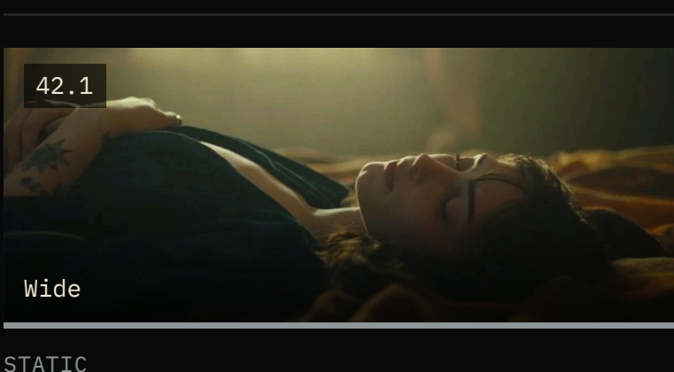
-

42

INT. BEDROOM - MORNING

Morning arrives. Eleanora opens her eyes to empty space, places a hand on the back of her neck and a wave of calm washes over her.

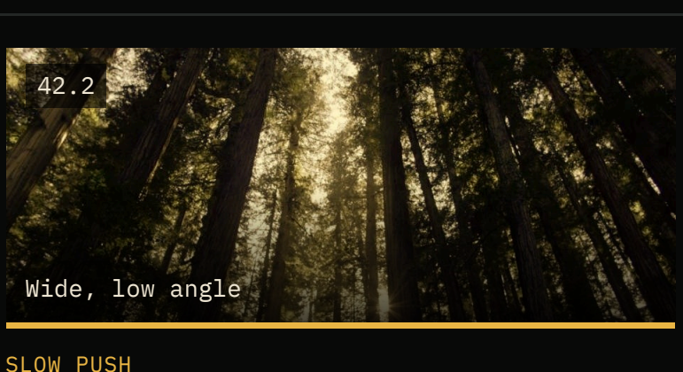
SOURCE Script p65
WORLD ■ Reality
LOOK Soft morning, empty bed.



STATIC

Morning arrives. Eleanora opens her eyes to empty space. She places a hand on the back of her neck, inhales deeply; a wave of calm washes over her again.

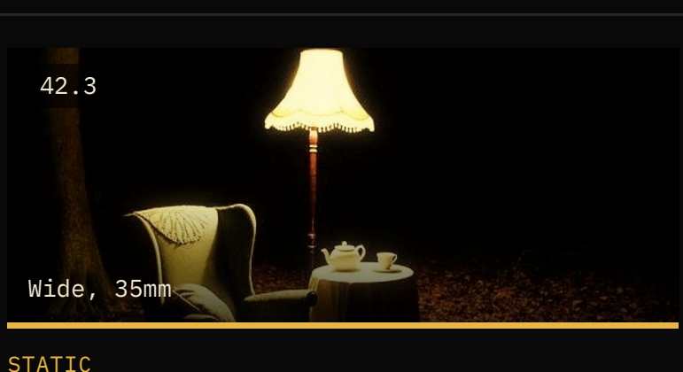
-



SLOW PUSH

EXT. FOREST - DAY - ELEANORA'S FANTASY. She walks out of the house toward the forest; some of the group stare through the window at her.

-



STATIC

Her old dining room is now outside in the forest: an armchair, a lamp, a pot of tea on a small table among the leaves.

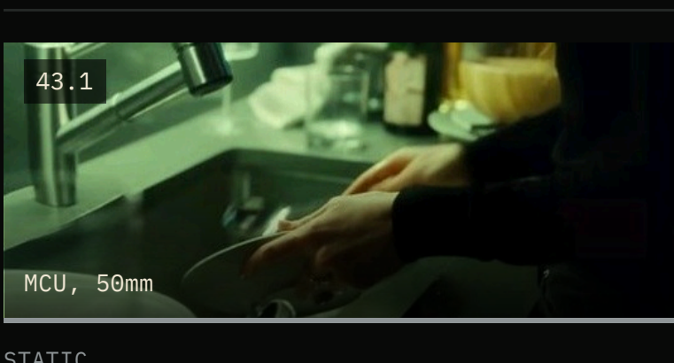
-

43

INT. KITCHEN - DAY (DISH WASHING)

Eleanora does the dishes while Jasper and Frans watch. Frans splashes her. Ezra calls her a creepy fan who doesn't listen; she says all he has ever been with is fans. 'At best you were going to be a good fuck.'

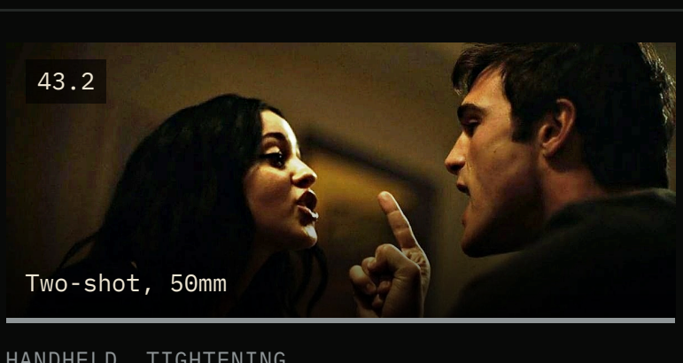
SOURCE Script p65-72
WORLD ■ Reality
LOOK Static OTS that becomes handheld as it escalates.



STATIC

Eleanora starts doing the dishes. Jasper is lounging in the background with Frans; we see them over her shoulder. Frans throws more dishes in the sink; water splashes up onto Eleanora.

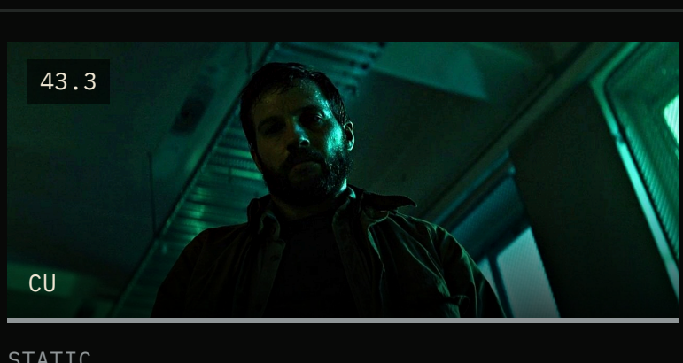
FRANS You don't have to do that, by the way. ELEANORA It needs to be done. JASPER It's not why we're here. Can you stop? FRANS Maybe it's why she's here. ELEANORA Both up here just to watch me clean, huh? FRANS I helped you there.



HANDHELD, TIGHTENING

Frans walks off and Ezra enters. The argument escalates.

EZRA If I'm honest you come across like a bit of a fan now. I find it creepy. ELEANORA So I'm a creepy fan who doesn't listen. ... ELEANORA I think all you've ever been with is fans. Girls who lie in bed and hold your face and tell you you're gorgeous. And because I'm not, it freaks you out.



STATIC

Ezra, unrepentant.

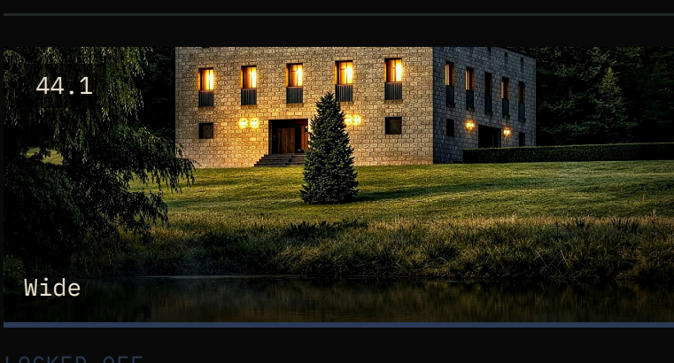
FRANS Cause you're a little pet. ELEANORA And you're a twat.

44

EXT. RETREAT - NIGHT (INTERCUT GROUP)

Eleanora smokes outside, wiping away a tear; behind her the outhouse door is lit green. Intercut: the group dissects her rudeness and her mother's death. A TWIST and CLICK echoes.

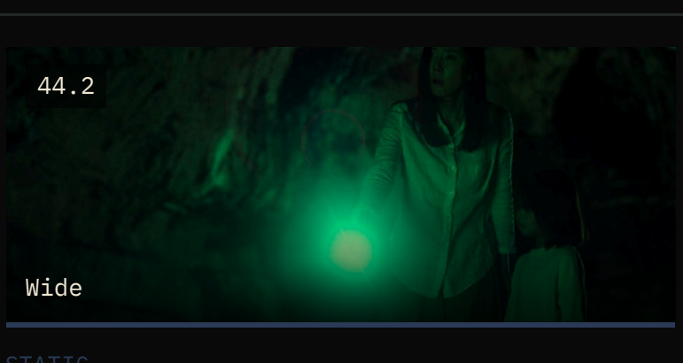
SOURCE Script p72-74
WORLD ■ Night
LOOK Green door deep in frame.



LOCKED-OFF

The house from across the water as night falls, its windows lit.

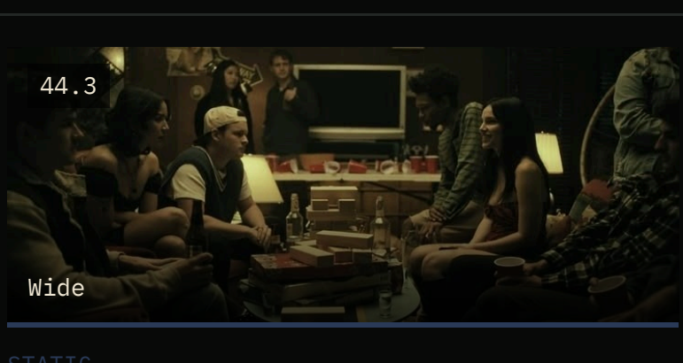
-



STATIC

Eleanora is outside having a smoke and wiping away a tear. In the background we can see the outhouse door lit with green.

-



STATIC

INTERCUT WITH THE GROUP.

FRANS I mean she was so rude to him, you have no idea... EZRA Well, yes. Brain to jelly and all that. JASPER We've all lost family. FRANS Fun sponge. NOISE of a TWIST and CLICK echoes.

45

INT. JACQUELINE'S FANTASY - NIGHT

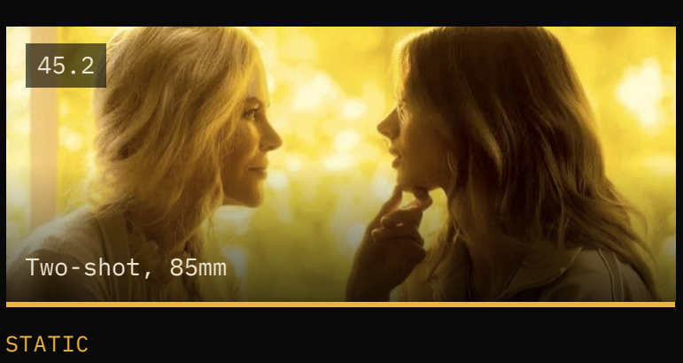
Eleanora holds Jacqueline's hand as she screams in pain.

SOURCE Script p74
WORLD ■ Fantasy
LOOK Close, harsh.

HANDHELD

Eleanora holds Jacqueline's hand as she screams in pain.

JACQUELINE (V.O.) I know where this is going to go. ELEANORA (V.O.) Can you choose?



STATIC

Eleanora holds Jacqueline's face gently, the two close in the yellow light.

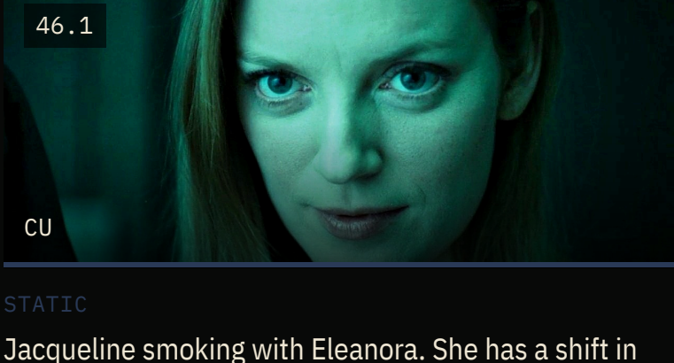
ELEANORA (V.O.) Can you choose?

46

EXT. RETREAT - NIGHT / INT. HOUSE

Smoking with Eleanora, Jacqueline drops the act: this is her actual voice. She talks about Jasper, his fantasy, children she cannot have. Eleanora: she grieved her mother before she died. 'I think I'm becoming a ghost and you're searching for one.'

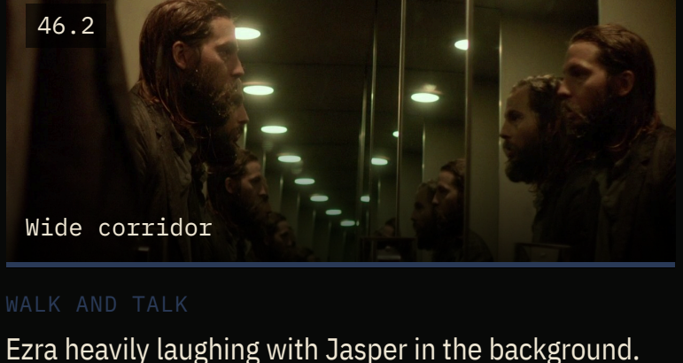
SOURCE Script p75-78
WORLD ■ Night
LOOK Walk-and-talk through the house.



STATIC

Jacqueline smoking with Eleanora. She has a shift in tone and temperament. Eleanora inhales the cigarette deeper.

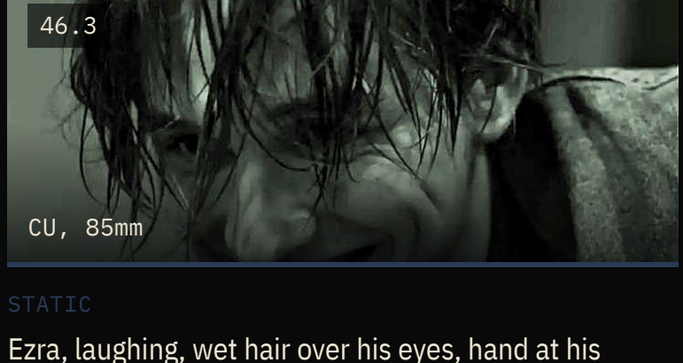
JACQUELINE Oh yeah. This is my actual voice. The other is what Jasper conjured up.... ELEANORA I'm not a stray by the way. JACQUELINE That's not me. In these circles alone you'll develop a wicked tongue.... It makes him laugh. So I do it.



WALK AND TALK

Ezra heavily laughing with Jasper in the background. INTERCUT: flashes of Jasper's fantasy.

JACQUELINE I don't need to see his fantasy to see what he wants. ... ELEANORA I grieved before she died. My mum. Cared for her so long... JACQUELINE I think I'm becoming a ghost and you're searching for one. ... I let you stay here, remember.



STATIC

Ezra, laughing, wet hair over his eyes, hand at his mouth.

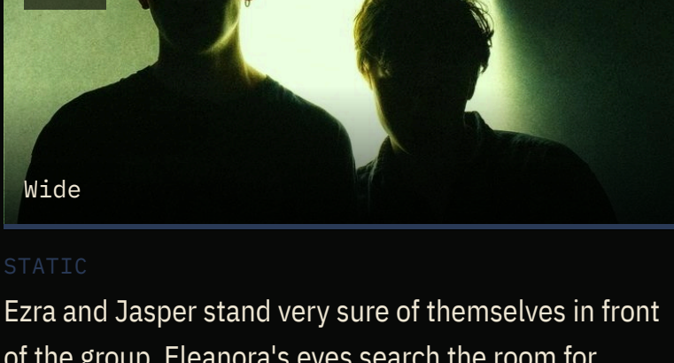
Laughter.

47

INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT (THE LAST NIGHT)

Ezra and Jasper, very sure of themselves: as it's the last night, something special. Everyone closes their eyes; Jacqueline looks to Eleanora with regret. A TWIST and CLICK echoes louder than before.

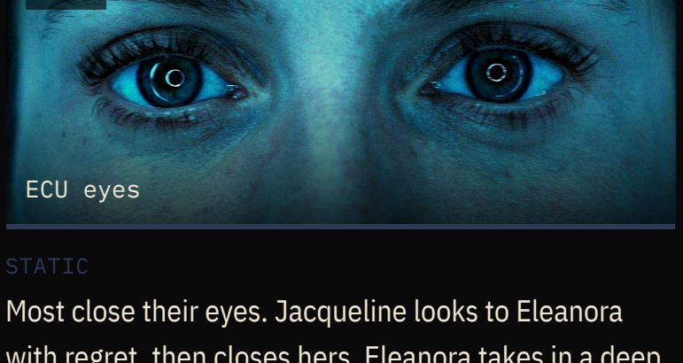
SOURCE Script p78-79
WORLD ■ Night
LOOK Wide, then singles closing their eyes.



STATIC

Ezra and Jasper stand very sure of themselves in front of the group. Eleanora's eyes search the room for reassurance; the women avoid her gaze, each wearing the same quiet dread.

EZRA As it's the last night. And we only have a few fantasies left. Let's do something special. If you could take a seat. Close your eyes. I will let whoever remains decide.



STATIC

Most close their eyes. Jacqueline looks to Eleanora with regret, then closes hers. Eleanora takes in a deep breath and closes her eyes slowly.

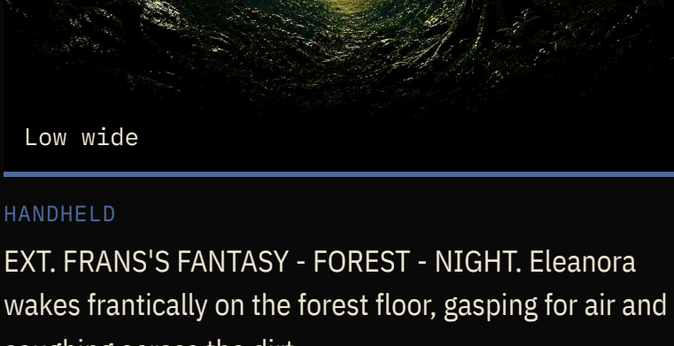
TWIST and CLICK from across the room; Eleanora follows. It echoes louder than before.

48

EXT. FRANS'S FANTASY - FOREST - NIGHT (THE HUNT)

Eleanora wakes on the forest floor inside Frans's fantasy. A blood-soaked woman sprints past; the group are hunted between the trees; Jacqueline is tackled. Eleanora reaches the house, finds every door locked, and is grabbed and choked against the wall.

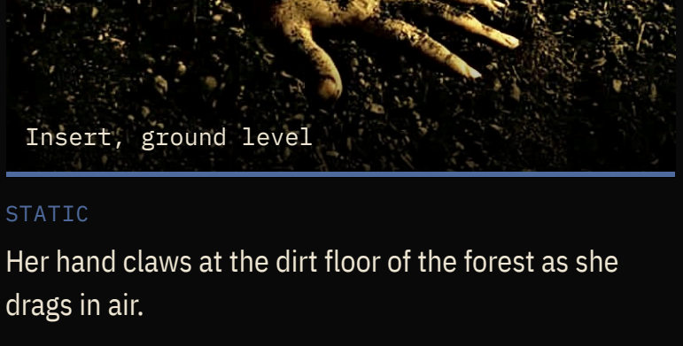
SOURCE Script p79-80
WORLD ■ The hunt
LOOK Blue-black night forest, torchlight, fully subjective handheld.



HANDHELD

EXT. FRANS'S FANTASY - FOREST - NIGHT. Eleanora wakes frantically on the forest floor, gasping for air and coughing across the dirt.

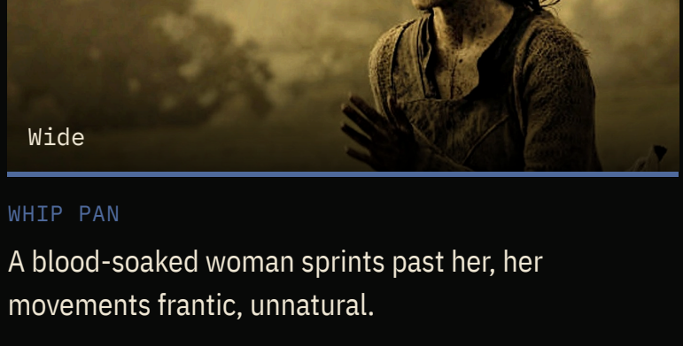
TWIST and CLICK echo, louder than before.



STATIC

Her hand claws at the dirt floor of the forest as she drags in air.

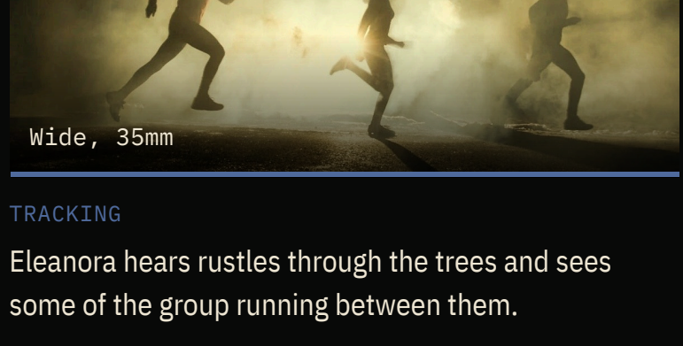
Coughing.



WHIP PAN

A blood-soaked woman sprints past her, her movements frantic, unnatural.

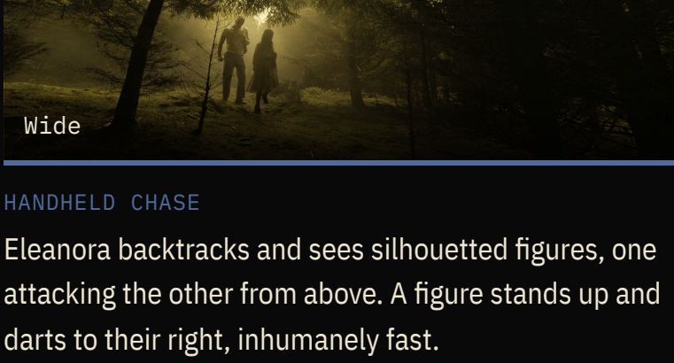
MIX: ELEANORA'S MOTHER / JACQUELINE / EVE (distorted) RUN!



TRACKING

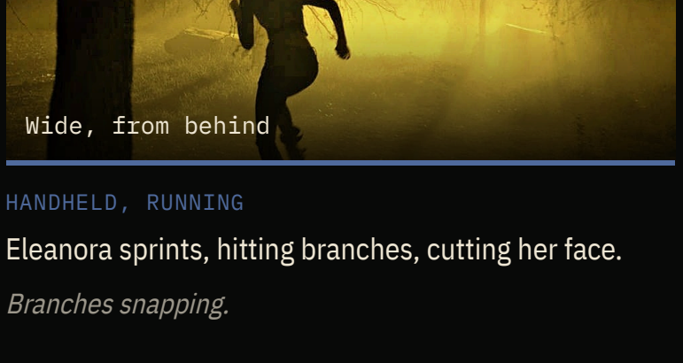
Eleanora hears rustles through the trees and sees some of the group running between them.

Rustling, running feet.



HANDHELD CHASE

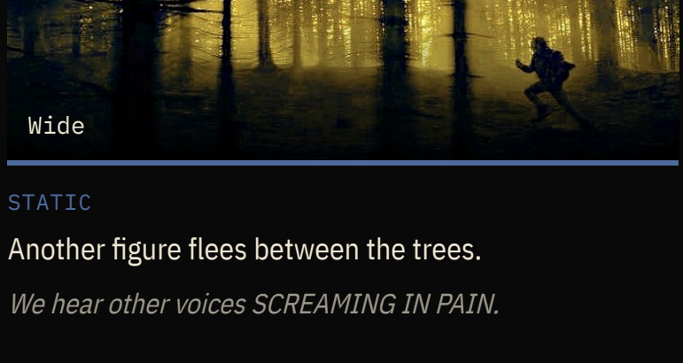
Eleanora backtracks and sees silhouetted figures, one attacking the other from above. A figure stands up and darts to their right, inhumanely fast.



HANDHELD, RUNNING

Eleanora sprints, hitting branches, cutting her face.

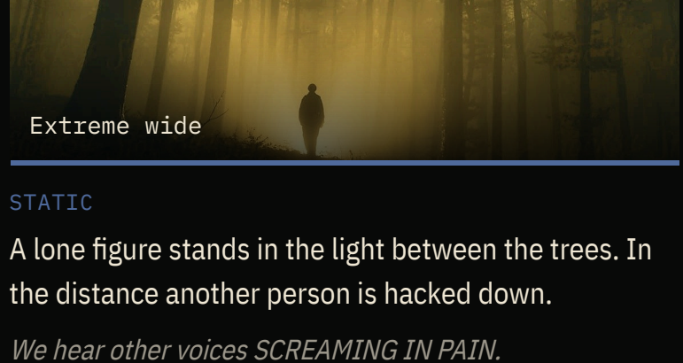
Branches snapping.



STATIC

Another figure flees between the trees.

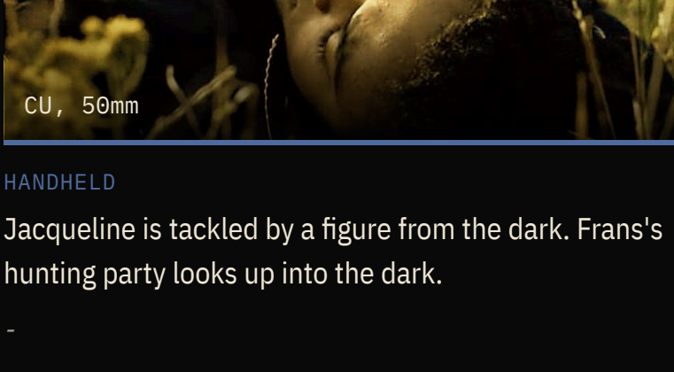
We hear other voices SCREAMING IN PAIN.



STATIC

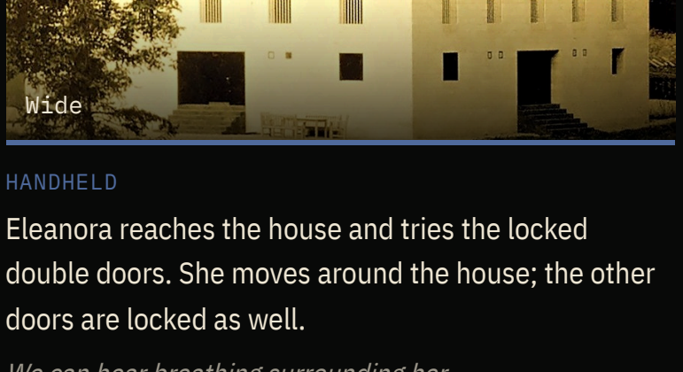
A lone figure stands in the light between the trees. In the distance another person is hacked down.

We hear other voices SCREAMING IN PAIN.



HANDHELD

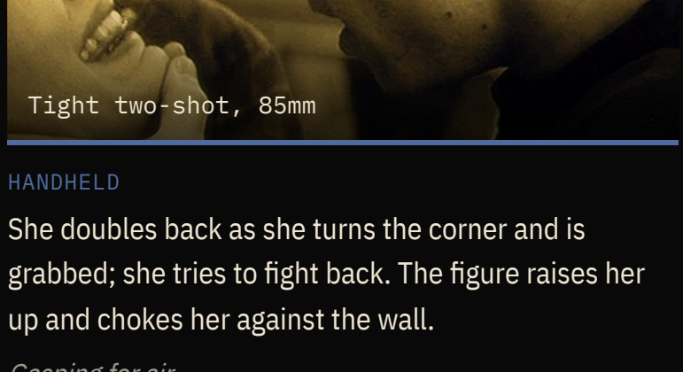
Jacqueline is tackled by a figure from the dark. Frans's hunting party looks up into the dark.



HANDHELD

Eleanora reaches the house and tries the locked double doors. She moves around the house; the other doors are locked as well.

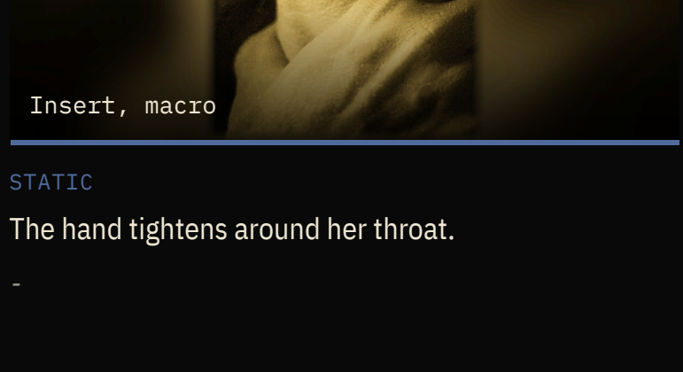
We can hear breathing surrounding her.



HANDHELD

She doubles back as she turns the corner and is grabbed; she tries to fight back. The figure raises her up and chokes her against the wall.

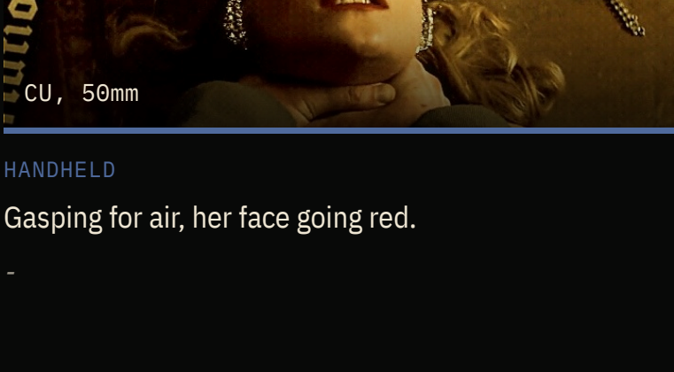
Gasping for air.



STATIC

The hand tightens around her throat.

-



HANDHELD

Gasping for air, her face going red.

HANDHELD

Feet kicking for grip, she desperately looks up to the window above: the woman she danced through the house with stares down at her.

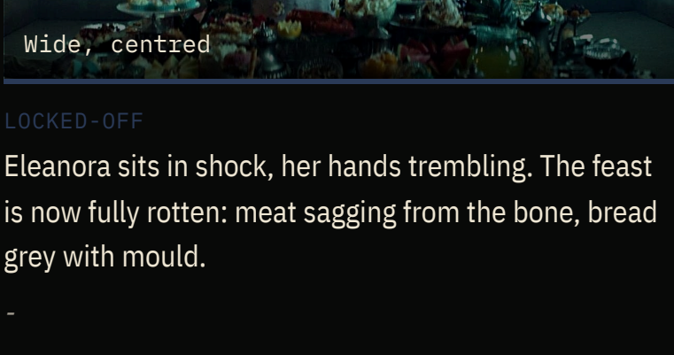
Gasping for air. BLURRED CUT TO:

49

INT. DINING ROOM - NIGHT (LAST DINNER)

The last dinner. The feast is fully rotten; the guys toast the hunt with glasses of water while Eleanora sits in shock.

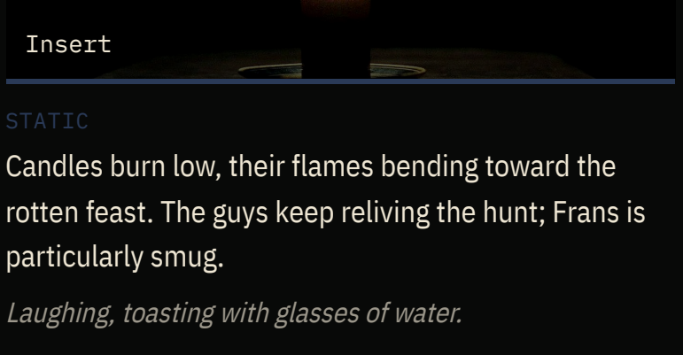
SOURCE Script p80-81
WORLD ■ Night
LOOK Locked-off, centred.



LOCKED-OFF

Eleanora sits in shock, her hands trembling. The feast is now fully rotten: meat sagging from the bone, bread grey with mould.

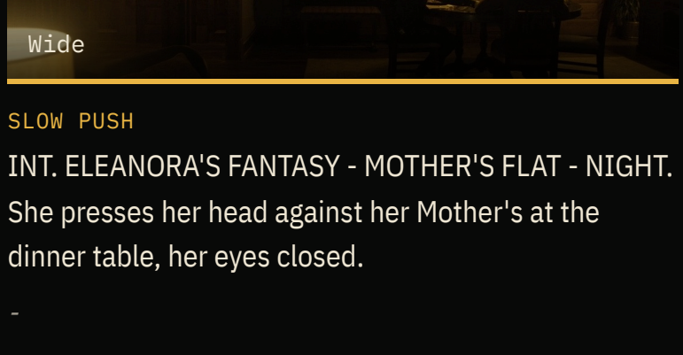
-



STATIC

Candles burn low, their flames bending toward the rotten feast. The guys keep reliving the hunt; Frans is particularly smug.

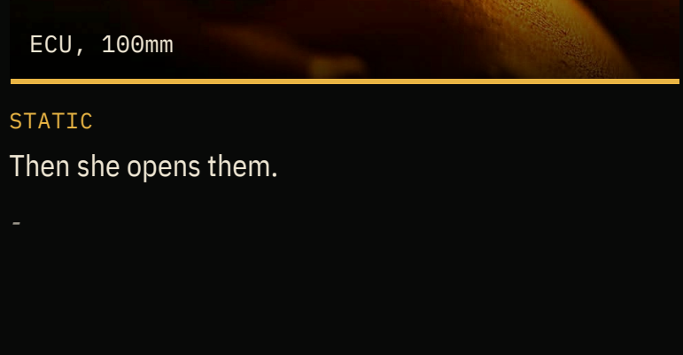
Laughing, toasting with glasses of water.



SLOW PUSH

INT. ELEANORA'S FANTASY - MOTHER'S FLAT - NIGHT. She presses her head against her Mother's at the dinner table, her eyes closed.

-



STATIC

Then she opens them.

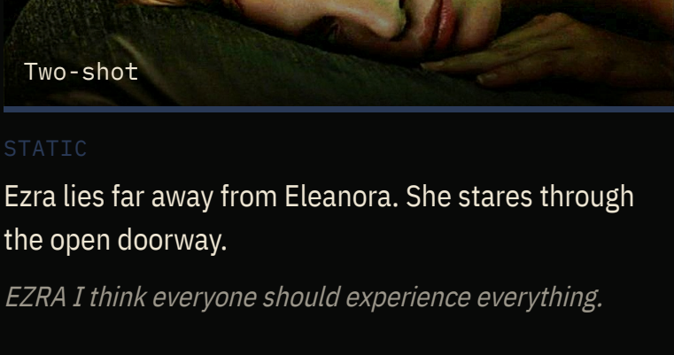
-

50

INT. BEDROOM - NIGHT (BED TIME)

Bed time. Ezra lies far away from Eleanora. 'I think everyone should experience everything.'

SOURCE Script p81-82
WORLD ■ Night
LOOK Static two-shot.



STATIC

Ezra lies far away from Eleanora. She stares through the open doorway.

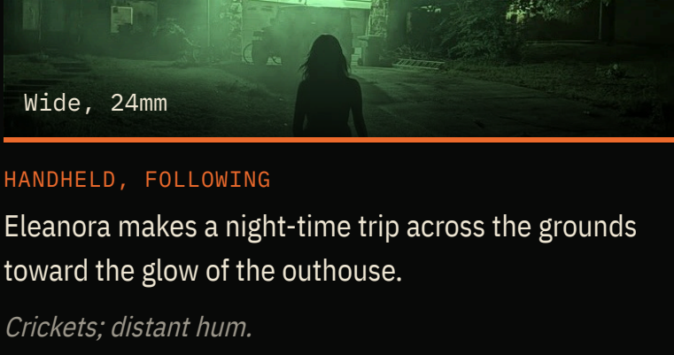
EZRA I think everyone should experience everything.

51

EXT. / INT. OUTHOUSE - THE OFFSET LAB - NIGHT

Fully alienated, Eleanora makes a night-time trip to the outhouse. She discovers Eve: hooked to failing machinery, her device sparking red, damaged by prolonged 'infinity' use.

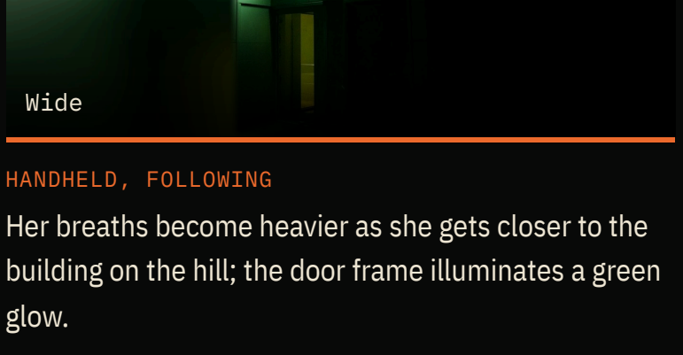
SOURCE Script p82-83
WORLD ■ Device / infinity
LOOK Green-lit clinical corridors. Device danger state: orange-red.



HANDHELD, FOLLOWING

Eleanora makes a night-time trip across the grounds toward the glow of the outhouse.

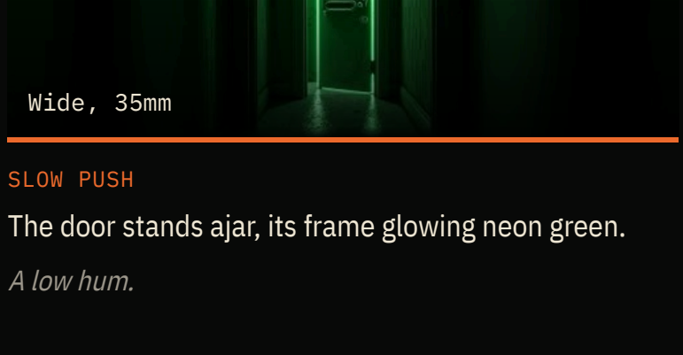
Crickets; distant hum.



HANDHELD, FOLLOWING

Her breaths become heavier as she gets closer to the building on the hill; the door frame illuminates a green glow.

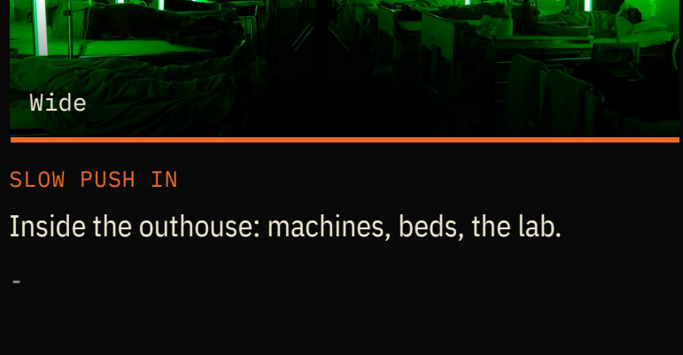
Heavy breathing.



SLOW PUSH

The door stands ajar, its frame glowing neon green.

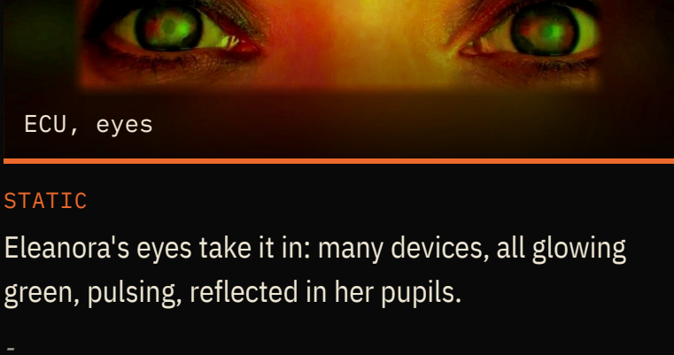
A low hum.



SLOW PUSH IN

Inside the outhouse: machines, beds, the lab.

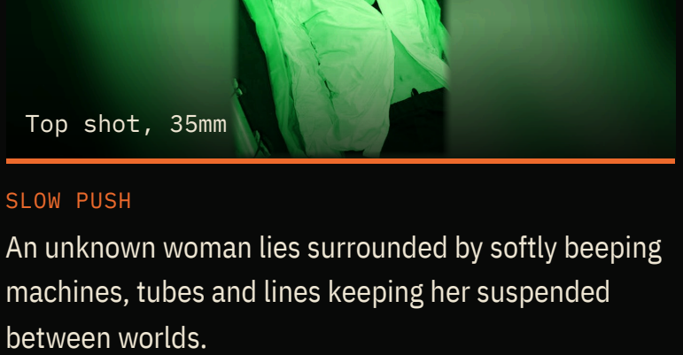
-



STATIC

Eleanora's eyes take it in: many devices, all glowing green, pulsing, reflected in her pupils.

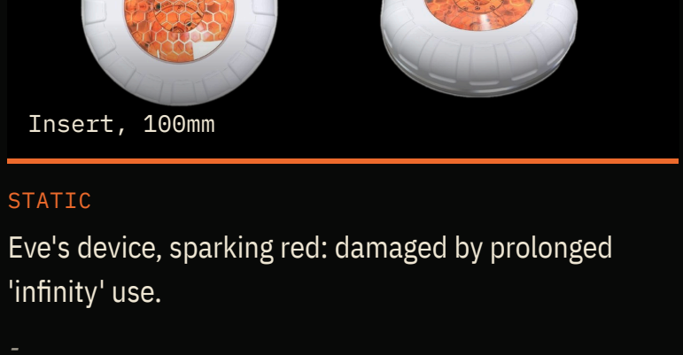
-



SLOW PUSH

An unknown woman lies surrounded by softly beeping machines, tubes and lines keeping her suspended between worlds.

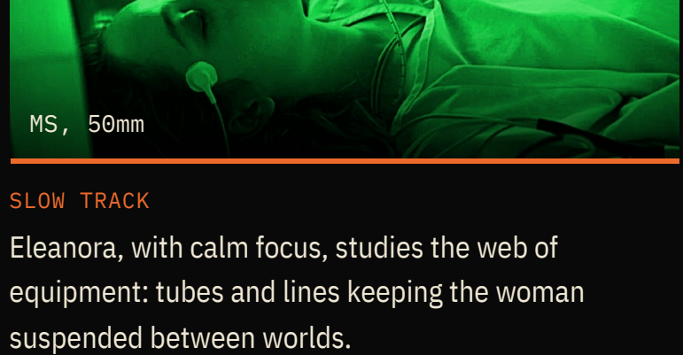
Machines beeping softly.



STATIC

Eve's device, sparking red: damaged by prolonged 'infinity' use.

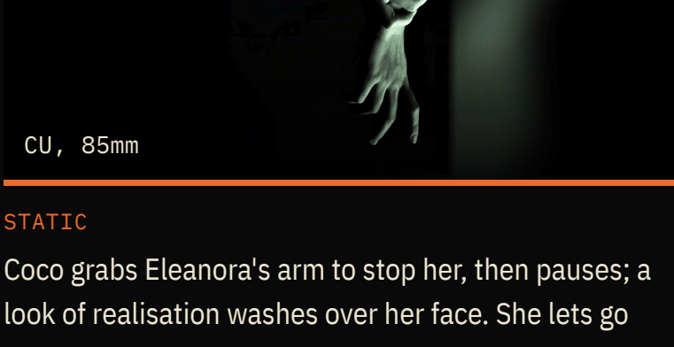
-



SLOW TRACK

Eleanora, with calm focus, studies the web of equipment: tubes and lines keeping the woman suspended between worlds.

Softly beeping machines.



STATIC

Coco grabs Eleanora's arm to stop her, then pauses; a look of realisation washes over her face. She lets go apologetically.

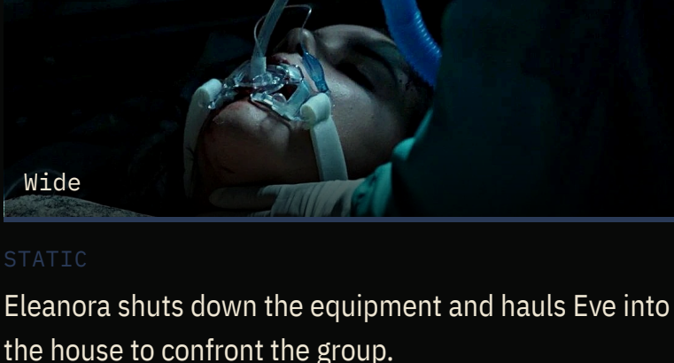
-

52

INT. HOUSE - STAIRS / LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Eleanora shuts down the equipment and hauls Eve into the house to confront the group. Charlie and Coco's culpability is exposed. Eve, glitching and in agony, begs to be killed: an echo of Eleanora's mother.

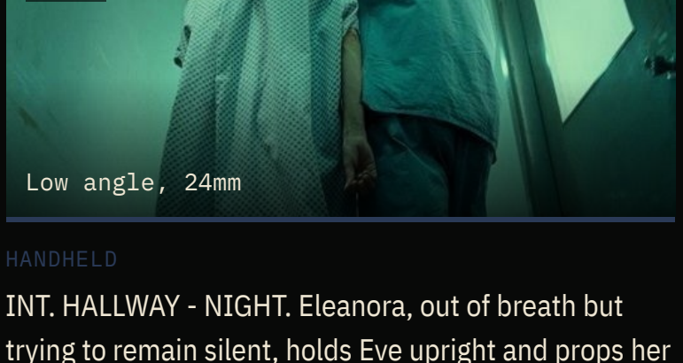
SOURCE Script p83-91
WORLD ■ Night
LOOK Horror register. The cold-open stairwell, now real.



STATIC

Eleanora shuts down the equipment and hauls Eve into the house to confront the group.

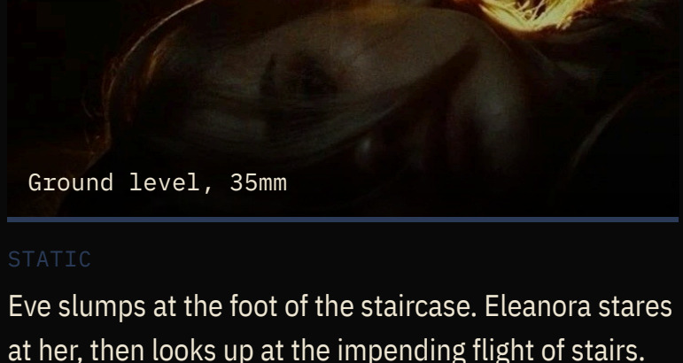
-



HANDHELD

INT. HALLWAY - NIGHT. Eleanora, out of breath but trying to remain silent, holds Eve upright and props her against the side of the staircase.

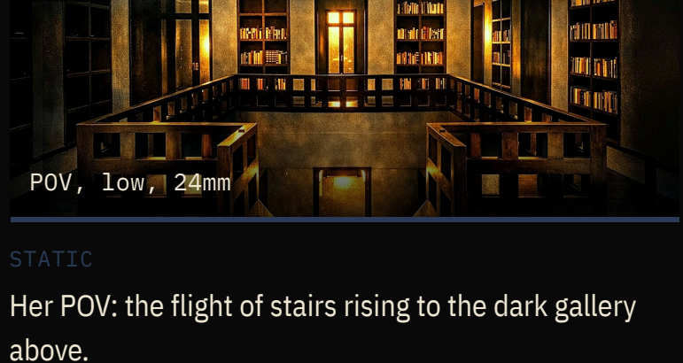
Laboured breathing.



STATIC

Eve slumps at the foot of the staircase. Eleanora stares at her, then looks up at the impending flight of stairs.

-



STATIC

Her POV: the flight of stairs rising to the dark gallery above.

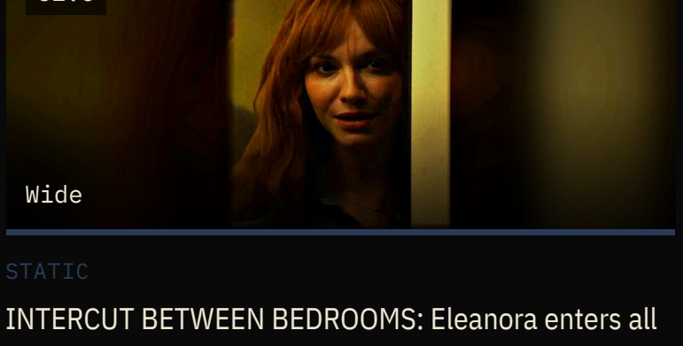
-

52.5
CU, through the banisters

STATIC

Through the banisters: Eve at the bottom of the stairs.

Laboured breathing.



STATIC

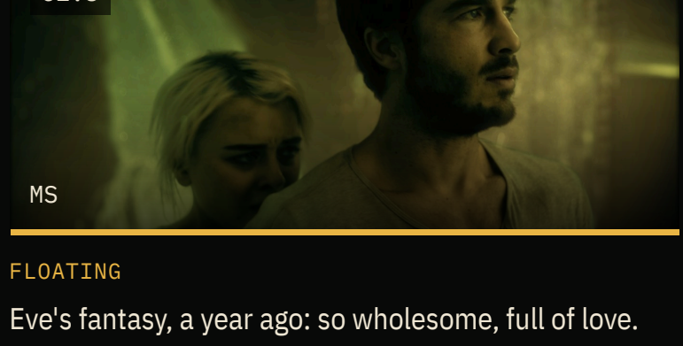
INTERCUT BETWEEN BEDROOMS: Eleanora enters all the bedrooms and whispers to everyone.

Whispers.

HANDHELD

FLASHBACK FROM THE YEAR BEFORE: the same group in their pristine clothes, devices on, laughing and joking.

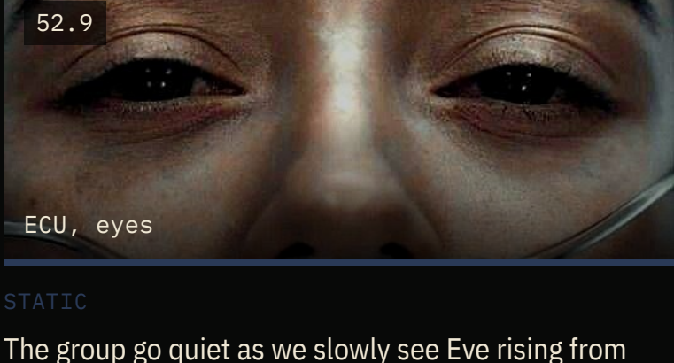
COCO We took turns like you have.



FLOATING

Eve's fantasy, a year ago: so wholesome, full of love. The system was younger.

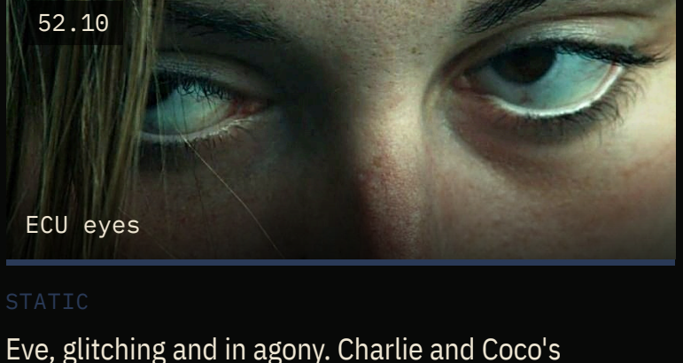
COCO Hers was so wholesome, full of love. I admired her optimism.



STATIC

The group go quiet as we slowly see Eve rising from her chair, her device glitching in and out. Her eyes try to find focus like a camera, opening and closing in pain from the lights.

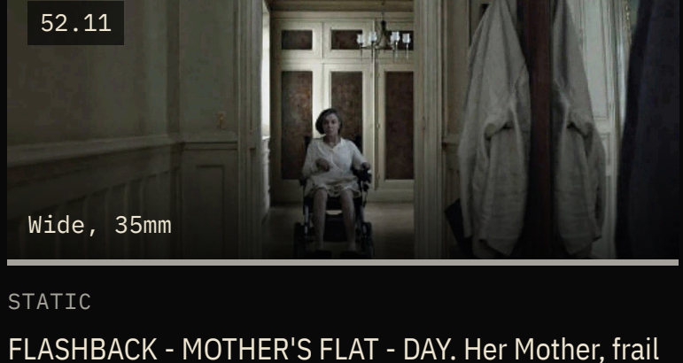
EZRA My god.



STATIC

Eve, glitching and in agony. Charlie and Coco's culpability is exposed.

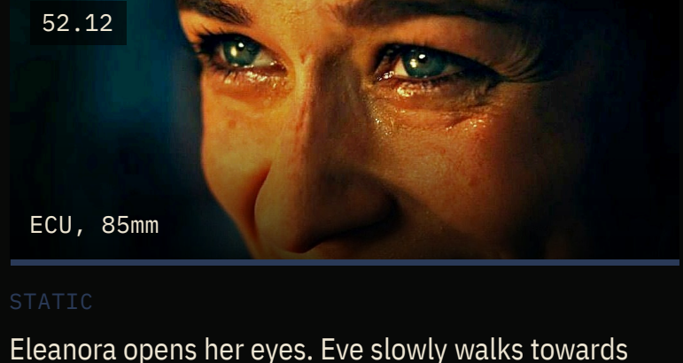
-



STATIC

FLASHBACK - MOTHER'S FLAT - DAY. Her Mother, frail in her wheelchair at the end of the hallway. Eleanora has a strong emotional reaction.

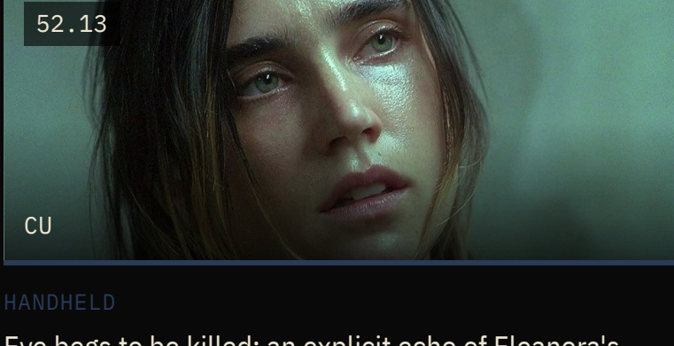
MOTHER SCREAMS IN PAIN. MOTHER Kill me!



STATIC

Eleanora opens her eyes. Eve slowly walks towards her, struggling to find balance, and grabs onto her; Eleanora, tears in her eyes, looks more concerned for Eve than for herself.

-



HANDHELD

Eve begs to be killed: an explicit echo of Eleanora's mother.

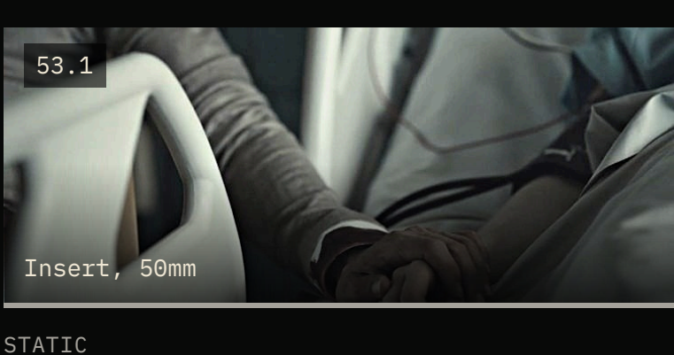
-

53

INT. HOUSE - BALCONY - NIGHT

Eve breaks free and jumps from the balcony, dying in the same spot as the year before.

SOURCE Script p92
WORLD ■ Night
LOOK Matches the cold open's leap.



STATIC

FLASHBACK - INT. MOTHER'S FLAT - DAY. Eleanora holds her Mother's hand. She gives her mum a huge hug; they grip each other tightly.

-

SLOW MOTION

Eve breaks free and jumps from the balcony, dying in the same spot as the year before.

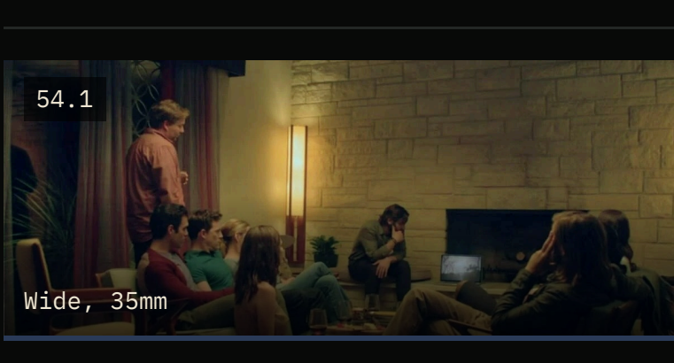
-

54

INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT (THE REQUEST)

The group fractures into blame, panic and denial ('You thought she died?'). Eleanora quietly asks to go back into the device 'one more time'.

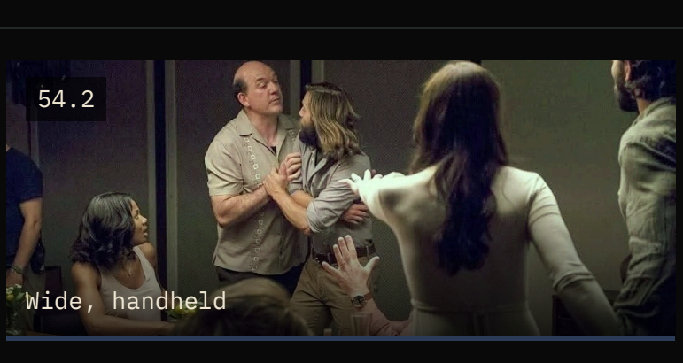
SOURCE Script p92-94
WORLD ■ Night
LOOK Static, quiet.



STATIC

The group scrambles to distance themselves, fracturing into blame, panic and denial.

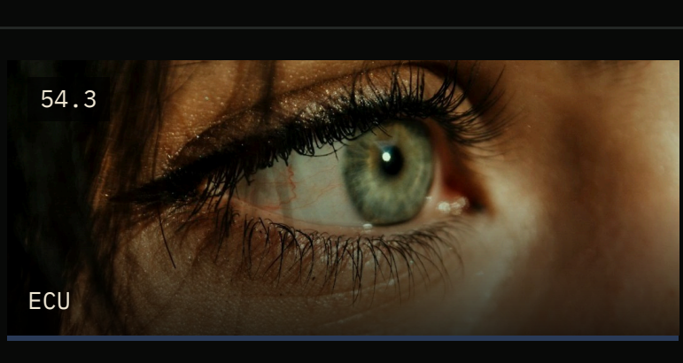
CHARLIE You thought she died? Was that going to be your reply?



HANDHELD, PUSHING IN

The group erupts. Ezra explodes in anger, shouting, pacing and blaming. Charlie joins in, yelling over everyone, the accusations flying in all directions. Voices overlap. Fingers point. No one agrees on what just happened or who is responsible.

Overlapping shouting.



STATIC

Eleanora's quiet, unsettling request.

ELEANORA One more time.

ACT III

The Reckoning

Scenes 55 to 58

55

INT. DINING ROOM – NIGHT (THE RECKONING)

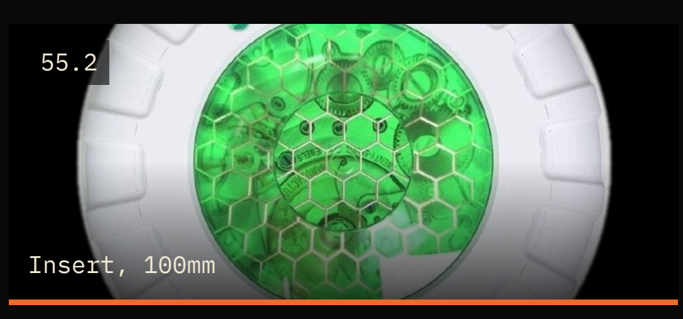
One final shared session at the ruined feast table. One by one, Eleanora turns each device past its intended duration toward 'infinity': Frans first, a physical struggle she wins; then Charlie, turned by a weeping, complicit Coco; then the rest.

SOURCE	Script p94-95
WORLD	🟧 Device / infinity
LOOK	Centred and controlled again, but now Eleanora holds the dial. Device moves from green to orange-red.

STATIC

Reluctantly, grief-numbed and eager to move past what just happened, the group agrees to one final shared session at the ruined feast table. Eleanora turns a device past its intended duration, toward 'infinity'.

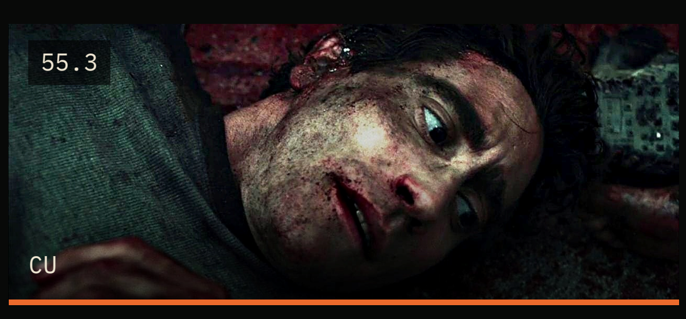
TWIST. TWIST. TWIST.



STATIC

Frans slowly leans forward to see if she is in the system. He moves her hair off her neck and catches a glance of the device with just one green circle.

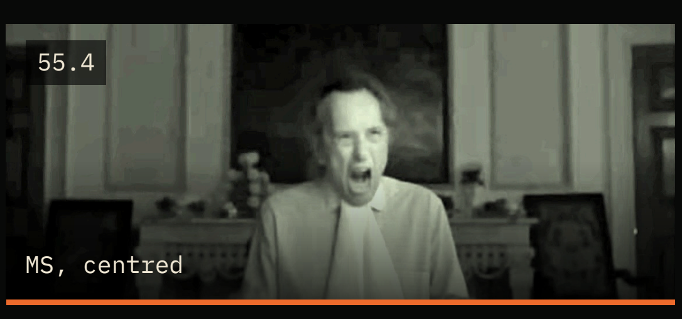
-



HANDHELD

Frans first: a physical struggle she wins.

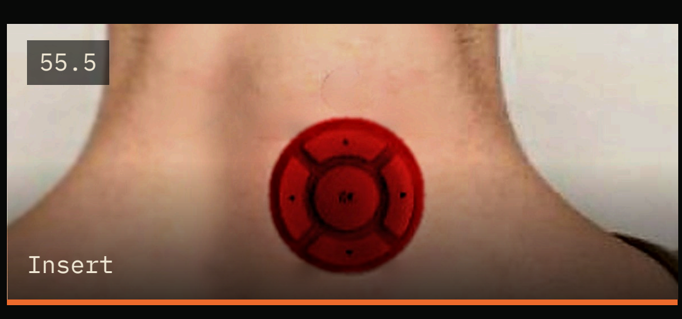
-



STATIC

Charlie is disgusted and fills with rage; he moves towards Eleanora to attack her and shouts at her. Coco comes to comfort him.

CHARLIE (shouting, unheard)



STATIC

Then Charlie, turned by a weeping, complicit Coco; then the rest of the group in sequence.

-

56

INT. DINING ROOM – NIGHT (THE FIGHT)

Ezra is the final and hardest confrontation: a full physical fight across the spoiled feast. Eleanora narrowly overpowers him.

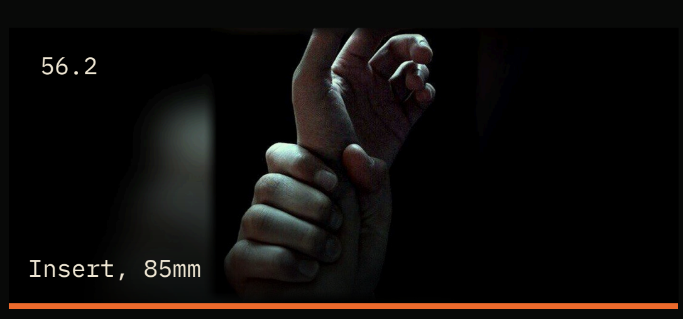
SOURCE	Script p95-96
WORLD	🟧 Device / infinity
LOOK	Handheld, close, brutal.

56.1
Wide, 28mm

HANDHELD

Ezra snaps and lunges. He climbs onto the table and crawls across it like a maniac as the others pull back.

Glasses topple.



HANDHELD

Eleanora meets him head on. He seizes her wrist; the table shakes as they each try to gain the upper hand.

-

56.3
MCU, 50mm

HANDHELD

Ezra, blood smeared down his neck and shirt, comes at her again.

-

56.4
Low, table level

HANDHELD

Ezra pushes Eleanora across the table and into the decaying food; plates and glasses scatter as they struggle across it.

Glass breaking.

56.5
Top shot, 35mm

HANDHELD

They find themselves at the end of the table. Ezra pins her down, his hand clamped over her mouth; her eyes wide.

Muffled breathing.

56.6
Two-shot, silhouette

HANDHELD

Ezra is choking her. Eleanora scratches his face, making him wince; he tightens his grip just before she is about to pass out.

CLICK.

56.7
Wide, 35mm

STATIC

She swings around and hits his device. Ezra collapses forward across the table; Eleanora kneels among the plates, gasping, collecting air.

Heavy breathing.

56.8
High angle, 35mm

STATIC

Ezra lies across the table amid the ruined feast, eyes open, staring at nothing as he slips into the system.

-

PUSH IN

She twists his device even further, just before infinity. Eleanora moves around the table doing it to each person.

ELEANORA (V.O) My Mother knew what she meant to me.

56.10
Top shot, 24mm

SLOW CRANE UP

Eleanora sits amid the ruined feast, the group slumped around the table in the system, one by one.

-

56.11
MCU, 85mm

STATIC

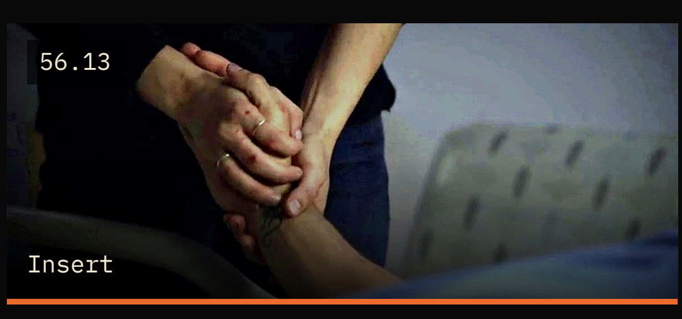
Eleanora stands, spattered with the rotten food, surveying what she has done.

Silence; the hum of the devices.

STATIC

INTERCUT: Eleanora has a hot shower and cleans off the rotten food.

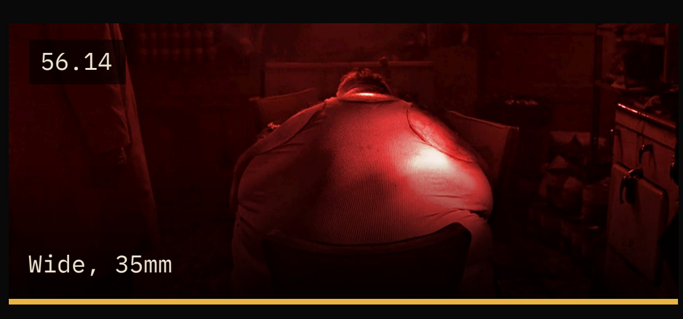
Water running.



STATIC

Coco checking the group's vitals as they are in the system.

Monitors beeping.



STATIC

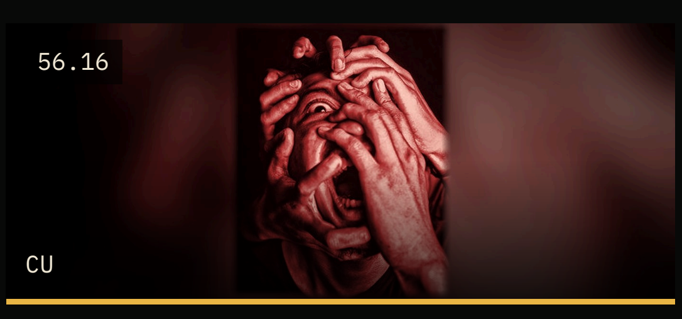
INTERCUT: A morbidly obese Cali, in pain, hunched over the table.

ELEANORA (V.O) A year for a year.

STATIC

She stuffs cake into her mouth. Her mirror unchanged.

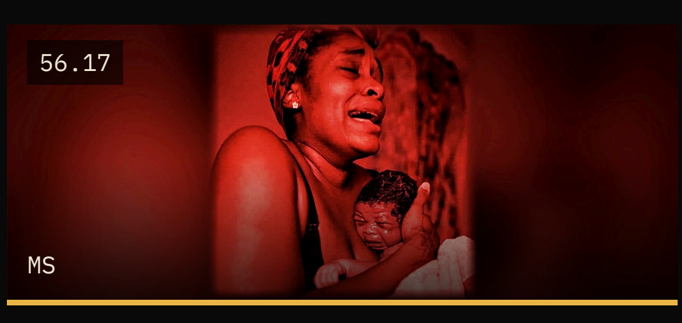
-



HANDHELD

Hands gripping and scratching Jasper from bodies unseen.

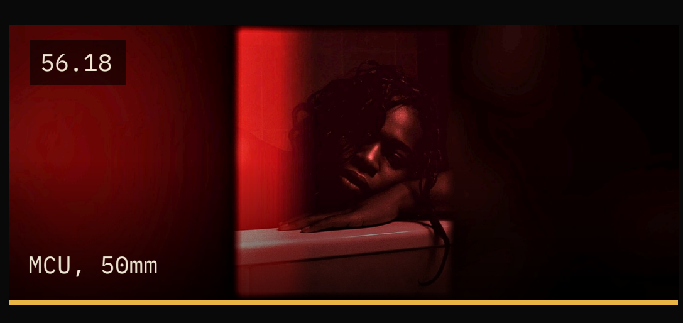
ELEANORA (V.O) They lived reckless and careless lives and forgot about her.



STATIC

Jacqueline cries against a bed as a baby cries on it.

ELEANORA (V.O) So they will stay in there. Like she did.



STATIC

Jacqueline slumped over the edge of the bath, spent, in the red light.

-

56.19
Insert

STATIC

Flo's fingers bleed, fumbling as she tries to conceal the marks on the glass.

ELEANORA (V.O) What is desire if it's fulfilled?

56.20
Top shot, 35mm

STATIC

Cai lies on the grass, overdosing, consumed by the drugs: sunk into the earth, arms spread, the ground closing over him.

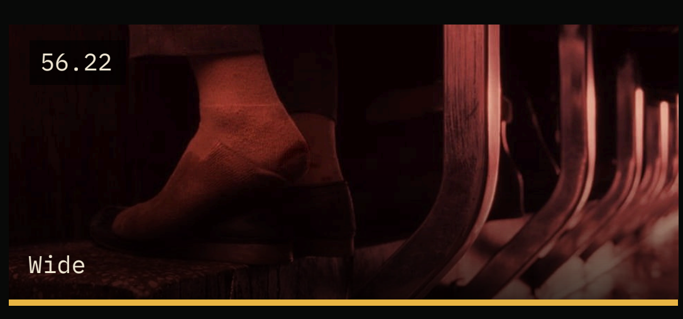
ELEANORA (V.O) What is thirst when it's quenched?

56.21
High angle, 50mm

SLOW PUSH

His eyes close; the undergrowth swallows him.

-



HANDHELD

Charlie gives tours in agony, attempting to bask in glory, but his trembling legs and blistered feet barely hold him up.

ELEANORA (V.O) It's nothing. Nothing comes from nothing.

STATIC

Ezra's make-up streaks from tears as he and the fans are in agony, but they continue clapping.

ELEANORA (V.O) And after all the pleasure and gorging and idolising. The question still stands.

57

INT. ELEANORA'S FANTASY – MOTHER – (FINAL)

A flicker of hesitation as her hand lifts toward her neck. FLASHBACK to her fantasy with her Mother, as before: she leans in on her Mother at the table. 'No eres mi madre.'

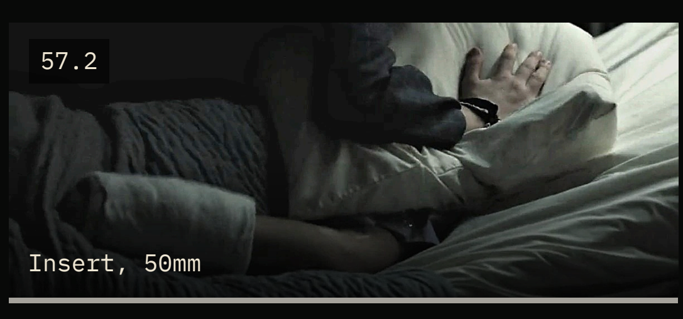
SOURCE	Script p97
WORLD	🟨 Fantasy
LOOK	Fantasy yellow: a flashback to her earlier fantasy, not a return.

57.1
Two-shot

STATIC

FLASHBACK: Eleanora with her Mother in her earlier fantasy, remembered, not revisited.

-



STATIC

FLASHBACK - INT. MOTHER'S FLAT. Eleanora holds the pillow above her mum's head and presses down a little. Then she releases it to the floor.

-

STATIC

She gives her mum a huge hug. They grip each other tightly.

-

57.4
Two-shot, 85mm

STATIC

INT. ELEANORA'S FANTASY - NIGHT. She leans in on her Mother, close, the two resting against each other.

ELEANORA No eres mi madre. (You are not my Mother.)

58

EXT. RETREAT – DAY / LATER: INT. LIVING ROOM – DAY

Eleanora walks barefoot down the lane, away from the house, alive and entirely alone. Later, the group lie dusty and wired in, kept in the system.

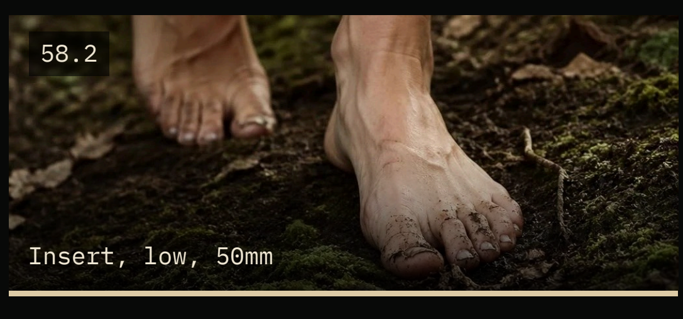
SOURCE	Script p97
WORLD	■ Walking out
LOOK	Extreme wide, still, fog.

58.1
Extreme wide

LOCKED-OFF

Eleanora walks barefoot down the lane away from the house, alive and entirely alone.

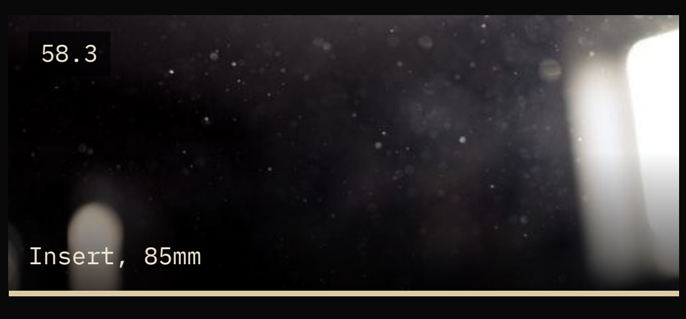
-



TRACKING

Under her bare feet, the ground is damp with dew; each step soft but deliberate.

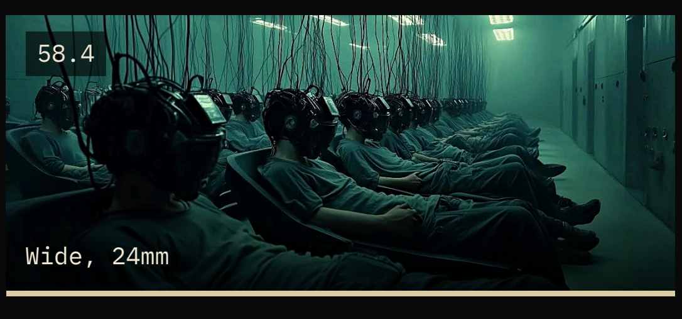
ELEANORA (V.O) Would your fantasy really be your fantasy if you could have it all the time?



STATIC

LATER: dust hangs in the light of the living room.

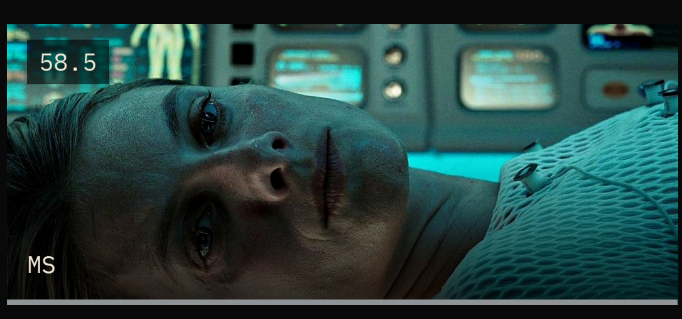
-



SLOW TRACK

The group lie in rows, wired in, feeding tubes and lines running from each of them: kept in the system, indefinitely.

The hum of the machines.



SLOW TRACK

LATER: INT. LIVING ROOM - DAY. The group are all slightly dusty, connected to devices, feeding tubes, heart monitors and IVs.

ELEANORA (V.O) Or should it always be just out of reach. Aimed for but never grasped.

58.6
Insert, 85mm
RESP
20

STATIC

Heart monitors tick over beside each of them, keeping the group suspended in the system.

The steady beep of the monitors. ELEANORA (V.O) Forever. Para siempre. FADE TO BLACK.

Would your fantasy really be your fantasy…

if you could have it all the time?

Or should it always be… just out of reach.

Aimed for… but never grasped.

Not to run… or to fly.

But to walk… with my voice.

Forever…

Para siempre.

ELEANORA (V.O.) · OFFSET · P97

PAGE REFERENCES FOLLOW THE 98-PAGE DRAFT (OFFSET 04-07-2026).